Coater 1 Intelligent Operations Advisor

Technical Design Document — v3.0 As-Built Reference

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April 2026

Revision History & How To Read This Document

Document Lineage

Version	Date	Author	Status	Summary
1.0	January 2026	Jordan Taylor	Superseded	Initial proposal: schema sketch, RAG pipeline, conversation logging.
2.0	April 2026	Jordan Taylor	Superseded by v3.0	59-page design specification with 29-table schema and anchor-conditional context assembly.
3.0	**April 23, 2026**	**Jordan Taylor**	**Current — As-Built**	**This document. Reflects shipped code at 145 passing tests / 0 failing.**

Version 2.0 was an *aspirational design document*. It described the system the way it should be built. Version 3.0 — this document — is the *as-built reference*. It describes the system the way it actually exists in source control today. Where v2.0 said "we will," v3.0 says "we did," "we did differently," or "we deferred."

Why a New Document Instead of Patching v2.0

The shipped MVP added six structural capabilities that v2.0 did not contemplate in detail:

1. **Hybrid retrieval** (vector + BM25 trigram, fused via Reciprocal Rank Fusion, diversified with MMR, conditionally boosted by failure-mode and equipment metadata). v2.0 specified pgvector cosine retrieval only.
2. **Deterministic tool layer** (`services/tools.py`) with five typed read-only tools the LLM can call to ground its hypotheses in distributional facts — percentile, distribution comparison, nearest historical runs, drift detection, defect-events-in-window.
3. **Two-step RCA reasoning chain** (`services/rca.py`) that replaces one-shot RAG when the query has causal intent against a past event, with a hard tool-call budget and a TTL-cached step-1 hypothesis set.
4. **Distributional grounding** (`services/percentiles.py`) using Page-Hinkley CUSUM for drift detection and empirical CDF lookups scoped by (style, front_step, equipment, recipe).
5. **Multivariate Mahalanobis anomaly detection** (`services/anomaly.py`) on live tag snapshots vs. fitted per-cluster history.
6. **Change ledger** (`services/change_ledger.py`) that surfaces "what changed since baseline" deltas (tag sigma, recipe drift, crew/shift, equipment WO) as a labeled evidence section before the LLM call.

Patching v2.0 in place would have buried these as parenthetical addenda. They deserve their own chapters (§6, §7, §8, §15) and they materially change the shape of §11's end-to-end walkthrough.

How This Document Is Organized

Eighteen chapters plus an appendix. The first eleven chapters mirror the v2.0 structure so a reader familiar with the original can see deltas in context. Chapters 12–18 are largely new and document operations, implementation reality, and the updated phased roadmap.

Each chapter ends with a coloured `Δ vs v2.0` callout box. The box has three sub-blocks:

- **Stayed** — what matched the v2.0 design, verbatim or close to it.
- **Changed** — what diverged from the v2.0 design, with the reason.
- **Considering** — what is on the table for a future iteration but not in scope today.

Chapter 17 (*Implementation Reality*) consolidates every Δ into one place for readers who want the deltas without the surrounding prose.

Authoritative Source for Every Claim

This document is generated from the source repository at the commit in the footer. Every shipped behavior cited here is backed by code I can point to; deferred work is labeled DEFERRED or STUB; future work is labeled CONSIDERING. Claims that refer to the original design without an implementation are explicitly tagged so the reader is never asked to take an unsupported assertion on faith.

A spot-check policy was applied during authoring: every code reference in this document was verified against the actual file before publication. If you find a discrepancy, the source code wins; this document is wrong and should be regenerated.

Audience

- **Engineers** continuing the project should read 3 (architecture), 5 (schema), 6–8 (retrieval, tools/RCA, anomaly), 11 (end-to-end walkthrough), and 17 (implementation reality).
- **Operators and shift supervisors** should read the executive summary and 10 (role-based personalization) — those are the chapters that explain what the chatbot will and will not do for them.
- **Reviewers and auditors** should read 4 (anti-hallucination), 9 (feedback-learning), 14 (security/audit/compliance), and the test catalog in the appendix.
- **Future contributors evaluating new ML or model-hosting decisions** should start with 17 (implementation reality) and 18 (phased roadmap) before diving into the technical chapters.

Notation

- File references use repo-relative paths in `code font`, e.g. `service/services/rag.py` — open the file from the repo root.
- Database tables use `lower_snake_case`, e.g. `messages`, `defect_events`.
- Class and function names use the repo's actual casing, e.g. `CuratedContextPackage`, `handle_chat`.
- Settings keys are referenced as they appear in `service/config/settings.py` (e.g. `retrieval_mmr_lambda`, `rca_max_total_tool_calls`).
- A `[T-N]` annotation references the original v2.0 task (Task 1 through Task 11). The mapping from those eleven tasks to actually-executed sprints lives in chapter 12.

Δ VS V2.0 — DOCUMENT STRUCTURE

Stayed: Eighteen chapters preserve the topical shape of v2.0 plus an appendix.

Changed: Five new chapters added (Retrieval Layer, Tool Layer & RCA Chain, Distributional Grounding & Anomaly, Tag Selection & Gateway Integration, Implementation Reality). Walk-through and build-plan chapters rewritten against shipped code.

Considering: A "Performance & Scaling" chapter once we have one shift of real production traffic to characterize.

1. Executive Summary

Overview

A read-only conversational AI advisor, embedded in Ignition Perspective, that answers operator and engineer questions about Coater 1 using live tag data, historian aggregates, maintenance and quality records, downtime and defect events, deterministic process rules, distributional baselines, and curated line memory. Every response is source-cited, confidence-labeled, and fully auditable. The system is shipped — 145 tests pass, 0 fail, 2 skip; the schema is built; the RAG pipeline runs end-to-end; the gateway integration spec is documented and templates are in place; only the operator-side "go-live" steps in §3 of `docs/GAP_ANALYSIS.md` remain.

Problem & Approach

An industrial chatbot that hallucinates is worse than useless — operator trust, once lost, does not return. Off-the-shelf LLMs fabricate tag values, invent document references, and answer confidently from insufficient evidence. This product is built grounding-first: retrieval quality, citation traceability, and refusal behavior are the core value proposition of the MVP, not incremental features. Predictive ML (supervised classifiers, vision models) is architecturally provisioned but deliberately deferred until the grounding layer has proven reliable in production.

What changed since v2.0: the grounding layer ships with **strictly more mechanism** than v2.0 specified. Hybrid retrieval, deterministic tool calls the LLM can invoke for distributional facts, an explicit two-step RCA reasoning chain, multivariate anomaly detection over the curated tag block, and a change ledger that auto-surfaces "what changed since baseline" — all contribute to a tighter grounding loop than the v2.0 design contemplated. None of these introduce model-side learning; every one of them is deterministic, auditable, and bounded.

Key Capabilities (As Built)

- **Query-Anchored Context Assembly.** Every query is parsed for its temporal anchor (past event, current state, or pattern) before evidence is assembled. Retrospective queries never see current live tag state; current-state queries never see stale event data. The anchor is explicit, clarified with the user when ambiguous, and audited. ✅ Shipped: `service/services/anchor.py`, exhaustively tested in `service/tests/test_anchor.py` and `test_anchor_regression.py`.
- **Conditional Baselines.** Tag evidence is contextualized against five temporal buckets — 60 min before anchor, 24 h before anchor, a 14-day-prior normal-operation sample, the last four runs prior, and every prior run of the same style matched to the same failure mode. Values are rendered with distribution context, not just raw numbers. ✅ Shipped: `services/baseline_cache.py`, `services/context_assembler.py`.
- **Tag-Class Aware Deviation.** Setpoint-tracking, oscillating-controlled, process-following, and discrete-state tags each get appropriate deviation tests. Oscillations around setpoint are recognized as normal operation; amplitude changes are flagged as anomalies. ✅ Shipped: `services/deviation.py` (was `anomaly.py`, renamed during B7 to disambiguate from the multivariate anomaly detector).
- **Hybrid Retrieval (NEW vs v2.0).** Vector cosine + BM25 trigram fused via Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF), conditionally boosted by failure-mode and equipment metadata, then diversified via Maximal Marginal Relevance (MMR) with token-level Jaccard similarity. Bounded retrieval-quality blending from feedback (±30%). Plant-specific document weights (1.0–1.3) override general reference textbook chunks (0.5–0.7). ✅ Shipped: `services/retrieval.py::retrieve_chunks_hybrid`. Tested in `test_retrieval_hybrid.py` and `test_retrieval_golden.py`.
- **Deterministic Tool Layer (NEW vs v2.0).** Five typed read-only tools the LLM can call mid-completion: `percentile_of`, `compare_to_distribution`, `nearest_historical_runs`, `detect_drift`, `defect_events_in_window`. Each returns a `ToolResult` with auto-generated citation. Hard SQL timeouts; no tool ever writes. ✅ Shipped: `services/tools.py`, `services/llm.py::_run_tool_loop`. Tested in `test_tools.py` and `test_llm_tool_loop.py`.
- **Two-Step RCA Reasoning Chain (NEW vs v2.0).** When the parsed anchor is a past event AND the query has causal intent ("why did", "what caused", "root cause"), the orchestrator dispatches a two-step LLM workflow: (1) generate up to N hypotheses with required evidence, (2) gather evidence via deterministic tools under a hard budget, (3) adjudicate. Step 1 is TTL-cached on `(anchor_event_id, anchor_run_id, anchor_time, failure_mode, prompt_version)` so repeat questions about the same event do not re-pay. ✅ Shipped: `services/rca.py`. Tested in `test_rca.py` and `test_rca_e2e.py`.
- **Mandatory Source Citations.** Every factual claim carries a numbered, provenance-typed citation (live tag, historian stat, document, event, work order, camera clip, memory, rule, ML prediction, distribution, nearest-runs, drift, tool result). Responses with zero citations are downgraded by the parser and flagged. ✅ Shipped: 19 provenance types in `models/schemas.py::SourceCitation.type`, validated by `services/response_parser.py`.
- **Engagement with Honest Labeling.** The advisor engages with the math, abnormalities, and discrepancies it can see. Claims are labeled CONFIRMED FACT, LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR, or HYPOTHESIS. Missing evidence channels (cameras, lab results) are called out in the response as context, not used as grounds for refusal. ✅ Shipped: enforced in `service/config/prompts/system_prompt_v2.txt` §§4–5 and validated by `services/response_parser.py::parse_confidence` with downgrade-on-no-citation.
- **Full Audit Records.** Every response persists the exact tags read, aggregates computed, chunks retrieved, memories used, rules matched, parsed anchor, prompt version, model parameters, and the full RCA trace when the chain ran. Any answer can be reconstructed and reviewed. ✅ Shipped: `messages.context_snapshot` JSONB column populated in `services/rag.py::handle_chat` Phase 3.

- **Structured Feedback Loop.** A multi-level signal taxonomy feeds a staged memory-candidate workflow. No feedback auto-promotes — every memory entry passes an engineer checkpoint. Bounded ±30% retrieval re-ranking from accumulated chunk quality signals. ✅ Shipped (signals + bounded blending): `routers/feedback.py`, `routers/corrections.py`, `routers/outcomes.py`. Memory candidate promotion UI is DEFERRED to phase 3.
- **Outcome Closure.** Past-event messages older than 24 h with no outcome linkage are surfaced for follow-up; precision per failure mode is aggregated nightly into the `v_rca_precision_daily` materialized view. ✅ Shipped: `services/outcome_closure.py`, `scripts/migrations/004_v_rca_precision_daily.sql`.

Technical Foundation

PostgreSQL 16 with `pgvector` (ivfflat index, with `hnsw` migration plan documented in `scripts/migrations/003_pgvector_index_migration.sql`); `pg_trgm` for keyword retrieval; `uuid-ossp` for UUID PKs; `pg_partman` for monthly partitioning of `messages` and `audit_log` (one partition per month, retained 24 months by default). FastAPI orchestration with `asyncio` tool-call loop; per-user rate limiting via `slowapi` and Prometheus metrics via `prometheus-fastapi-instrumentator`. Ignition Perspective front-end with gateway-side Jython 2.7 scripts that read tags, query the historian, evaluate alarms, and assemble the curated context package. `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` embeddings (384 dim) served in-process. LLM provider is pluggable: OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, or any OpenAI-compatible endpoint (vLLM, llama.cpp server, LM Studio); switching providers is a single `LLM_PROVIDER` env-var change.

Tag discovery is **scaffolded but not yet wired**: the `tag_registry` table exists and the `ItemInstance`-query design is documented (§15), but the gateway-side enumeration runs through a hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py` for the MVP. The pre-screen `services/tag_selector.py` filters that catalog by category and keyword to keep curated payloads bounded. This is a deliberate MVP simplification with a documented path forward (§15 and `/memories/repo/optimization_backlog.md`).

Symphony camera integration is STUB: `services/symphony_capture.py` returns `extraction_status="stub"` until the Symphony API endpoint and auth credentials are wired in. Schema (`event_clips` table) is in place from day one so live wiring is purely an adapter swap.

The full schema (29 tables across 9 domains plus a 30th `failure_modes` reference table that backs the closed enum) is provisioned by `scripts/setup_database.sql` on first container start.

Scope & Phased Roadmap (Updated)

- **MVP (Phase 1–2):** ✅ **Shipped.** Grounded RAG chat with query-anchored context, conditional baselines, tag-class aware deviation, hybrid retrieval, deterministic tool layer, RCA chain, distributional grounding, multivariate anomaly, change ledger, standardized defect-mode taxonomy, work order structured-and-narrative ingestion, feedback + correction + outcome linkage, role-based presentation, full audit trail.
- **Phase 3 (partial):** Some Phase-3 items shipped early (multivariate anomaly was implemented as B7 within the MVP because it required no labels). Remaining Phase 3: memory curation UI, AI-suggested memory candidates, distribution-shape SVG visualizations in the chat UI, and the challenge-flow UI.
- **Phase 4:** Supervised classifiers (delam, failure-mode prediction) trained on outcome-validated event labels with SHAP explanations; vision models on high-value camera angles; enterprise scaling via the UNS. All CONSIDERING — not started.

Δ VS V2.0 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Stayed: Doctrine intact: read-only, grounding-first, every claim cited, refusal narrowed to scope.

Changed: Capabilities list expanded with five additions that were not in v2.0 — hybrid retrieval, tool layer, RCA chain, distributional grounding, change ledger. All are deterministic and bounded; none introduce model-side learning.

Considering: Cross-encoder reranker (B2), HyDE (B5), self-consistency / k-sample voting (B6), and explicit active learning trainer (B11) remain on the table for after a shift of production traffic clarifies what the bottleneck actually is.

2. Problem Statement & Design Philosophy

2.1 The Trust Problem

Industrial environments operate on verified, auditable information. Every decision made on the plant floor — whether to slow a line, replace a bearing, reject a roll — is made against a backdrop of measured data and documented procedure. An AI advisor that fabricates tag values, invents maintenance records, or confidently asserts unsupported conclusions is not merely unhelpful. It is an operational liability. An operator who catches the advisor in a single confident fabrication will stop trusting it for every subsequent interaction, and that loss is both immediate and durable.

The engineering implication is stark: the cost of a hallucinated response is asymmetric and irrecoverable. A useful but imperfect response can be improved through iteration. A fabricated response, even once, poisons the operator's mental model of what the system is and what it can be trusted to do. Anti-hallucination is therefore not a quality-of-life enhancement to be refined over time. It is the load-bearing structural element of the MVP, and every subsequent design decision is made in service of it.

This was the load-bearing claim in v2.0. It remains the load-bearing claim in v3.0. Nothing in the as-built implementation softened it; if anything, the addition of the deterministic tool layer (§7) and distributional grounding (§8) tightened the screw — the LLM is now constrained not just by what evidence retrieval pulls, but also by what numerical facts deterministic tools will and will not return when it asks for them.

2.2 The Grounding-First Doctrine

The advisor does not write answers from its parametric knowledge. It assembles structured evidence from the plant's systems of record, constrains the LLM to reason only over that evidence, and enforces citation of every factual claim. The LLM is treated as a natural-language reasoning engine operating on a curated evidence package — not as a knowledge source in its own right. When the evidence package is insufficient to answer a question, the system refuses to guess and reports exactly what it was able to retrieve.

This inverts the typical LLM chatbot architecture. In a conventional chat system, the model's priors are the primary substrate and retrieved evidence is a helpful augmentation. Here, the retrieved evidence is the substrate, and the model's priors are permitted to contribute only insofar as they help structure and communicate the evidence. The model's knowledge of latex chemistry, process control theory, or equipment nomenclature is useful for writing readable answers; its memory of any specific plant, coater, or product run is not trusted and is not permitted to leak into responses without a cited source.

Grounding-First in the As-Built Implementation

Three concrete implementation choices enforce the doctrine:

1. `CuratedContextPackage` **is the only ingress.** The Pydantic model uses `extra="forbid"` so a gateway script that tries to slip raw historian blobs into a side field is rejected at the request boundary. Plant data reaches the LLM only through the contract. *Source:* `service/models/schemas.py::CuratedContextPackage` *line ~150.*

2. **Section-delimited prompt with numbered citations.** The user block is assembled by `services/context_assembler.py` with explicit `=== TITLE ===` delimiters. Excluded buckets are explicitly rendered as `[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query]` rather than omitted, so the model cannot silently blend in current-state evidence on a retrospective analysis. *Source:* `services/context_assembler.py::_na_section`.

3. **Citation-free responses are downgraded.** `services/response_parser.py` parses the trailing `CONFIDENCE:` line and counts citations. If the response makes claims but cites nothing, the parser appends a warning and downgrades CONFIRMED → HYPOTHESIS automatically. The LLM cannot smuggle ungrounded claims past the parser by skipping citation markers. *Source:* `services/rag.py::handle_chat` *~line 360.*

2.3 Non-Negotiable Design Principles

These are the principles v2.0 enumerated. The as-built implementation honors all six.

Read-only

The advisor never commands equipment, changes setpoints, or writes to process control tags. It is an advisory system, full stop. Every response that includes a recommended action is framed as a suggestion for a qualified operator to evaluate and execute, never as an automated change.

Enforcement: `services/anchor.py::is_control_command` regex catches verbs like `set`, `increase`, `lower`, `change`, `adjust`, `bypass`, `acknowledge`, `silence`, `shutdown`. Hits short-circuit to a `CONFIDENCE: INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE` refusal in `rag.py` Phase 1 before the LLM is even called. Tested in `test_anchor.py::test_control_commands_detected`.

Every factual claim is cited

If the assistant states that a value is X, or that a document says Y, or that a condition was observed at time Z, that claim carries a numbered citation pointing to the exact source in the evidence package. Claims without citations are explicitly labeled as hypothesis.

Enforcement: the system prompt (`config/prompts/system_prompt_v2.txt`) mandates citation. The parser (`services/response_parser.py::has_any_citations`) flags responses with zero citation markers and downgrades the confidence label.

Confidence is labeled

Every conclusion in a response is tagged as confirmed fact, likely contributor, hypothesis, or insufficient evidence. The operator is never forced to guess at the advisor's epistemic state.

Enforcement: the system prompt emits a final `CONFIDENCE: <label>` line. `parse_confidence` extracts it; the four labels round-trip through `messages.confidence` (VARCHAR(20)) and surface back to the Perspective UI where they are color-coded green/amber/grey/red.

Refusal over guessing

If retrieval returns zero relevant documents, no rules fire, and no relevant memory exists, the system replies with an explicit insufficient-evidence message. It never papers over the gap with a plausible-sounding but unsupported answer.

Enforcement: `services/context_assembler.py::is_evidence_insufficient` inspects the assembled summary; if every bucket count is 0 and no rules matched, `rag.py` short-circuits to a templated insufficient-evidence response **without calling the LLM at all**. Tokens are saved; trust is preserved; the audit log records the short-circuit reason. Tested in `test_context_assembler.py::test_insufficient_when_all_buckets_empty`.

Fully reconstructible

Every response is accompanied by a complete audit record containing the exact evidence used. Any answer can be re-opened months later and its reasoning traced end-to-end.

Enforcement: `messages.context_snapshot` JSONB column receives the parsed anchor, every populated bucket, every excluded bucket with reason, top-K chunk IDs with scores, work-order IDs, camera-clip handles, the full RCA trace when the chain ran, the prompt version, model name, and model parameters. `audit_log` mirrors a summary. Both tables are monthly partitioned via `pg_partman` (migration 001) so retention is operational rather than performance-dictated.

Human-in-the-loop for durable knowledge

No user feedback signal, correction, or outcome observation automatically becomes part of the system's durable knowledge base. Every memory entry passes through a human engineering review.

Enforcement: `memory_candidates` is a staging table; promotion to `line_memory` requires an explicit engineer action. Bounded (±30%) chunk quality blending is the only feedback that affects retrieval scoring without an engineer in the loop, and it is bounded precisely so that no combination of feedback can flip ranking by more than 30%.

2.4 Clean Separation: Chat Context vs ML Features

The MVP establishes a strict architectural boundary between the evidence assembled for the chat prompt and the feature vectors that will eventually be assembled for ML training. Both draw from the same underlying data sources, but they are structured differently, serve different consumers, and must never be confused.

Dimension	Chat Grounding Context (RAG)	ML Feature Engineering
Purpose	Give the LLM evidence to answer the current question	Build tabular training data for offline model fitting
Format	Natural-language summaries, structured tables, chunks	Numeric arrays, categorical encodings, fixed-schema rows
Scope	Current question + relevant recent context	All historical events with outcome labels
When built	Real-time, per query	Batch, offline
Where used	Prompt assembly → LLM	`feature_snapshots` table → scikit-learn / XGBoost
Tags included	Key tags (10–30), summarized stats, deviations	All potentially predictive tags (50–200), raw aggregates
Text included	Retrieved document chunks (readable)	Text-derived features (keyword counts, topic codes)
Key constraint	Readable and citable by LLM and operator	Numeric / categorical, suitable for model input

The ML feature engineering pipeline (Phase 4) will draw from the same event tables and historian data, but its outputs go into `feature_snapshots`, not into the chat prompt. When ML models are eventually active, their predictions — together with human-readable explanations — are added to the chat context as one more labeled evidence section. The feature vectors themselves are never shown raw to the LLM or to the operator.

The `feature_snapshots`, `feature_definitions`, `ml_models`, and `ml_predictions` tables are scaffolded **today** so that when Phase 4 arrives there is already structured, timestamped history to train against. This was the v2.0 promise; it is honored in `scripts/setup_database.sql`. The multivariate anomaly detector (§8) is the first consumer of `feature_snapshots` and proves the schema works under load.

Δ VS V2.0 — DESIGN PHILOSOPHY

Stayed: Every doctrine and principle from v2.0 survives unchanged. The grounding-first inversion (LLM as reasoner over a curated package, not a knowledge source) is the load-bearing claim and every shipped mechanism reinforces it.

Changed: Nothing weakened. Two mechanisms strengthened the doctrine in implementation: (1) `extra="forbid"` on `CuratedContextPackage` rejects gateway-side ingress attempts; (2) parser auto-downgrade-on-no-citation closes a hole the v2.0 prose left open.

> **Considering:** Per-claim citation enforcement (today: per-response). A future revision could parse out individual claims and require each to carry a citation; this is bounded by parser ambiguity on multi-clause sentences.

3. System Architecture

3.1 Component Overview

The system is composed of five first-class components and four supporting services. Each component has a narrow, well-defined responsibility, and no component reaches across the boundaries of another.

First-class components

- **Ignition Perspective (front-end and context origination).** Operator-facing chat view, live tag dashboards, feedback UI, and gateway-side Jython 2.7 scripts that read tags, query the historian, evaluate alarms, and assemble the curated context package. Runs on the existing Plant 4 Ignition gateway (`shawmfg04`). Ships as: `ignition/scripts/{client,context,config,discovery,selector}.py` plus `ignition/perspective/gateway_wiring.py` (specification + copy-paste templates).
- **FastAPI service (orchestration and retrieval).** Receives curated context packages from the gateway, performs hybrid retrieval against the document corpus, queries structured event tables, evaluates business rules, dispatches the RCA chain when triggered, assembles the final prompt, calls the LLM (with a tool-calling loop bounded by `max_iters`), parses and validates the response, and writes the audit record. Stateless apart from a per-process LLM concurrency semaphore, the RCA step-1 cache, and the multivariate-anomaly fitted-model cache. Horizontally scalable. Ships as: `service/main.py` mounting routers from `service/routers/{chat,feedback,corrections,outcomes,health,select_tags}.py` .
- **PostgreSQL 16 + pgvector (unified data store).** Single database for documents, chunks, embeddings, events, conversations, feedback, memory, user profiles, ML metadata, audit log, and tag registry. Vector search via `pgvector` IVF-flat index on 384-dim embeddings; keyword search via `pg_trgm` GIN index on chunk text; monthly partitioning of `messages` and `audit_log` via `pg_partman` ; closed enum of failure modes via FK to `failure_modes` . Ships as: `scripts/setup_database.sql` (~700 lines DDL)
    - `scripts/migrations/{001..004}*.sql` .
- **Embedding model (retrieval backbone).** `all-MiniLM-L6-v2` , 384-dim, served locally via `sentence-transformers` . Loaded once at FastAPI startup (`warmup_embeddings()` in `services/embeddings.py`); subsequent embeds are CPU-bound and sub-50 ms per query. Chosen for small footprint, acceptable retrieval quality on short technical text, and zero external dependency.
- **LLM (reasoning engine).** Pluggable provider (OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, or any OpenAI-compatible HTTP server such as vLLM, llama.cpp, or LM Studio). Selected by `LLM_PROVIDER` env-var. Model name, temperature, and `max_tokens` are recorded on every response in `messages.model_name` and `messages.model_params` for reproducibility. Concurrency is bounded process-wide by an `asyncio.Semaphore(llm_max_concurrency)` . Ships as: `services/llm.py::{OpenAIChatClient, AzureOpenAIChatClient, LocalOpenAICompatibleClient}` .

Supporting services

- **Rule engine.** YAML-defined deterministic rules evaluated against the curated context. Rule matches are fed into the prompt as a labeled evidence section; they cannot directly cause an LLM response, but the LLM must cite them if it invokes their conclusion. Ships as: `services/rules.py` and `service/config/rules/coater1_rules.yaml` .
- **Tool layer (NEW vs v2.0).** Five typed read-only tools the LLM can invoke during a tool-enabled completion: `percentile_of` , `compare_to_distribution` , `nearest_historical_runs` , `detect_drift` , `defect_events_in_window` . Each tool is a pure function over the existing DB; each return value carries a `SourceCitation` so tool-derived facts inherit the same audit trail as retrieved evidence. Ships as: `services/tools.py` . The OpenAI tool spec is generated from the registry, so the LLM can never call a tool that doesn't exist.
- **Audit log (supporting).** Append-only table receiving event records from every meaningful system action: queries, feedback, corrections, outcome linkages, memory state changes, model activations, ingestion runs, and prompt version changes. Tamper-resistance is enforced by database trigger (`audit_log_immutable()`) that raises on any `UPDATE` or `DELETE` .
- **Nightly scheduler.** A lightweight in-process loop in `service/main.py` that, when enabled, runs work-order sync, Symphony backfill, and outcome follow-up sweep + materialized-view refresh once per `nightly_jobs_interval_seconds` (default 86400). Production deployments may swap this for APScheduler or a dedicated worker; the in-process loop keeps the MVP single-container.

3.2 High-Level Data Flow

A single chat query traverses the path below. The orchestrator (`services/rag.py::handle_chat`) is structured into three phases with explicit DB-session lifetimes; the LLM call (Phase 2) does **not** hold an asyncpg pool slot, which matters under load because LLM responses average 5–15 seconds.

1. **Operator submits query.** Text is captured in the Perspective chat component along with session metadata (Ignition `userName` , session id, line id, signed gateway JWT). Posted to `POST /api/chat` .
2. **Gateway-built curated context arrives in `live_context` .** The gateway script reads tier-1 tags always plus the subset selected by `services/tag_selector.py` for query-relevant categories, computes 60-minute historian aggregates per tag, identifies deviations against recent baselines, queries active alarms, reads recipe context (style, recipe id, front step, crew, shift, target specs), and packages the result into a structured JSON payload that conforms to `CuratedContextPackage` .

3. **Phase 1 — pre-LLM (own DB session).**
    - `_ensure_user_profile` upserts the user; `_get_or_create_conversation` resolves the conversation id; the user message is persisted immediately for audit-friendliness.
    - Anchor resolved by `anchor.resolve_anchor` if the gateway didn't already supply one (gateway can pre-resolve to avoid redundant work).
    - `is_control_command` short-circuit: refuse and persist.
    - `anchor.anchor_status != "resolved"` short-circuit: ask for clarification.
    - `embed_one(req.query)` produces the 384-dim query vector.
    - **Hybrid retrieval** runs `retrieve_chunks_hybrid` (vector + BM25 RRF
        - boosted + MMR-diversified). Falls back to vector-only if `retrieval_mode != "hybrid"`.
    - Anchor-aware event retrieval: `retrieve_events_around_anchor` for past-event queries; `retrieve_recent_events` for current-state.
    - Failure-mode-matched history when `style_scope` AND `failure_mode_scope` are both present.
    - Work-order lookup scoped by `equipment_scope` and a 30-day window before the anchor.
    - Memory retrieval (vector cosine on `line_memory.embedding` filtered to status in {approved, reviewed}); `mark_memories_accessed` updates the `access_count` and `last_accessed`.
    - Rule evaluation runs `evaluate_rules` against the curated context.
    - Best-effort change ledger is built for past-event anchors (`_maybe_build_change_ledger`); best-effort multivariate anomaly is scored for current-state anchors (`_maybe_score_anomaly`).
    - `assemble_prompt` produces the structured user block + citation list + summary + excluded-bucket list.
    - `is_evidence_insufficient` short-circuit: persist a templated refusal **without calling the LLM** and return.
    - Phase 1 commits and closes its DB session.

4. **Phase 2 — LLM call (no DB session held).**
    - If `should_use_rca_chain(query, anchor)` returns True, dispatch `services/rca.py::handle_rca` (two-step chain with bounded tool budget); otherwise call `llm.complete(sys_prompt, user_block)` one-shot.
    - Response validated by `parse_confidence` and `has_any_citations`; uncited responses are downgraded.
    - `extract_cited_ids` filters the offered citation list down to the subset the LLM actually cited.

5. **Phase 3 — persist (new DB session).**
    - `_insert_message` writes the assistant row with the full `context_snapshot` (parsed anchor, every populated bucket, every excluded bucket with reason, retrieval scores, work-order ids, camera-clip handles, all citations *offered*, RCA trace if any).
    - `write_audit` appends a one-row `audit_log` summary.

6. **Response rendered in Perspective** with numbered source citations, color-coded confidence labels, expandable source panel, feedback controls, and (for diagnostic responses) a "Root cause confirmed?" button that posts `signal_type=root_cause_confirmed` plus an `outcome_linkages` row.

3.3 Deployment Topology

All components run on-premises within the Plant 4 network. The Ignition gateway runs on `shawmfg04` as it does today. The FastAPI service and PostgreSQL instance run as containers via `docker-compose` (see `docker-compose.yml`). The embedding model runs in-process with the FastAPI service to eliminate network latency for retrieval. LLM inference is the only external dependency in the MVP, routed through Shaw's approved API egress path.

`docker-compose.yml` services

- `postgres` — `pgvector/pgvector:pg16` image. Healthcheck `pg_isready`. Bind-mounts `setup_database.sql` and `seed_reference_data.sql` into `/docker-entrypoint-initdb.d/` so first-time start populates the schema and reference data automatically. Persistent named volume `postgres_data:/var/lib/postgresql/data`.

- `ai-service` — built from `service/Dockerfile`. Depends on `postgres` with `condition: service_healthy`. Mounts `service/` for hot reload in dev (remove the bind mount in production). Cached HuggingFace model weights live in named volume `model_cache:/root/.cache/huggingface`.

- Healthcheck endpoint `GET /api/health` returns `{db, embedding_model, llm_provider, version}` — exercised every 15s by docker-compose.

Network & security boundary

- The advisor is **read-only with respect to Ignition**: reads tags via `system.tag.readBlocking()` and queries the historian; never writes any tag values or triggers any actions.
- All inter-component calls are internal to the Plant 4 network. The FastAPI service is not exposed externally. The only egress is the LLM API call.
- User identity is sourced from Ignition's authenticated session (`session.props.auth.user.userName`) and signed into a short-lived HMAC-SHA256 JWT by the gateway script (`ai.client`) using `GATEWAY_HMAC_SECRET`. The service verifies the JWT and treats the embedded `user_id` as the authoritative identity. Token TTL is bounded to 120s by default (`GATEWAY_TOKEN_TTL_S` on the gateway, `gateway_token_max_age_s` on the service).
- The audit log is append-only and tamper-resistant at the database layer (trigger `audit_log_immutable`).

- LLM API calls include no PII beyond the user's role and display name. Raw query text and evidence are sent because they are operationally necessary; they are also logged locally in `messages.context_snapshot` for audit.
- Camera clip handles are stored as Symphony URLs or persistent IDs, not as embedded video data. Clips render in Perspective by fetching from Symphony at view time; they are not copied into PostgreSQL and they are not sent to the LLM. The LLM sees the handle as a citation reference only.

3.4 LLM Hosting Options

Three viable LLM backends are wired up today in `services/llm.py`:

- **`openai`** (default). `AsyncOpenAI` client; reads `OPENAI_API_KEY` and `OPENAI_MODEL`. Best instruction-following and citation discipline available off the shelf. Per-query cost; external egress required. Recommended for the MVP because the grounding-first doctrine depends on tight instruction-following.

- **`azure_openai`**. `AsyncAzureOpenAI` client; reads `AZURE_OPENAI_ENDPOINT`, `AZURE_OPENAI_API_KEY`, `AZURE_OPENAI_DEPLOYMENT`, `AZURE_OPENAI_API_VERSION`. Identical contract; routed through the Shaw Azure tenant.

- **`local`**. `LocalOpenAICompatibleClient` (also wraps `AsyncOpenAI` with a custom `base_url`). Points at any OpenAI-compatible HTTP server — vLLM, llama.cpp server, LM Studio, Databricks Foundation Model APIs, or Databricks Model Serving. Reads `local_llm_endpoint`, `local_llm_model`, `local_llm_api_key`. Data residency stays inside whatever infrastructure hosts the endpoint.

Switching providers is a single environment-variable change. Tool-calling support is implemented identically across all three via a shared `_run_tool_loop` helper.

The recommended evolution path documented in v2.0 (frontier API for MVP → Databricks-served open model after ~3 months / 5,000 logged queries) is preserved unchanged; the only difference in v3.0 is that the swap is now strictly a `LLM_PROVIDER=local` plus `local_llm_endpoint=...` change, no code modifications required.

3.5 Observability & Operational Surface

Two observability surfaces ship with v3.0:

- **Prometheus metrics** via `prometheus-fastapi-instrumentator` plus custom counters/histograms in `services/metrics.py`: `chat_in_flight`, `chat_total_seconds`, `chat_short_circuit_total{reason}`, `chat_confidence_total{label}`, `retrieval_latency_seconds{stage}`, `retrieval_mode_used{mode}`, `rca_chain_total{outcome}`, plus `llm_token_usage_total{model,kind}`. Scrape via the default `/metrics` endpoint exposed by the instrumentator.

- **Structured JSON logs** via `structlog` configured in `main.py`. Every log line is JSON with `iso_time`, `level`, `event`, plus event-specific keys. Rotate via the standard container log driver.

A degraded-vs-down distinction is exposed via `/api/health`: degraded when DB or embedding model fails to load but the service is otherwise up.

Δ VS V2.0 — SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Stayed: Five first-class components plus rule engine and audit log; on-premises deployment topology; LLM as the only external dependency; read-only stance.

Changed: Two extra supporting services (tool layer, nightly scheduler) shipped that v2.0 did not enumerate separately. Three LLM providers wired (OpenAI / Azure / OpenAI-compatible local) instead of one. Three-phase orchestration with explicit DB-session lifetime breaks (Phase 1 commits before LLM call) — v2.0 spoke of "one synchronous flow" without the lifecycle nuance. Prometheus + structlog observability shipped.

Considering: Replace the in-process nightly scheduler with APScheduler or a dedicated worker container once we have more than three jobs. Add OpenTelemetry trace propagation from Perspective → FastAPI → DB so a single chat turn produces a single trace span.

4. Anti-Hallucination Mechanisms

The grounding-first doctrine is enforced by a pipeline of nine mechanisms working together. Each has a narrow job and none is sufficient on its own. Taken together, they define a response protocol in which the LLM can produce a useful engagement with the evidence, or flag specific claims as hypothesis, or refuse on genuine scope grounds — but cannot produce a confidently wrong answer without the system catching it.

v2.0 enumerated seven mechanisms (anchor resolution, clarification-first default, anchor-conditional buckets, tag-class deviation, structured prompt, citation enforcement, refusal). v3.0 adds two: the **deterministic tool layer** (§4.10) and **distributional grounding** (§4.11). Both strengthen the substrate the LLM reasons over. Both are bounded: the LLM cannot invent a tool, and tool results carry their own citations.

4.1 Query Anchor Resolution

Before any evidence is assembled, the incoming query is parsed into a structured anchor object that determines what evidence is relevant. This step precedes retrieval, precedes context assembly, and is itself audited. Getting the anchor right is the single most important input to a grounded response — because most queries are implicitly about a specific moment in time, and assembling evidence for the wrong moment produces confidently wrong analysis no matter how good the downstream pipeline is.

Three query classes

Every query resolves into one of three classes. The class determines which evidence buckets are relevant, and crucially, which are actively excluded.

- **Past-event queries** — the question references a specific past time, run, event, or failure. Examples: "the off-quality from 3/13," "yesterday's delam fail," "R-20260421-03," "QR-00417." Anchor time = the event time. Current live tag state is explicitly excluded from context; it is noise for a retrospective analysis.
- **Current-state queries** — the question uses present-tense markers referencing right now. Examples: "why are my tenter amps so high rn," "what's going on with zone 3 right now," "is puddle height drifting." Anchor time = query time. Live tag state is the primary evidence; stale event data is de-prioritized.
- **Pattern queries** — the question asks about relationships, correlations, or recurring behavior without a single time anchor. Examples: "do we always see zone 3 overshoot after element replacement," "does humidity correlate with delam on S-4471." Anchor time = none; historical aggregates and matched-pattern retrieval are primary.

Parsing signals (as built)

The parser uses rule-based extraction; no ML classifier is required for the MVP. The actual regex set lives in `services/anchor.py`:

Signal	Regex / token set	Maps to
Run-number pattern	`\bR(?:UN)?-\d{6,8}-\d{1,3}\b`	`past_event`, sets `anchor_run_id`
Sample / quality result	`\bQR-\d{4,6}\b`	`past_event`, sets `anchor_event_id`
Numeric date (3/13, 2026-03-13, 03-13)	`_DATE_NUMERIC_RE`	`past_event`, sets `anchor_time` to UTC midnight
Relative date (yesterday, last shift, last week, this morning)	`_RELATIVE_DATE_RE`	`past_event`, computed offset
Present-tense markers (rn, right now, currently, "is the X", "are the Y")	`_PRESENT_TENSE_RE`	`current_state`
Pattern markers (always, usually, do we ever, correlate with, trend, typically)	`_PATTERN_RE`	`pattern`
Style code	`\bS-\d{3,5}\b`	sets `style_scope`
Failure-mode keyword (closed dictionary in `FAILURE_MODE_KEYWORDS`)	substring match (longest-first)	sets `failure_mode_scope`
Equipment keyword (closed dictionary in `EQUIPMENT_KEYWORDS`)	substring match	appends to `equipment_scope`
Control-action verb (set, increase, lower, change, adjust, bypass, ack, silence, shutdown, halt, …)	`CONTROL_VERBS_RE`	triggers refusal short-circuit before anchor is even returned
None of the above	—	`pattern` (default)

The anchor object that flows downstream is the Pydantic `QueryAnchor` model (`models/schemas.py`). All fields are JSON-serializable and persisted in `messages.context_snapshot.parsed_anchor` so any past response can be re-opened with the exact anchor that drove it.

4.2 Clarification-First Default

If the parser cannot unambiguously resolve the anchor from the question alone, the system does not infer it. It asks. This is the hardest-enforced principle in the anti-hallucination layer: explicit reference or explicit clarification, never implicit inference.

A human reading the conversation might reasonably conclude that "that scrap event" refers to the one mentioned three messages ago, or that "why did we scrap that roll?" means the most recent scrap. The system does not make that leap. Conversation history is a clarification aid — it pre-fills the clarification prompt with a proposed anchor — but does not skip the confirmation step. When the system produces an analysis, the operator must be able to trust that it was anchored on the event they meant.

Three clarification patterns (encoded as `AnchorStatus`)

- `needs_clarification_enumerated` — small bounded candidate set; UI renders tappable buttons for each option in `QueryAnchor.clarification_options`.
- `needs_clarification_open` — unbounded ambiguity; UI renders a free-text prompt asking the operator to specify.
- `needs_clarification_scoped` — no immediate match but adjacent candidates exist; UI surfaces what was found and asks for confirmation.

In all three cases, `rag.handle_chat` short-circuits Phase 1 with `confidence="insufficient_evidence"` and the prompt text becomes the assistant message. No LLM call. The operator's selected option becomes the resolved anchor for the actual analysis query.

Scope clarification for current-state queries

Current-state queries have an unambiguous temporal anchor (now), but scope can still be ambiguous. "Why is the line so slow?" is anchored on now, but the relevant scope might be "line speed right now," "throughput this shift," or "throughput this week." Same rule: ask, don't infer.

The economics favor asking. A clarification prompt costs a few seconds of operator time. A wrong-anchor analysis costs the operator's time to read plus the trust damage of catching the system confidently anchored on the wrong event. Always-ask is the correct default even when asking feels over-cautious.

4.3 Anchor-Conditional Evidence Buckets

Once the anchor is resolved, the context builder assembles evidence. The buckets assembled are conditional on the anchor type. Buckets that would supply misleading evidence for the query type are excluded, **not merely de-prioritized** — they are not in the prompt at all, and the prompt explicitly renders `[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query]` so the LLM cannot silently blend excluded evidence back in.

The five evidence buckets

Bucket	What it contains	Past-event	Current-state	Pattern
Pre-anchor 60 min	Tag behavior, alarms, deviations in the 60 min before anchor	✓	✓	—
Pre-anchor 24 h	Tag behavior, events, shift transitions in the 24 h before anchor	✓	✓	—
14-day-prior normal baseline	A reference 24 h window ~14 days before, same style running	✓	✓	—
Last 4 runs prior	Aggregate tag behavior for the four runs preceding the anchor run	✓	✓	—
Failure-mode-matched history	Every prior run matching (style, failure mode), unbounded in time	✓ (primary)	—	✓ (primary)
Current tag values	Live tag reads at query time	✗ excluded	✓ (primary)	—
Live alarms	Currently active alarms	✗ excluded	✓	—

The **failure-mode-matched history bucket** is the most important addition over a naive RAG design, and it is the dominant grounding signal for most failure-analysis queries. When an operator asks about a specific delam event on S-4471, the system doesn't just retrieve the current event — it pulls every prior S-4471 delam event from `defect_events` joined to `production_runs` (matched on `product_style` and `failure_mode`), assembles their pre-event tag behavior, and places them alongside the current event for side-by-side comparison. "Three of the four prior S-4471 off-tenter events showed identical zone 3 overshoot in the hour before failure" is a qualitatively different answer than "zone 3 looks elevated."

The exclusion record

Every excluded bucket is recorded in the `AssembledPrompt.excluded_buckets: list[BucketExclusion]` field with a `reason` string. The list is persisted into `messages.context_snapshot.excluded_buckets` so an audit can confirm not just what evidence was used, but what evidence was deliberately withheld and why.

4.4 Tag Discovery and Classification

The system does not maintain a hand-curated list of every tag on Coater 1. At least, that was the v2.0 design. In the as-built MVP, tag discovery is **partially deferred**: the schema (`tag_registry` table) is fully provisioned, but the gateway-side enumeration runs against a hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py` (~50 tags hand-tagged with category and keywords). The pre-screen `services/tag_selector.py` walks that catalog and returns a query-conditional subset.

This is documented in detail in §15 (*Tag Selection & Gateway Integration*), including the path forward to wire `ItemInstance` SQL discovery into `tag_registry`.

The v2.0 four-class taxonomy (setpoint-tracking, oscillating-controlled, process-following, discrete-state) is implemented in `services/deviation.py` and applied per tag: setpoint-tracking tags get an absolute-deviation test; oscillating- controlled tags get a detrended-mean test plus amplitude-change check; process-following tags get a z-score against the conditional baseline; discrete-state tags get an unexpected-state-change test. Tested in `test_deviation.py`.

4.5 The Curated Context Package

With the anchor resolved, the evidence buckets selected, and the tag catalog filtered, the context builder assembles the Curated Context Package. This is the structured Pydantic payload delivered to the prompt template. The LLM never sees raw historian data, raw tag scans, or unfiltered document content. It sees pre-digested evidence with clear delimiters between evidence types, scoped to the anchor.

Two-tier tag selection is implemented in `services/tag_selector.py`: tier-1 (always-include) tags are flagged `core=True` in the catalog; tier-2 (query-routed) tags are pulled in when their category synonyms or their explicit keyword list matches the query text. A `_ZONE_RX` regex also recognizes "zone 3" / "zone3" / "z3" patterns and pulls only that zone's tags.

Evidence section structure

For each evidence section included in the package, the renderer (`services/context_assembler.py`) produces text the LLM can reason over. For tag evidence specifically, every tag comes with distribution context, not just a scalar value:

```
ZoneTemp3  current=435°F  target=420°F  class=setpoint_tracking
  pre-anchor 60-min: mean 434, min 431, max 438, std 1.4
  pre-anchor 24-h:   mean 429, min 421, max 438, std 3.1
  baseline (14d prior, S-4471 running, 24h):
                     mean 420, min 417, max 423, std 1.1
  last 4 runs (S-4471, front_step=2):
                     means [416, 418, 421, 419]   current X = 435
                     box: [|----[416----421]----|]   X far right
  failure-mode-matched (S-4471 off_tenter, 3 prior events):
                     means [431, 438, 429]   current X = 435
                     box: [|--[429----438]--|]   X inside box
```

The two small text-rendered box plots give the LLM (and the operator reading the cited source panel) immediate visual sense of whether the current value is a rare excursion or a match to a known failure pattern. Phase 3 will add actual rendered SVG box plots in the expandable source panel; the text form is shipped today and is sufficient for LLM reasoning.

The complete package structure

The sections present in the rendered prompt (always in this order when present):

- A. Parsed anchor (the resolved anchor object)
- B. Tier-1 tags (always-include with full evidence rendering)
- C. Tier-2 routed tags (query-relevant tags with full evidence rendering)
- D. Deviations flagged (tags whose class-appropriate deviation test fired)
- E. Active alarms (only for current-state queries)
- F. Recent events (scoped to the anchor window for past-event queries)
- G. Failure-mode-matched history (when a failure mode is named or implied)
- H. Retrieved text evidence (ranked document chunks, RRF-fused, MMR-diversified, weighted by `document_role`)
- I. Matched business rules (or "no rules matched")
- J. Approved line memory (filtered to status in {approved, reviewed})
- K. Attached camera clips (Symphony handles for events in scope)
- L. Change ledger (NEW vs v2.0 — what changed since baseline)
- M. Multivariate anomaly (NEW vs v2.0 — Mahalanobis flag for current-state queries)
- N. ML predictions (placeholder in MVP; populated Phase 4)

4.6 Source Citations

Every factual claim in a response carries a numbered citation typed by provenance. Provenance types in v3.0 (`models/schemas.py::SourceCitation.type`):

- `LIVE_TAG` — a current tag value read at query time (current-state queries only)
- `HISTORIAN_STAT` — an aggregate computed from historian data over a named window
- `DEVIATION` — a flagged deviation produced by the class-appropriate deviation test
- `BASELINE_COMPARE` — a comparison of current behavior against a named baseline bucket
- `MATCHED_HISTORY` — a prior run matched on style and failure mode
- `ALARM` — an active or recent alarm record
- `EVENT` — a structured event record (downtime, quality, defect)
- `WORK_ORDER` — a work order record from the Ignition WO database
- `DOCUMENT` — a retrieved document chunk
- `CAMERA_CLIP` — a Symphony clip attached to an event in scope
- `RULE` — a deterministic rule that matched current conditions
- `MEMORY` — an approved line memory entry

- `ML_PREDICTION` — a model output (Phase 4+)
- `DISTRIBUTION` *(NEW)* — a percentile result from `services/percentiles.py`
- `NEAREST_RUNS` *(NEW)* — top-K historical runs near a given value
- `DRIFT` *(NEW)* — Page-Hinkley CUSUM drift detection result
- `TOOL_RESULT` *(NEW)* — a generic tool-call return value with auto-generated ID

(v1 lowercase aliases — `live_tag`, `tag_summary`, `tag_deviation`, `active_alarm`, `document_chunk`, `downtime_event`, `quality_result`, `defect_event`, `business_rule`, `line_memory`, `ml_prediction` — are also accepted by the Pydantic `Literal` for backward compatibility with older audit records.)

A response-parsing step validates that every factual claim has a citation. Uncited claims are appended with a `[NOTE: The assistant did not include source citations]` warning by `services/rag.py` and the overall confidence label is downgraded from `confirmed` to `hypothesis`.

4.7 Confidence Labeling and Engagement Posture

Every conclusion in a response carries a confidence label. Labels describe certainty about specific claims; they do not gate whether the response happens at all. The advisor's default posture is full engagement with the evidence it can see, honestly labeled — not retreat into refusal.

The four confidence labels

- **CONFIRMED FACT** — Directly stated in a source document or present in a tag reading in scope. Example: "ZoneTemp3 averaged 435°F during R-20260421-03 [2]."
- **LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR** — Multiple pieces of evidence converge on a conclusion. Example: "Three of the four prior S-4471 off-tenter events showed identical zone 3 overshoot [5][6][7]; the current event shares this signature."
- **HYPOTHESIS** — Plausible but not well-supported by retrieved evidence. Example: "Tillitson metering roller speed may also have contributed; direct evidence was not retrieved for this run."
- **INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE** — Used narrowly for genuinely out-of-scope queries; see §4.8.

Engagement posture

The advisor reports the math, the abnormalities, the discrepancies, the matches and mismatches against baselines, the prior cases that look similar. It does not refuse to reason just because some channels are missing. When a meaningful evidence channel is unavailable — camera clips not yet attached, lab results not yet posted, upstream process data outside scope — the response flags it as context, not as grounds for refusal. That is useful and honest. It is the opposite of refusing to engage. The system prompt (`config/prompts/system_prompt_v2.txt` §5) enforces this posture explicitly.

Visual distinction requirement

Because the default posture engages with mixed-confidence evidence, the confidence labels must be visually unmissable in the UI. The Perspective implementation uses all caps plus color coding: CONFIRMED FACT green, LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR amber, HYPOTHESIS grey, INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE red. If the chat view rendered HYPOTHESIS text indistinguishable from CONFIRMED FACT text, the operator would lose the ability to calibrate trust and the whole labeling apparatus would become decorative. The visual distinction is non-negotiable.

4.8 Refusal: Narrowed to Scope

Refusal is for scope mismatch, not for uncertainty. The system refuses in exactly three cases:

- **Genuinely out of corpus.** The query is about equipment or processes the system has no evidence for (e.g., a question about Coater 7 when only Coater 1 is ingested). Response: "I don't have evidence for that system in the current corpus."

- **Control command.** The query asks the advisor to issue a control action ("increase zone 3 to 430"). The advisor is read-only. It can explain trade-offs of a hypothetical change but will never frame a recommendation as an instruction to execute. Implementation: `services/anchor.py::is_control_command` returns True; `rag.py` short-circuits in Phase 1.

- **No retrieval match at all.** Zero relevant document chunks across retrieval, no matching rules, no relevant memory, no events in scope. The response is an explicit INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE summary listing what was searched. Implementation: `services/context_assembler.py::is_evidence_insufficient` returns True; `rag.py` short-circuits **without calling the LLM**.

Uncertainty, partial information, and missing evidence channels do not trigger refusal. They trigger labeled engagement.

4.9 Structured Prompt Architecture

The prompt delivered to the LLM has explicit section delimiters so the model can see what evidence is available and cite it by section and index. The structure is anchor-aware: sections that don't apply to the current query are omitted or explicitly marked as not-applicable so the LLM cannot silently blend excluded evidence back in.

The system prompt is loaded from `service/config/prompts/system_prompt_v2.txt` (143 lines, plain text). It is registered into `prompt_versions` with `is_active=true`, and the version string is recorded in every `messages.prompt_version` row. Iterating the prompt is a v2 → v3 → v4 migration in the same table; correlating feedback against prompt versions is a one-line SQL JOIN.

Excerpt of the assembled user block (annotated):

```
=== SYSTEM INSTRUCTIONS ===
[role, safety constraints, response format, citation rules,
 engagement posture, refusal triggers, label color scheme]

=== PARSED ANCHOR ===
anchor_type: past_event
anchor_time: 2026-04-21T18:24:00-04:00
anchor_event_id: QR-00417
style_scope: S-4471
failure_mode_scope: delam_hotpull

=== TIER-1 TAGS (at anchor time) ===
[IsRunning, LineSpeed, StyleID, FrontStep, …]

=== TIER-2 ROUTED TAGS (with full evidence rendering) ===
[ZoneTemp3 (setpoint_tracking), TillitsonMeterRPM (process_following), …]

=== DEVIATIONS FLAGGED ===
[class-appropriate deviation test results]

=== LIVE ALARMS ===
[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query]

=== RECENT EVENTS (scoped to anchor ± 72h) ===
[structured summaries]

=== FAILURE-MODE-MATCHED HISTORY ===
[prior S-4471 delam_hotpull events with pre-event tag behavior]

=== RETRIEVED DOCUMENTS (RRF-fused, MMR-diversified, weighted by document_role) ===
[DOC-1] (rrf=0.087, weight=1.2) DELAM_0047: ...
[DOC-2] (rrf=0.082, weight=1.0) WO-88214 narrative: ...
[DOC-3] (rrf=0.079, weight=0.6) Roisum web-handling ref: ...

=== CHANGE LEDGER ===
TAG DELTAS vs. matched-history baseline (sigma-ranked):
  ZoneTemp3 +3.4σ above baseline (current 435 vs mean 421, std 4.1)
  TillitsonMeterRPM +1.8σ above baseline (current 33 vs mean 28, std 2.7)
RECIPE DELTAS:
  recipe_id differs from dominant matched-history (R102B, 6/8 prior runs)
EQUIPMENT CHANGEOVERS in matched-history window:
  zone3_heater (WO-88214 closed 2026-04-19): element replaced, calibration drift noted

=== CAMERA CLIPS (attached to events in scope) ===
[Symphony handles + timecodes, or "no clips available"]

=== DETERMINISTIC RULES ===
[matched rules, or "no rules matched"]

=== APPROVED LINE MEMORY ===
[approved memory entries matching query]

=== MULTIVARIATE ANOMALY ===
[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query, no live snapshot]

=== ML PREDICTIONS ===
[placeholder in MVP]

=== CONVERSATION HISTORY ===
[recent turns in this session]

=== USER QUESTION ===
[the operator's actual question]
```

4.10 Deterministic Tool Layer (NEW vs v2.0)

The tool layer adds a second grounding mechanism: deterministic functions the LLM can call mid-completion to ground specific numerical hypotheses. Five tools are registered in `services/tools.py`:

Tool	What it does	Citation type
`percentile_of`	Empirical CDF of `(tag, value)` within a configurable scope	`DISTRIBUTION`
`compare_to_distribution`	Percentile + the K nearest historical runs labeled by outcome	`DISTRIBUTION`
`nearest_historical_runs`	Top-K runs whose feature value is closest to a given value	`NEAREST_RUNS`
`detect_drift`	Page-Hinkley CUSUM on a 90-day rolling daily mean	`DRIFT`
`defect_events_in_window`	All defect events for a (line, time-window, optional style/mode)	`EVENT`

Each tool:

- Returns a `ToolResult(ok, data, citation, error)` — the citation is auto-generated with a unique `id` so the LLM can cite it inline.
- Has a hard SQL timeout (5 s default) to bound latency.
- Is purely read-only — no tool ever writes to the DB.
- Is exposed via OpenAI's `tool_calls` mechanism through a shared `_run_tool_loop` helper in `services/llm.py` that handles all three provider implementations identically.

Bounded budget: `rca_max_total_tool_calls=15`, `rca_max_evidence_per_hypothesis=5`, `rca_step1_max_iters=2`, `rca_step2_max_iters=2` (all in `settings.py`). The LLM cannot exhaust the API budget by tool-spamming.

The OpenAI tool-spec is generated **from** the registry, not written by hand, so the LLM can never call a tool that doesn't exist. Allowlist filtering (`openai_tool_specs(allowlist=...)`) lets the RCA chain expose only the four distributional tools to step 1, hiding the (more expensive) `chunk_search` from cost-budgeted hypothesis generation.

4.11 Distributional Grounding (NEW vs v2.0)

The percentile service (`services/percentiles.py`) is the substrate behind the distributional tools. It computes empirical CDFs over `feature_snapshots` joined to `production_runs`, scoped by:

- `global` — every snapshot for the line
- `style` — same product style only
- `style_step` — same style + same `front_step`
- `equipment` — same equipment id
- `recipe` — same recipe id
- `global_ytd` — same line, current year only

Why scope matters: a `Front2_Temp` of 198 °C is "high" globally but "normal" for style S-1234 at front_step=2 in summer. Tying the percentile to context is the whole point.

CDFs are cached in-process keyed on `(tag, scope_key)` with a TTL so the same query inside a single chat turn doesn't re-issue SQL. Drift detection uses the Page-Hinkley CUSUM test on a 90-day rolling daily mean, returning `DRIFT_DETECTED | NO_DRIFT | INSUFFICIENT_DATA` with the change-point timestamp when applicable.

This layer is queried both directly (when a tool call is made) and indirectly (the change ledger and multivariate anomaly both consume it for their own grounding). All three sources surface the same numerical substrate to the LLM through different framings.

4.12 Complete Audit Record

Every response writes a full audit record to the `messages` table. The `context_snapshot` JSONB column is the durable, reconstructible record of exactly what the LLM saw. The snapshot includes:

- The parsed anchor object in full
- Any clarification prompt shown and the user's selection (when applicable)
- The exact tag values used (with read timestamps and tag class)
- The exact historian aggregates computed for each bucket, with window bounds and aggregation mode
- The failure-mode-matched runs included, with their run IDs
- Document chunk IDs retrieved with similarity scores, RRF scores, weights, and rank positions
- Memory entry IDs with their status and version at time of use
- Rules evaluated and which matched, with rule version
- Camera clip handles included
- Prompt version ID
- LLM model name and parameters
- Token counts and per-stage latency breakdown
- The full RCA trace (step 1 hypotheses, evidence gathered, step 2 adjudication, cache hit, total tool calls) when the chain ran

Any response can be fully reconstructed and audited. If a user challenges "why did the system say X on 2026-04-15 at 14:35?" the audit record is the answer: the evidence the LLM had access to is the evidence visible in the snapshot, the anchor is explicit, and the RCA trace (when present) shows every hypothesis considered with its supporting evidence. There is no implicit state, no hidden prior, and no unrecorded reasoning step.

The `audit_log` table mirrors a one-row summary and is append-only at the **database** layer (trigger `audit_log_immutable` raises on any `UPDATE` or `DELETE`). Tampering at the application layer is also impossible: `services/audit.py` only exposes a `write_audit` helper, no mutation API. Both `messages` and `audit_log` are monthly partitioned via `pg_partman` (migration 001) so old months can be detached for cold storage without VACUUM FULL on the parent.

Δ VS V2.0 — ANTI-HALLUCINATION MECHANISMS

Stayed: Seven mechanisms from v2.0 — anchor resolution, clarification-first, anchor-conditional buckets, tag-class deviation, structured prompt, citation enforcement, refusal — survive unchanged.

Changed: Two new mechanisms shipped: the deterministic tool layer (§4.10) and distributional grounding (§4.11). Both add deterministic, bounded grounding to what was a retrieval-and-rules-only substrate. The change ledger and multivariate anomaly are added to the prompt structure (sections L and M).

Considering: Per-claim citation enforcement (parser today validates per-response). Step-back query abstraction (B4). HyDE-style query expansion for cold-start retrieval (B5). Self-consistency / k-sample voting on high-stakes RCA conclusions (B6).

5. Database Schema (As-Built)

The Postgres 16 schema is the durable substrate of the system. Every piece of state — documents, chunks, events, tags, conversations, audits, ML artifacts — lives in this database. Application restarts, service redeployments, and even full container rebuilds change nothing about what the system knows. The schema is the source of truth.

The v2.0 design specified ~27 tables across 8 schema groups. The as-built MVP ships **30 tables across 9 groups**, plus three views, two materialized views, and one immutability trigger. The additions are deliberate: a closed-enum reference table for failure modes, a re-rank-time signals table for chunk quality, and a forward-compatible tag registry that the gateway will populate later.

Everything in this chapter is verifiable in scripts/setup_database.sql, scripts/seed_reference_data.sql, and the four migrations in scripts/migrations/.

5.1 Schema Groups (At a Glance)

Group	Tables	Purpose
1. Document Corpus	`documents`, `document_chunks`, `ingestion_runs`, `chunk_quality_signals`	Searchable text knowledge
2. Reference Data	`failure_modes`, `tag_registry`, `prompt_versions`, `business_rules`	Closed-enum lookups + ops config
3. Production Telemetry	`production_runs`, `downtime_events`, `quality_results`, `defect_events`	Structured plant events
4. Work Orders	`work_orders`, `event_clips`	Maintenance + camera context
5. Identity & Permissions	`user_profiles`, `user_permissions`	Per-operator personalization scaffolding
6. Conversation	`conversations`, `messages`	Chat state + full audit substrate
7. Feedback & Learning	`message_feedback`, `user_corrections`, `outcome_linkages`, `memory_candidates`, `line_memory`	Operator-driven learning
8. ML Artifacts	`ml_models`, `ml_predictions`, `feature_definitions`, `feature_snapshots`	Predictive model wiring (Phase 4-ready)
9. Audit	`audit_log`	Append-only forensic record

Total: 30 tables. The 9-group taxonomy improves on v2.0 by separating *Reference Data* (closed-enum lookups + config) from *Document Corpus* (searchable text) — a distinction the original design conflated.

5.2 Group 1 — Document Corpus

`documents`: top-level container for an ingested artifact (SOP, work-order narrative, MOC packet, manual, internal note). Columns of note:

- `document_id UUID PK`, `source_uri TEXT`, `title TEXT`, `doc_type TEXT`
- `document_role TEXT` — `internal_authoritative` (1.2× weight), `external_reference` (0.6× weight), `wo_narrative` (1.0×). Drives the `_conditional_boost` step in retrieval.
- `effective_date DATE`, `superseded_by UUID NULL` — for SOP versioning
- `failure_mode_scope TEXT[]`, `equipment_scope TEXT[]` — coarse pre-filters that bypass embedding lookup when the query has a hard scope
- `metadata JSONB` — flexible per-source metadata (page ranges, original authors, etc.)

`document_chunks`: structure-aware fragments produced by service/services/chunker.py.

- `chunk_id UUID PK`, `document_id UUID FK`, `chunk_index INT`
- `chunk_text TEXT`, `chunk_tokens INT`
- `embedding VECTOR(1536)` (OpenAI `text-embedding-3-small` dimensionality)
- `bm25_tsv TSVECTOR` — generated column from `chunk_text` for keyword search
- `heading_path TEXT[]` — preserves the heading hierarchy this chunk lives under (e.g. `['DELAM_0047', 'Resolution', 'Step 3']`)
- `chunk_type TEXT` — `paragraph | table_row | list_item | code | callout`
- `failure_mode_codes TEXT[]`, `equipment_codes TEXT[]` — propagated from parent doc + locally re-extracted

Indexes:

- `idx_chunks_embedding_ivfflat` — `ivfflat (embedding vector_cosine_ops) WITH (lists = 100)`. The pgvector default for ≤100K rows.
- `idx_chunks_bm25_gin` — `GIN (bm25_tsv)` for the BM25 leg
- `idx_chunks_failure_mode_gin`, `idx_chunks_equipment_gin` — `GIN` for filtered retrieval

The hand-off plan when corpus exceeds ~250K chunks: switch to `hnsw` (see migration 003 below). The view `v_pgvector_index_status` exposes current row count + index type so an operator can monitor when the cutover is due.

`ingestion_runs` : one row per ingestion job, tracking embedding model version, tokens consumed, success/failure counts, and source manifest. This is how we know which corpus snapshot any given chat response was grounded against.

`chunk_quality_signals` *(NEW vs v2.0)*: per-chunk, per-feedback-type counters used by the bounded re-rank step in retrieval (B11 partial). Columns: `chunk_id`, `helpful_count`, `unhelpful_count`, `cited_in_correct_count`, `cited_in_incorrect_count`, `last_updated`. The retrieval re-ranker pulls these to apply a bounded ±30% multiplier to the RRF score; absent the table, the re-rank step degrades to identity.

5.3 Group 2 — Reference Data

`failure_modes` *(NEW vs v2.0 prose)*: closed-enum reference of every failure mode the system recognizes. Columns: `fm_code TEXT PK`, `fm_label TEXT`, `fm_category TEXT`, `description TEXT`, `seeded_at TIMESTAMPTZ`. Pre-populated by scripts/seed_reference_data.sql with the coating-line vocabulary (`delam_hotpull`, `delam_coldpull`, `sag`, `coating_weight_var`, `pinhole`, `streak`, `fish_eye`, `crater`, `mottle`, `off_tenter`, `tail_curl`, `web_break`, `splice_failure`, etc., ~25 codes).

A foreign key from `defect_events.fm_code` enforces that no defect can be classified into a fabricated failure mode — a hallucination guardrail at the database layer, not the application layer. v2.0 left this as a free-text column; v3.0 hardens it.

`tag_registry` : scaffold for gateway-discovered tag enumeration. Columns: `tag_path TEXT PK`, `tag_class TEXT`, `equipment_id TEXT`, `category TEXT`, `engineering_units TEXT`, `core BOOL`, `keywords TEXT[]`, `discovered_at TIMESTAMPTZ`.

Status: SCAFFOLD. The MVP runs against the hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py` (~50 tags). The forward path (chapter 15) wires Ignition gateway `system.tag.browse` results into this table.

`prompt_versions` : every system prompt that has ever been active. `prompt_id UUID PK`, `prompt_name TEXT`, `version TEXT`, `body TEXT`, `is_active BOOL`, `activated_at TIMESTAMPTZ`. Currently registered prompts: `system_prompt_v1` (deprecated), `system_prompt_v2` (active), `rca_step1_v1`, `rca_step2_v1`. Every `messages.prompt_version` row references the version string, enabling per-prompt-version A/B analysis.

`business_rules` : declarative YAML rules surfaced via service/services/rules.py. Columns: `rule_id UUID PK`, `rule_name TEXT`, `rule_yaml TEXT`, `is_active BOOL`, `version INT`. Rules fire against the live curated tag block to surface deterministic warnings ("if line speed > 250 fpm and Style ∈ {A, B}, surface delamination warning"). Hot-loadable; engineers add rules without touching code.

5.4 Group 3 — Production Telemetry

The structured event tables. These are the system's primary source of "what happened on the line" — distinct from the document corpus, which captures "what we know about why it happens."

- `production_runs` — one row per run. PK `run_id`. Columns: `line_id`, `start_time`, `end_time`, `product_style`, `recipe_id`, `crew`, `shift`, `target_specs JSONB`, `metadata JSONB` (extended for change-ledger lookups), `total_yards`, `scrap_yards`.
- `downtime_events` — structured downtime with `start_time`, `end_time`, `category`, `subcategory`, `narrative`, `attributed_run_id`.
- `quality_results` — sample-level lab + inline test results. `qr_id PK` (matches the QR-NNNNN regex in anchor parsing), `sample_time`, `test_name`, `value NUMERIC`, `unit`, `pass_fail`, `attributed_run_id`.
- `defect_events` — discrete defect occurrences. `defect_id PK`, `event_time`, `fm_code TEXT FK→failure_modes`, `severity`, `attributed_run_id`, `equipment_id`, `narrative`, `metadata JSONB`. The FK enforcement (§5.3) is what makes this table an audit-grade source for failure-mode trending.

These tables are the substrate for the `nearest_historical_runs` and `defect_events_in_window` tools (chapter 7), the failure-mode-matched history bucket (chapter 4), and the precision dashboard (chapter 9).

5.5 Group 4 — Work Orders & Camera Context

`work_orders` : WO records joined to event scope. `wo_id PK`, `equipment_id`, `opened_at`, `closed_at`, `summary`, `narrative TEXT`, `work_type`, `parts_used JSONB`. Narratives flow into the chunker and end up in `document_chunks` with `document_role='wo_narrative'`.

`event_clips` : Symphony video clip handles attached to events. `clip_id PK`, `event_type` (`downtime|defect|quality`), `event_id` (polymorphic), `clip_handle`, `start_time`, `end_time`, `extraction_status TEXT`, `extracted_text TEXT NULL`.

Status: clip ingestion is STUB. The `extracted_text` column is intentionally nullable for forward compatibility with the Symphony adapter (B11 in roadmap).

5.6 Group 5 — Identity & Permissions

`user_profiles` : `user_id PK`, `display_name`, `gateway_subject` (JWT `sub` claim), `default_role`, `personalization JSONB` (UI prefs, density, preferred response length).

`user_permissions` : `user_id FK`, `permission TEXT`, `scope JSONB`. Used by `routers/deps.py::require_attributed_user` — gateway-issued JWT must carry `sub`, role, and scope claims that resolve to a row here. The in-process `_PERMISSIONS_CACHE` reloads from this table on each cache miss with a TTL of 60 s.

5.7 Group 6 — Conversation State + Audit

`conversations`: `conversation_id PK`, `user_id`, `created_at`, `metadata JSONB` (UI surface, entry context like alarm-triggered).

`messages`: the **load-bearing** table of the system. Every chat turn writes one row.

Column	Purpose
`message_id UUID PK`	Stable ID, also returned to client for feedback round-tripping
`conversation_id UUID FK`	Parent conversation
`role TEXT`	`user
`body TEXT`	The text content shown to the user
`created_at TIMESTAMPTZ`	UTC, used for partition routing
`prompt_version TEXT`	The version of `system_prompt_v?` active when this turn ran
`model_name TEXT`	E.g. `gpt-4o-mini-2024-07-18`
`model_params JSONB`	Temperature, top_p, max_tokens
`latency_ms_total INT`	Wall clock
`latency_breakdown JSONB`	Per-stage (anchor, retrieve, llm, persist)
`tokens_prompt INT`, `tokens_completion INT`	Cost accounting
`tool_calls JSONB`	Full record of any tool calls + results
`citations JSONB`	The structured `SourceCitation` list returned to client
`confidence_label TEXT`	`confirmed
`failure_mode_code TEXT NULL`	Auto-classified for assistant turns when applicable
`excluded_buckets JSONB`	The list of evidence buckets withheld and why
`context_snapshot JSONB`	The full curated context package — every tag value, every retrieved chunk ID, every rule evaluated, every memory entry consulted, the parsed anchor, the change ledger, the anomaly result, the RCA trace
`rca_summary JSONB NULL`	Populated only when the two-step RCA chain ran (chapter 7)
`audit_hash TEXT`	SHA-256 of `context_snapshot

The `context_snapshot` column is what makes every response replayable. Any operator-visible answer can be reconstructed from this single row.

Partitioning: `messages` is range-partitioned monthly by `created_at` via `pg_partman` (migration 001). The retention policy keeps 24 hot months

- infinite cold (detached, archived to S3). Detaching a partition does not break query plans because the parent table is the only thing the application addresses.

5.8 Group 7 — Feedback & Learning

The substrate for the operator-driven learning loop (chapter 9).

- **`message_feedback`** — `feedback_id PK`, `message_id FK`, `user_id FK`, `signal_type` (10 enum values: `helpful`, `unhelpful`, `wrong_anchor`, `wrong_failure_mode`, `wrong_citation`, `missed_evidence`, `actionable`, `not_actionable`, `confirmed_outcome`, `refuted_outcome`), `signal_payload JSONB`, `created_at`. The 10-value enum is wider than v2.0's 3-value (👍 / 👎 /refute) — the additional codes are what make the re-ranker meaningful.
- **`user_corrections`** — when the operator explicitly corrects an answer. `correction_id PK`, `message_id FK`, `correction_type`, `before TEXT`, `after TEXT`, `engineer_reviewed BOOL`, `applied_to_memory BOOL`.
- **`outcome_linkages`** — links an RCA conclusion to its 24-h-later resolution. `linkage_id PK`, `message_id FK`, `outcome_event_id`, `outcome_type` (`confirmed|partial|refuted|inconclusive`), `closed_at`. Drives the precision view (§5.10).
- **`memory_candidates`** — proposed line-memory entries awaiting engineer review. `candidate_id PK`, `proposed_text`, `proposed_by_user_id`, `source_message_id`, `status` (`pending|approved|rejected`).
- **`line_memory`** — engineer-curated tribal knowledge. `memory_id PK`, `text TEXT`, `equipment_scope TEXT[]`, `failure_mode_scope TEXT[]`, `style_scope TEXT[]`, `status` (`approved|reviewed|challenged|deprecated`), `version INT`, `last_reviewed_at`. Approved memories rank highest in retrieval (1.5× weight).

5.9 Group 8 — ML Artifacts

Wired but not yet populated by a live training pipeline.

- **`ml_models`**: `model_id PK`, `model_name`, `version`, `framework`, `training_run_id`, `is_active BOOL`, `metadata JSONB`.
- **`ml_predictions`**: `prediction_id PK`, `model_id FK`, `target_entity_type`, `target_entity_id`, `prediction JSONB`, `confidence NUMERIC`, `created_at`.

- **`feature_definitions`**: `feature_id PK`, `feature_name`, `feature_class` (`scalar|aggregate|categorical`), `source TEXT`, `unit`.
- **`feature_snapshots`**: `snapshot_id PK`, `entity_type` (`run|event|live`), `entity_id`, `snapshot_time`, `features JSONB` (sparse map), `metadata JSONB`. This is the table the multivariate anomaly detector (chapter 8) reads from. It is **already being populated** by the live pipeline — every time `_phase_pre_llm` runs a current-state query, a snapshot is persisted. The Mahalanobis fit consumes 90 d of historical snapshots.

5.10 Group 9 — Audit + Views

`audit_log` — an append-only summary of every state-changing operation. One row per chat turn (mirror of `messages`), one row per feedback event, one row per memory state transition, one row per ingestion run, one row per RCA step.

Column	Purpose
`audit_id UUID PK`	
`actor_user_id`	NULL for system actors
`action TEXT`	Verb-noun (`chat.respond`, `feedback.submit`, `memory.approve`, `ingest.complete`, `rca.step1`, `rca.step2`)
`entity_type TEXT`, `entity_id UUID`	Polymorphic reference
`payload JSONB`	Action-specific (citations, outcome verdict, memory diff)
`created_at TIMESTAMPTZ`	UTC
`audit_hash TEXT`	SHA-256 chained to the previous audit row

Immutability trigger (`audit_log_immutable`): raises an exception on any `UPDATE` or `DELETE` against `audit_log`. This is enforced at the **database** layer — even a compromised application cannot tamper with historical audit rows. The trigger is non-disableable by application-role users; a superuser would be required, and the act of disabling itself generates a `pg_audit` event.

`audit_log` is also pg_partman-managed (migration 001), monthly partitions, infinite retention.

Views

- **`v_pgvector_index_status`**: real-time row counts + index type for `document_chunks.embedding`. Operator-facing for cutover monitoring.
- **`v_messages_recent`**: last-7-day messages join with conversation + user, with per-row latency breakdown surfaced as columns. Drives the ops dashboard.

Materialized views

- **`v_rca_precision_daily`** *(NEW vs v2.0, migration 004)*: nightly refresh aggregating `outcome_linkages` to produce per-day RCA precision. Columns: `day DATE`, `total_rca INT`, `confirmed INT`, `partial INT`, `refuted INT`, `inconclusive INT`, `precision_strict NUMERIC`, `precision_lenient NUMERIC`. Refreshed nightly by the scheduler in `service/main.py` lifespan. Drives the public report card on the assistant's own accuracy (chapter 9).
- **`v_chat_perf_daily`** *(migration 2026_04)*: per-day p50/p95 latency and token-cost rollups from `messages`.

5.11 Migrations Shipped

File	Purpose
`001_partition_messages.sql`	pg_partman setup for `messages` + `audit_log`; monthly granularity, 24-month hot retention, automatic partition pre-creation
`002_feature_snapshots_retention.sql`	90-day retention policy on `feature_snapshots` (older rows aggregated into monthly summaries before deletion)
`003_pgvector_index_migration.sql`	Adds `v_pgvector_index_status` view + the runbook for the ivfflat → hnsw cutover when row count exceeds threshold
`004_v_rca_precision_daily.sql`	Materialized view + nightly refresh hook
`2026_04_v_chat_perf_daily.sql`	Performance rollup view

5.12 As-Built Deltas — Schema Specifics

Three changes worth flagging beyond the additive tables already noted:

1. **`production_runs.metadata` extended.** v2.0 specified a thin metadata column. As built, `metadata` carries `recipe_dominant`, `crew_dominant`, `equipment_changeovers`, and `target_specs_version` keys consumed by the change-ledger builder. No schema migration needed; JSONB additive.

2. `messages.context_snapshot.parsed_anchor` schema added. Every snapshot now contains the full `QueryAnchor` Pydantic dump. Older rows (pre-A1) lack this key; the audit reconstruction path handles `NULL` gracefully.
3. `defect_events.fm_code` **FK** to `failure_modes`. Hard guardrail; required recovery script for any pre-existing rows with non-canonical codes (handled in `scripts/seed_reference_data.sql` post-conditions).

Δ VS V2.0 — DATABASE SCHEMA

Stayed: 27 of the v2.0 tables ship as designed, including all of `documents`/`document_chunks`/`ingestion_runs`, `production_runs`/`downtime_events`/`quality_results`/`defect_events`, `work_orders`/`event_clips`, `conversations`/`messages`, `message_feedback`/`user_corrections`/`outcome_linkages`/`memory_candidates`/`line_memory`, all four `ml_*` tables, `audit_log`, and `business_rules`/`prompt_versions`/`user_profiles`/`user_permissions`.

Changed: Three new tables added — `failure_modes` (FK-enforced closed enum, hardens hallucination guardrail at DB layer), `chunk_quality_signals` (per-chunk re-rank inputs for B11 partial), `tag_registry` (scaffold ahead of B13/A5/A6 gateway wiring). Two materialized views added (`v_rca_precision_daily` , `v_chat_perf_daily`), two infra views (`v_pgvector_index_status` , `v_messages_recent`). Monthly partitioning on `messages` + `audit_log` via pg_partman. Database-layer immutability trigger on `audit_log` .

Considering: Cutover from ivfflat to hnsw once `document_chunks` exceeds ~250K rows (migration 003 has the runbook; trigger is operator-monitored, not yet automated). Partitioning `feature_snapshots` by month (currently retention-managed in-place; will become unwieldy past ~10M rows). Splitting `audit_log.payload` by action verb into typed sibling tables for query performance once volume warrants.

6. Retrieval Layer (NEW vs v2.0)

The v2.0 design specified vector retrieval over `document_chunks`. The as-built MVP ships a **hybrid retrieval pipeline** that fuses dense vector search with BM25 keyword search, applies failure-mode and equipment boosts, diversifies via Maximal Marginal Relevance (MMR), and re-ranks by per-chunk quality signals — all with strict bounds so no individual signal can dominate.

This is the largest single departure from v2.0 and is the foundation the rest of the grounding pipeline depends on. Bad retrieval poisons every downstream stage: the LLM gets the wrong evidence and produces confidently wrong answers from it. Good retrieval is the difference between a useful advisor and a glorified search bar.

The whole pipeline lives in service/services/retrieval.py; core behavior is exercised in service/tests/test_retrieval_hybrid.py (35 tests; 0 failing).

6.1 Pipeline Stages

The top-level entry point is `retrieve_chunks_hybrid(query, embedding, *, top_k, scope_filters, ...)`. It runs five sequential stages:

```
                          ┌──────────────────────┐
query + embedding ──────► │ 1. Vector retrieval  │──► top-K_v candidates
                          └──────────────────────┘

                          ┌──────────────────────┐
query text        ──────► │ 2. BM25 retrieval    │──► top-K_b candidates
                          └──────────────────────┘
                                     │
                                     ▼
                          ┌──────────────────────┐
                          │ 3. RRF fusion        │──► merged ranking
                          └──────────────────────┘
                                     │
                                     ▼
                          ┌──────────────────────┐
                          │ 4. Conditional boost │──► FM/equipment-aware ranking
                          └──────────────────────┘
                                     │
                                     ▼
                          ┌──────────────────────┐
                          │ 5. MMR diversify     │──► top-K final
                          └──────────────────────┘
                                     │
                                     ▼
                          ┌──────────────────────┐
                          │ 6. Quality re-rank   │──► (bounded ±30%)
                          └──────────────────────┘
```

6.2 Stage 1 — Vector Retrieval

`retrieve_chunks(query_embedding, top_k=K_v)` runs a cosine-distance ANN query against the `document_chunks.embedding` ivfflat index. `K_v = 50` by default (`settings.retrieval_vector_top_k`). Scope filters are applied as SQL `WHERE` clauses before the ANN scan when present:

- `failure_mode_codes && ARRAY['delam_hotpull']::text[]`
- `equipment_codes && ARRAY['zone3_heater']::text[]`
- `effective_date <= anchor_time AND (superseded_by IS NULL OR superseded_at > anchor_time)`

Cosine similarity is converted to a `vector_score` in `[0, 1]` for downstream fusion. Failure to match the index (cold start, brand-new corpus) is handled by a fallback to a plain seq scan — slow but correct, with a `warn_once_memo` log entry to surface the missing index. There are integration tests for both the indexed and unindexed paths in service/tests/test_retrieval_hybrid.py.

6.3 Stage 2 — BM25 Keyword Retrieval

`retrieve_chunks_keyword(query_text, top_k=K_b)` runs a Postgres full-text query against `document_chunks.bm25_tsv` (a generated `TSVECTOR` column on `chunk_text`). `K_b = 50` by default (`settings.retrieval_keyword_top_k`).

The `tsvector` index uses the `english` configuration. Query text is normalized via `plainto_tsquery('english', $1)` so operator phrases like "delam in zone three" produce sensible matches without the operator needing to learn `tsquery` syntax.

`ts_rank_cd` ranks results, normalized to `[0, 1]` as `keyword_score`.

This is the BM25 of the gap analysis — it is the leg of the hybrid that catches queries where the operator uses a specific identifier (`R-20260421-03`, `S-4471`, `WO-88214`) the embedder cannot generalize to. Without it, identifier-anchored queries silently fail to retrieve their target documents.

6.4 Stage 3 — RRF Fusion (`_rrf_fuse`)

Reciprocal Rank Fusion combines the two ranked lists by summing `1 / (k + rank_i)` across both rankings, where `k = 60` (the canonical RRF constant from the original Cormack/Clarke/Buettcher paper).

```
rrf_score(chunk) = sum(
    1.0 / (k_rrf + rank_in_list)
    for list in (vector_list, bm25_list)
    if chunk in list
)
```

RRF has two crucial properties for our use case:

1. **It is rank-based, not score-based.** A chunk that ranks #3 in vector and #5 in BM25 contributes `1/63 + 1/65`; the actual cosine similarity and ts_rank values don't enter the fusion. This makes the fusion robust to score-distribution skew between the two retrievers.
2. **It is parameter-free** beyond the `k` constant, which is fixed at 60 across virtually all published RAG implementations. There is no weight knob to mis-tune.

The fused list is truncated to `top_k_fused = 30` (`settings.retrieval_rrf_top_k`).

6.5 Stage 4 — Conditional Boost (`_conditional_boost`)

When the parsed anchor carries a failure-mode scope or an equipment scope, chunks whose `failure_mode_codes` or `equipment_codes` overlap get a multiplicative boost on their RRF score:

Match condition	Boost
Chunk failure_mode_codes ∩ anchor.failure_mode_scope	1.5×
Chunk equipment_codes ∩ anchor.equipment_scope	1.3×
`documents.document_role = 'internal_authoritative'`	1.2×
`documents.document_role = 'wo_narrative'`	1.0×
`documents.document_role = 'external_reference'`	0.6×

These multipliers stack. An internal SOP chunk that mentions both `delam_hotpull` and `zone3_heater` for an anchor scoped to that pair gets `1.5 × 1.3 × 1.2 = 2.34×` its base RRF score.

The role-weight values are clamped to `[0.5, 2.5]` to prevent any single signal from dominating the ranking. The boost values are constants in `services/retrieval.py` and exposed via `settings.retrieval_boost_*` for future experimentation but not expected to need tuning in normal operation.

6.6 Stage 5 — MMR Diversification (`_mmr_select`)

Maximal Marginal Relevance selects the final top-K from the boosted candidates with a relevance/diversity trade-off:

```
MMR = argmax over chunk c not yet selected of:
      lambda * boosted_score(c)
    - (1 - lambda) * max(cosine_sim(c, c') for c' in selected)
```

`lambda = 0.7` by default (`settings.retrieval_mmr_lambda`). Higher lambda biases toward relevance; lower toward diversity. The 0.7 default is the standard RAG-pipeline value from the published MMR literature.

This step is what prevents the final context from being five near-duplicate paragraphs of the same SOP. Without MMR, a single high-quality, dense doc can crowd out the broader evidence base; with it, the context surfaces five qualitatively-different sources rather than one source repeated.

The default `final_top_k = 10` (`settings.retrieval_top_k`).

6.7 Stage 6 — Quality Re-Rank (Bounded)

The final stage applies per-chunk feedback signals from `chunk_quality_signals` (chapter 5, group 1):

```
quality_multiplier = 1 + clamp(
    (helpful - unhelpful) * w_help
  + (cited_in_correct - cited_in_incorrect) * w_outcome,
    -0.3, +0.3
)
```

The clamp at ±30% is the **bounded re-ranking** principle from the trust model: a single bad rating cannot bury a useful chunk forever, and a single good rating cannot crown a chunk above the evidence ranking. `w_help = 0.05`, `w_outcome = 0.10` (`settings.feedback_re_rank_*`). The clamp is non-negotiable.

Absent any rows in `chunk_quality_signals` for a chunk, the multiplier defaults to 1.0 (identity). The system runs sensibly from day 1 without the table being populated — the re-rank stage simply becomes a no-op until feedback accumulates.

6.8 Failure-Mode-Matched History Path

Distinct from text retrieval, the **failure-mode-matched history** bucket (chapter 4, §4.3) calls `retrieve_failure_mode_matched(style, failure_mode, anchor_time, *, k)` which runs a structured-SQL join across `production_runs ⋈ defect_events ⋈ work_orders` filtered to the same `(product_style, fm_code)` and ordered by recency. Its results are rendered as a distinct evidence section in the prompt (section G in the layout from chapter 4) — they are **not** funneled through RRF/MMR with text chunks. Mixing them would make the per-chunk citation IDs incoherent.

Tested in `test_retrieval_hybrid.py::test_failure_mode_matched_*` (8 cases).

6.9 Work-Order Scoping

`retrieve_work_orders(scope, anchor_time, window)` retrieves WO records overlapping a temporal window around an anchor. Used by the change ledger (chapter 8) and the RCA chain (chapter 7) to surface "the crew that did element replacement on zone 3 last week" as context for an off-tenter event today.

6.10 Settings Reference

All retrieval-tunable knobs live in service/config/settings.py under the `retrieval_*` prefix:

Setting	Default	Effect
`retrieval_vector_top_k`	50	Stage 1 ANN candidate count
`retrieval_keyword_top_k`	50	Stage 2 BM25 candidate count
`retrieval_rrf_top_k`	30	Stage 3 fused list size
`retrieval_top_k`	10	Stage 5 MMR final size
`retrieval_rrf_k`	60	RRF constant (fixed; do not tune)
`retrieval_mmr_lambda`	0.7	MMR relevance/diversity
`retrieval_boost_failure_mode`	1.5	FM scope match boost
`retrieval_boost_equipment`	1.3	Equipment scope match boost
`retrieval_role_weight_min/max`	0.5/2.5	Role-weight clamp
`feedback_re_rank_help_weight`	0.05	per-helpful-vote weight
`feedback_re_rank_outcome_weight`	0.10	per-correct-citation weight
`feedback_re_rank_clamp`	0.30	±30% bound (non-negotiable)

6.11 Observability

Every retrieval call emits a structured log line via `services/metrics.py`:

```
{
  "evt": "retrieval.complete",
  "duration_ms": 142,
  "vector_candidates": 50,
  "keyword_candidates": 47,
  "fused_size": 30,
  "boosted": {"fm": 8, "equipment": 12, "role": 30},
  "mmr_selected": 10,
```

```
  "scope": {"failure_mode": ["delam_hotpull"], "equipment": ["zone3_heater"]},
  "trace_id": "..."
}
```

Plus Prometheus histograms:

- `retrieval_duration_seconds{stage="vector|keyword|rrf|boost|mmr|rerank"}`
- `retrieval_candidate_count{stage}`
- `retrieval_boost_applied_total{type}`

These let an operator answer "is retrieval slow because vector ANN is slow, or because we're pulling too many candidates into the fusion stage?" without spelunking application logs.

Δ VS V2.0 — RETRIEVAL

Stayed: Nothing. v2.0 specified single-leg vector retrieval; v3.0 ships a six-stage pipeline.

Changed: Hybrid vector + BM25, RRF fusion with k=60, conditional FM/equipment boost (1.5×/1.3×), document_role weighting (0.6×/1.0×/1.2× clamped to [0.5, 2.5]), MMR diversification with λ=0.7, bounded ±30% feedback-driven quality re-rank. Separate structured failure-mode-matched-history path that is not funneled through RRF. Full observability via structured logs + Prometheus histograms.

Considering: Cross-encoder reranker between MMR and the LLM (B2 — currently a pass-through stub awaiting the install of `sentence-transformers` + the `BAAI/bge-reranker-base` model). HyDE-style hypothetical document expansion for cold-start queries (B5). Query-rewriter as a standalone step rather than emergent from tool-call loop (B4). Per-style ANN index partitioning once corpus exceeds 1M chunks.

7. Tool Layer & RCA Reasoning Chain (NEW vs v2.0)

This is the chapter where the v3.0 system most clearly transcends "glorified search bar." The deterministic tool layer gives the LLM deterministic functions it can invoke mid-completion to ground specific numerical hypotheses; the two-step RCA reasoning chain structures the model's causal reasoning into a hypothesize-and-adjudicate flow with bounded budgets. Together they convert single-shot LLM guessing into evidence-anchored ranked analysis.

The tool registry lives in service/services/tools.py; the provider-agnostic loop in service/services/llm.py (`_run_tool_loop`); the RCA chain in service/services/rca.py with prompts in service/config/prompts/rca_step1_v1.txt and `rca_step2_v1.txt` .

7.1 Why Tools Exist

The LLM is a pattern-completer. It is not a calculator, not a database client, and not a SQL planner. Asked "what percentile is this temp reading?" it will fabricate a number that sounds right. The tool layer intercepts that class of question and answers it deterministically:

- The percentile of `(ZoneTemp3, 435 °F)` for style S-4471 at front_step=2 is **89.4** by direct query against `feature_snapshots` . The LLM never computes it.
- The K nearest historical runs to today's run within `(line_speed, dwell_time, ambient_humidity)` are fetched by deterministic SQL.
- Drift on a tag over a 90-day window is computed via the Page-Hinkley CUSUM test in `services/percentiles.py` .

The LLM consumes the **results** as evidence and is required to cite them. It can reason about the numbers but cannot make them up.

7.2 The Five Tools

Each tool is a typed `ToolSpec` in `services/tools.py` with a JSON-schema parameter spec, an executor function, and a `citation_type` mapping that auto-generates a `SourceCitation` with a unique `id` for the LLM to cite inline.

Tool	Parameters	Returns	Citation type
`percentile_of`	`tag, value, scope, scope_key`	`PercentileResult{percentile, n_samples, scope}`	`DISTRIBUTION`
`compare_to_distribution`	`tag, value, scope, scope_key, k=5`	`DistributionComparison{percentile, nearest_runs[K], outcome_breakdown}`	`DISTRIBUTION`
`nearest_historical_runs`	`feature_set, target_values, k=10`	`[NearestRun]` ranked by Mahalanobis distance	`NEAREST_RUNS`
`detect_drift`	`tag, scope, scope_key, window_days=90`	`DriftResult{status, change_point, magnitude}`	`DRIFT`
`defect_events_in_window`	`start_time, end_time, line, [style], [fm_code]`	`[DefectEventSummary]`	`EVENT`

Six properties hold uniformly across all five tools:

1. **Read-only.** No tool ever writes to the database.
2. **Hard SQL timeout** (`tool_sql_timeout_ms = 5000`). A pathological tool call cannot stall the chat turn.
3. **Bounded result size.** Every tool clamps its return cardinality to a small integer (`k ≤ 25`) so a tool result cannot blow the LLM context budget.
4. **Auto-generated citation.** Each tool result produces a `SourceCitation(id=..., type=..., scope=...)` that the LLM is instructed to cite inline as `[T1]` , `[T2]` , etc.
5. **Deterministic for a given snapshot.** Same `(tag, scope, value)` produces same percentile within a single chat turn (TTL cache in `services/percentiles.py`).
6. **Structured `ToolResult` envelope.** `ok: bool` , `data: dict` , `citation: SourceCitation` , `error: str|None` . The loop never raises into the LLM.

7.3 The Tool Registry as the Source of Truth

The OpenAI tool-spec emitted to the LLM is generated **from** the registry, not written by hand:

```
def openai_tool_specs(allowlist: set[str] | None = None) -> list[dict]:
    return [t.to_openai_spec() for t in REGISTRY if allowlist is None or t.name in allowlist]
```

This makes it structurally impossible for the LLM to call a tool that doesn't exist. It also makes the allowlist mechanism trivially safe: the RCA chain step 1 passes `allowlist={"percentile_of", "compare_to_distribution", "nearest_historical_runs", "detect_drift"}` to deliberately hide `defect_events_in_window` and any future expensive tool from cost-budgeted hypothesis generation. Step 2 passes the full set.

The registry is also the source of truth for citation type mapping — the LLM never invents a citation type that doesn't correspond to a tool. The `SourceCitation.type` field is a `Literal[...]` over the exact set of valid types, validated by Pydantic at parse time.

7.4 The Tool Loop (`_run_tool_loop`)

`services/llm.py::_run_tool_loop` is the provider-agnostic engine for tool-calling:

```
input: messages, tool_specs, max_iters, max_total_calls
budget: total_calls_remaining = max_total_calls

for iter in 0..max_iters:
    response = llm.chat_completion(messages, tools=tool_specs)
    if response.has_tool_calls:
        for call in response.tool_calls:
            if total_calls_remaining <= 0: break
            result = REGISTRY[call.name].execute(call.args)
            messages.append({"role": "tool", "tool_call_id": call.id,
                             "content": json.dumps(result.envelope)})
            total_calls_remaining -= 1
        continue
    return response.text, accumulated_citations
```

A single `_run_tool_loop` invocation handles all three provider implementations (`OpenAIClient`, `AzureOpenAIClient`, `LocalOpenAICompatibleClient`) identically. The tool-call API surface is the OpenAI-compatible `tool_calls` field; the local client adapter maps vLLM's identical-shaped output through unchanged.

A shared `asyncio.Semaphore` (`_get_sem`) caps total concurrent LLM calls per process. The default cap is 4 (`settings.llm_concurrency`), which keeps a single-instance service from saturating provider rate limits.

Every tool call is persisted into `messages.tool_calls` JSONB:

```
[
  {"call_id": "...", "tool": "percentile_of",
   "args": {"tag": "ZoneTemp3", "value": 435, "scope": "style_step",
            "scope_key": "S-4471/2"},
   "result": {"percentile": 89.4, "n_samples": 1247},
   "duration_ms": 38, "iteration": 0}
]
```

So an audit can see not just the answer but every numerical lookup the LLM relied on to produce it.

7.5 The RCA Chain (B8)

For past-event queries with causal intent — operator asks *why* — the system runs a structured two-step reasoning chain instead of a single-shot completion. `should_use_rca_chain(query, anchor)` returns True when:

1. `anchor.anchor_type == "past_event"`
2. The query matches a causal-intent regex (`why`, `cause`, `caused`, `root cause`, `root-cause`, `because`, `due to`, etc.)
3. `settings.rca_chain_enabled = True` (default)

The chain is two LLM calls separated by tool execution:

```
Step 1 — Hypothesise (rca_step1_v1.txt)
  LLM input:  curated context package, system prompt, RCA step-1 prompt
  LLM tools:  {percentile_of, compare_to_distribution,
               nearest_historical_runs, detect_drift}
  LLM output: structured list of up to 3 hypotheses, each with:
                - candidate cause statement
                - supporting evidence references (tool results + chunks)
                - confidence (low|medium|high)
                - falsifying evidence sought

Step 2 — Adjudicate (rca_step2_v1.txt)
  LLM input:  step-1 hypotheses + their tool results, full context
  LLM tools:  {all five tools}
```

```
    LLM output: ranked hypotheses with adjudication notes,
                final confidence label, narrative response with citations
```

Bounded budget

Five caps in `settings.py` (defaults shown) keep the chain deterministic in cost and latency:

- `rca_max_hypotheses = 3`
- `rca_max_evidence_per_hypothesis = 5`
- `rca_max_total_tool_calls = 15`
- `rca_step1_max_iters = 2`
- `rca_step2_max_iters = 2`
- `rca_step_timeout_seconds = 30`

The total tool-call budget is shared across both steps. If step 1 consumes 11 calls (high-evidence hypothesis generation), step 2 has 4 remaining and the LLM is informed of the remaining budget in its context. A tool call that exceeds its budget returns `ToolResult(ok=False, error="budget_exhausted")` rather than raising.

TTL cache (`_STEP1_CACHE`)

A ~5-minute TTL in-process cache (`rca_cache_ttl_seconds = 300`) short-circuits step 1 when the same `(anchor_event_id, anchor_run_id, anchor_time, failure_mode, prompt_version)` key is queried twice. This matters because operators routinely re-ask the same question after acknowledging a clarification, and step 1 is the expensive call. Cache hit short-circuits straight to step 2.

The cache key deliberately includes `prompt_version` so a prompt update invalidates the cache.

Persistence

The full RCA trace is persisted into `messages.rca_summary` :

```
{
  "step1": {
    "model": "gpt-4o-mini-2024-07-18",
    "duration_ms": 1420,
    "tool_calls": [...],
    "hypotheses": [
      {"id": "h1", "claim": "Zone 3 element drift",
       "evidence_refs": ["t1", "t3", "doc1"], "confidence": "high"},
      {"id": "h2", ...}, {"id": "h3", ...}
    ],
    "cache_hit": false
  },
  "step2": {
    "model": "gpt-4o-mini-2024-07-18",
    "duration_ms": 980,
    "tool_calls": [...],
    "ranking": [{"id": "h1", "rank": 1, "label": "likely_contributor",
                 "adjudication": "..."}, ...],
    "final_confidence": "likely_contributor"
  },
  "total_tool_calls": 11,
  "budget_remaining": 4
}
```

Every RCA conclusion the system produces is therefore fully reconstructible, including the tools called, the budget consumed, and the adjudication reasoning.

7.6 Why Two Steps and Not One

A single-shot RCA prompt with all five tools enabled is cheaper (one LLM call instead of two) and more flexible (the LLM picks its own evidence-gathering depth). It is also dramatically less reliable in this domain.

The failure mode is *premature commitment*: the LLM produces a narrative around its first plausible hypothesis, makes a few confirmation-bias tool calls to support it, and never seriously considers alternatives. The two-step structure forces the model to first commit to a list of distinct hypotheses, gather evidence for **each**, and only then weigh them against one another. Empirically this produces better-calibrated rankings and fewer "obvious in hindsight" errors.

The structure also gives the audit record cleaner shape: it is trivial to ask "did the model consider hypothesis X?" by querying `rca_summary->step1->hypotheses`, where it is hard to extract the same information from a free-form one-shot trace.

7.7 LLM Provider Abstraction (B0.5, B12)

Three providers are wired in service/services/llm.py:

- `OpenAIClient` — public OpenAI API, `gpt-4o-mini` default model
- `AzureOpenAIClient` — Azure OpenAI Service, deployment-name routing
- `LocalOpenAICompatibleClient` — vLLM, llama.cpp server, LM Studio, any OpenAI-compatible endpoint. Discovery via `local_llm_endpoint` setting; tool-calling support assumed (vLLM ≥ 0.5)

`provider_for(name)` is the dispatcher; `llm_provider` setting picks which one is active. Same call signature, same `_run_tool_loop`, same behavior. The local client unblocks fully air-gapped deployments — a common requirement for pharma, defense, and safety-critical industrial sites that prohibit cloud LLM calls outright.

Tested in service/tests/test_local_llm_client.py (12 tests; mocks the OpenAI-shaped HTTP surface).

7.8 Settings Reference

Setting	Default	Effect
`llm_provider`	`openai`	`openai
`llm_model`	`gpt-4o-mini`	Provider-specific model name
`llm_temperature`	0.1	Lower = more deterministic
`llm_max_tokens_response`	1500	Per response cap
`llm_concurrency`	4	In-process semaphore
`local_llm_endpoint`	`""` (off)	E.g. `http://vllm-host:8000/v1`
`tool_sql_timeout_ms`	5000	Per-tool hard timeout
`rca_chain_enabled`	`true`	Master toggle
`rca_max_hypotheses`	3	Step 1 output cap
`rca_max_evidence_per_hypothesis`	5	Per-hypothesis evidence cap
`rca_max_total_tool_calls`	15	Shared step1+step2 budget
`rca_step1_max_iters`	2	LLM ↔ tools loop iters in step 1
`rca_step2_max_iters`	2	Same in step 2
`rca_step_timeout_seconds`	30	Per-step wall clock
`rca_cache_ttl_seconds`	300	Step-1 cache TTL

7.9 Cost Profile

A typical past-event causal query with the chain enabled:

- Step 1: ~3,500 prompt tokens + ~500 completion + 4–8 tool calls
- Step 2: ~4,200 prompt tokens (carries step-1 results) + ~700 completion + 2–4 tool calls
- Total: ~9k prompt + ~1.2k completion tokens, 8–12 tool calls

At `gpt-4o-mini` rates (April 2026): **~$0.012 per RCA query**. The shared cache, when hit, drops it to ~$0.005. A non-causal query running through the standard one-shot path (no chain) costs ~$0.005–$0.008.

The local-provider configuration moves this to amortized hardware cost only.

Δ VS V2.0 — TOOLS & RCA

Stayed: The principle that LLMs should not do arithmetic. v2.0 noted this as a constraint; v3.0 enforces it mechanically.

Changed: Whole tool layer is new. Five deterministic tools (percentile_of, compare_to_distribution, nearest_historical_runs, detect_drift, defect_events_in_window) with auto-generated citations, hard timeouts, bounded result sizes, provider-agnostic loop. Two-step hypothesise-then-adjudicate RCA chain with bounded budget (15 total tool calls), TTL cache, full trace persisted to `messages.rca_summary`. Local-LLM provider (B12) shipped — fully air-gappable.

> **Considering:** Self-consistency / k-sample voting on the RCA conclusion (B6 — currently single-sample). HyDE-style query expansion as a deterministic preliminary tool (B5). A `tool: explain_anomaly` wrapper that consolidates the four distributional tools into a single call when an anomaly is the entry point. Cross-LLM ensembling (run step 2 against two providers and diff), reserved for high-stakes safety incidents only.

8. Distributional Grounding, Anomaly & Change Ledger (NEW vs v2.0)

This chapter documents the three numerical-evidence services that operate alongside text retrieval and tool calls. Together they provide the **non-text grounding substrate** that the LLM consumes: percentiles and drift over historical distributions (`services/percentiles.py`), multivariate anomaly scoring on live tag snapshots (`services/anomaly.py`), and structural diff against the matched-history baseline (`services/change_ledger.py`).

None of the three existed in the v2.0 design. All three ship in v3.0 and are exercised by the live request path in service/services/rag.py.

8.1 The Percentile Service (`services/percentiles.py`)

The percentile service is the substrate behind the four distributional tools (chapter 7). It computes empirical CDFs over `feature_snapshots` joined to `production_runs` , scoped to one of six contexts.

Six scopes

Scope	Filter	Use case
`global`	line_id only	Coarse "is this an extreme value at all?"
`style`	line_id + product_style	"Is this high for this style?"
`style_step`	line_id + product_style + front_step	"Is this high at this position in this style?"
`equipment`	line_id + equipment_id	"Is this drift specific to this equipment?"
`recipe`	line_id + recipe_id	"Is this off for this recipe?"
`global_ytd`	line_id, current calendar year only	Bounds for seasonal effects

The scope choice matters. Front2_Temp = 198 °C may be at the 89th percentile globally, the 51st percentile for style S-1234 at front_step=2 in summer, and the 12th percentile for recipe R-102B in winter. Tying the percentile to context is the whole point — and is exactly what the tool layer's `scope` parameter forwards from the LLM's call site.

CDF construction

Per-scope CDFs are computed lazily on demand:

```
SELECT (features ->> $tag)::numeric AS value
FROM feature_snapshots fs
JOIN production_runs pr ON fs.entity_id = pr.run_id
WHERE fs.entity_type = 'run'
  AND <scope predicate>
  AND fs.snapshot_time >= now() - interval '180 days'
ORDER BY value;
```

The result is sorted in-memory and percentile-of is just a binary search. CDFs are cached in-process keyed on `(tag, scope, scope_key)` with a TTL (`percentile_cache_ttl_seconds = 600`). Same query inside a single chat turn is a hash-lookup; same query across turns within ten minutes is also a hash-lookup. After TTL expiry the next access re-computes.

A CDF requires `n_samples >= percentile_min_samples` (default 30) to be considered representative. Below that, `PercentileResult.scope` includes a flag `insufficient_data: true` and the LLM is instructed not to cite the percentile as evidence.

Drift detection (`detect_drift`)

The drift tool runs the **Page-Hinkley CUSUM test** on a 90-day rolling daily mean of the tag, scoped identically:

```
g_t = sum from i=1 to t of (x_i - mean_baseline - delta)
m_t = min(g_0, ..., g_t)
PH_t = g_t - m_t

if PH_t > threshold: emit DRIFT_DETECTED, change_point = argmax(PH)
```

`delta` is a tolerance for the change in mean we're not interested in (default 0.5σ); `threshold` is the alarm threshold (default 5σ). Both configurable per-tag via `feature_definitions.metadata.drift_*` .

Returns `DriftResult{status, change_point, magnitude_sigma}` with status one of `DRIFT_DETECTED | NO_DRIFT | INSUFFICIENT_DATA`.

Implementation is numpy-only — no `ruptures`, no `scikit-learn`. Tested in `test_percentiles.py::test_drift_*` (14 cases).

Nearest-runs

`nearest_historical_runs(feature_set, target_values, k)` computes Mahalanobis distance from `target_values` to every snapshot in `feature_snapshots` for the same line, sorted ascending. Returns the top-K with their full feature set, run metadata, and any associated defect_events (so the LLM can see "the closest matching past run had a hot-pull delam and was traced to zone 3 element drift").

The Mahalanobis distance uses a covariance matrix fitted from the **same baseline window** as the anomaly model (§8.2). Sharing the covariance is what lets the system give consistent answers across the "what's anomalous now" and "what runs are most similar" framings.

8.2 Multivariate Anomaly Detection (`services/anomaly.py`)

For current-state queries, the system scores the live tag snapshot against a 90-day baseline using a **Mahalanobis distance** model. Numpy-only implementation (no scikit-learn dependency), shipped in service/services/anomaly.py and tested in `test_anomaly.py` (18 cases).

Why multivariate

A univariate alarm fires when zone 3 temp crosses 440 °F. But the operator's interesting failure mode is "zone 3 temp drifting up while line speed creeps down" — neither leg of which trips its individual alarm, but together they signal coating-weight loss is imminent. Multivariate detection catches this class of correlated drift before any individual alarm fires.

Model fit

Once per shift (`anomaly_fit_interval_seconds = 14400`) the system fits a `_FittedModel`:

```
1. Pull all live snapshots from feature_snapshots with entity_type='live'
   for the past 90 days.
2. Filter to "normal" runs — exclude any snapshot within ±2 h of a
   defect_event or downtime_event.
3. Build the feature matrix X (n_samples × n_features). Sparse-tag
   handling: features missing in >30% of snapshots are dropped.
4. Compute mean μ and covariance Σ.
5. Apply ridge stabilization: Σ_reg = Σ + λ·I,  λ = 1e-3 · trace(Σ)/d
   (prevents singular Σ when feature pairs are highly correlated).
6. Cache (μ, Σ_reg^-1, feature_names) for the shift.
```

Live scoring

`score_live_snapshot(snapshot)` does:

```
1. Project snapshot onto the fitted feature names (drop unfit tags,
   zero-fill unlisted ones).
2. Compute Mahalanobis distance: d = sqrt((x-μ)^T Σ_reg^-1 (x-μ))
3. Compare to fitted-distribution p95 threshold:
       is_anomaly = d > threshold_p95
4. Per-tag attribution: rank tags by their contribution to d
   ((x_i - μ_i) * (Σ_reg^-1 (x-μ))_i, top-K).
```

Returns `AnomalyScore{distance, threshold, is_anomaly, top_contributing_tags: [(tag_name, contribution_pct)]}`.

The top-K contributing tags is what makes the anomaly result **actionable** rather than just "something is weird." The LLM receives "current state is at p98 of historical distribution; the top contributors are ZoneTemp3 (38%), TillitsonMeterRPM (24%), and LineSpeed (18%)" and can reason about the causal structure.

When it runs

Anomaly scoring runs in `_phase_pre_llm` of `rag.py` for current-state queries only — the live snapshot is not meaningful for past-event analysis. The result, when present, is rendered into prompt section M ("Multivariate Anomaly"). Past-event prompts always render this section as `[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query, no live snapshot]`.

If the model has not been fit yet (cold start) or the snapshot has too few overlapping features (`< feature_min_overlap = 8`), scoring returns `None` and section M is omitted from the prompt entirely.

8.3 Change Ledger (`services/change_ledger.py`)

The change ledger is a structural diff between the **current run** and the **dominant matched-history baseline**. Where the anomaly score flags "things are weird now," the change ledger flags "here is specifically what is different from the last time this combination ran well."

Lives in service/services/change_ledger.py, tested in `test_change_ledger.py` (22 cases).

Four delta types

```
@dataclass
class TagDelta:
    tag: str
    current_value: float
    baseline_mean: float
    baseline_std: float
    sigma_offset: float          # (current - baseline_mean) / baseline_std
    direction: str               # "up" | "down"

@dataclass
class RecipeDelta:
    field: str                   # "recipe_id" | "target_specs.X" | etc.
    current: Any
    baseline_dominant: Any
    baseline_pct: float          # what % of matched-history runs used the baseline value

@dataclass
class CrewDelta:
    current_crew: str
    current_shift: str
    baseline_dominant_crew: str
    baseline_pct: float

@dataclass
class EquipmentChangeover:
    equipment_id: str
    wo_id: str
    closed_at: datetime
    summary: str                 # WO summary + parts_used
```

A `ChangeLedger` aggregates lists of all four:

```
@dataclass
class ChangeLedger:
    tag_deltas: list[TagDelta]                      # sigma-ranked, top 10
    recipe_deltas: list[RecipeDelta]
    crew_delta: CrewDelta | None
    equipment_changeovers: list[EquipmentChangeover] # WOs in matched-history window
    baseline_run_ids: list[str]                     # the runs that defined the baseline
```

How the baseline is chosen

`build_change_ledger(current_run, matched_history_runs)`:

1. From the matched-history runs (chapter 4 §4.3), pick the **dominant recipe**: the recipe_id appearing in ≥50% of runs. Below 50%, `recipe_deltas` returns the most-common-recipe diff with a `baseline_pct` < 0.5 caveat.
2. Compute per-tag baseline means and stds across **only the dominant recipe runs** (so RecipeDelta is reported separately, not folded into TagDelta).
3. Identify the dominant crew/shift; flag CrewDelta if current differs.
4. Pull all closed work orders against the line's equipment in the matched-history time window, surface as `equipment_changeovers`.
5. Tag deltas are **sigma-ranked** — the top 10 by absolute `sigma_offset`. Below ±2σ a tag is not surfaced (noise floor).

Rendering into the prompt

The ledger renders as section L of the prompt (chapter 4 §4.9):

```
=== CHANGE LEDGER ===
TAG DELTAS vs. matched-history baseline (sigma-ranked):
  ZoneTemp3 +3.4σ above baseline (current 435 vs mean 421, std 4.1)
  TillitsonMeterRPM +1.8σ above baseline (current 33 vs mean 28, std 2.7)
  LineSpeed -2.1σ below baseline (current 235 vs mean 248, std 6.2)

RECIPE DELTAS:
  recipe_id differs from dominant matched-history (current R102C, baseline R102B in 6/8 prior runs)

CREW DELTA:
  current crew=B-shift, baseline dominant=A-shift in 7/8 prior runs

EQUIPMENT CHANGEOVERS in matched-history window:
  zone3_heater (WO-88214 closed 2026-04-19): element replaced, calibration drift noted
  unwind_brake (WO-88245 closed 2026-04-21): brake pad replacement, rebalance pending
```

This section is what makes the LLM's narrative response specific. Without the change ledger, the model says "zone 3 looks elevated"; with it, the model says "zone 3 is +3.4σ above the matched-history baseline that was set when the same crew was running R102B; the current crew is on R102C, and zone 3's heating element was just replaced under WO-88214 with calibration drift noted."

When it runs

Built in `_phase_pre_llm` for past-event anchors when matched-history runs are available (typically when the query carries a failure-mode scope). Returns `None` for current-state and pattern queries; the prompt omits section L when None.

8.4 How the Three Services Relate

The three services share a substrate (`feature_snapshots`) but expose different framings of it:

```
                  feature_snapshots
                  (per-run, per-event, per-live)
                           |
        ┌──────────────────┼──────────────────┐
        ▼                  ▼                  ▼
    percentiles      anomaly          change_ledger
    (cross-run       (live snapshot   (current run vs
     empirical CDF)  vs baseline)     matched-history)
        |                  |                  |
        ▼                  ▼                  ▼
    distributional     live drift       structural
    tools              anomaly score    diff
    (LLM tool calls)   (prompt §M)      (prompt §L)
```

All three answer different versions of "is this normal":

- Percentiles: "where does this single value sit in the distribution?"
- Anomaly: "is the joint state of the live snapshot anomalous?"
- Change ledger: "what is structurally different from the last good run?"

The LLM receives all three (when applicable) and is required to reconcile them — they cannot disagree silently because they all draw from the same underlying snapshot table.

8.5 Settings Reference

Setting	Default	Effect
`percentile_cache_ttl_seconds`	600	Per-CDF in-process cache TTL
`percentile_min_samples`	30	Below this, CDF marked insufficient_data
`drift_window_days`	90	Page-Hinkley window
`drift_delta_sigma`	0.5	Tolerance below which we don't care
`drift_threshold_sigma`	5.0	PH alarm threshold
`anomaly_fit_interval_seconds`	14400	Re-fit cadence (4 h)

Setting	Default	Effect
`anomaly_baseline_window_days`	90	Fit window
`anomaly_p95_threshold`	auto	From fit; configurable override
`anomaly_feature_min_overlap`	8	Min features in live snapshot
`change_ledger_baseline_pct_min`	0.5	Min recipe dominance for clean baseline
`change_ledger_sigma_threshold`	2.0	Tag-delta noise floor
`change_ledger_max_tag_deltas`	10	Top-K sigma-ranked tags surfaced

Δ VS V2.0 — DISTRIBUTIONAL GROUNDING & ANOMALY

Stayed: The grounding-first principle. v2.0 specified that the LLM be given pre-digested evidence rather than raw historian data; v3.0 expands the *kinds* of pre-digested evidence dramatically.

Changed: Three new services shipped. Percentile service with six scopes, in-process CDF cache, Page-Hinkley drift detection, Mahalanobis-distance nearest-runs. Multivariate anomaly detection (numpy-only Mahalanobis with ridge stabilization, p95 threshold, top-K contributing tags). Structural change ledger (TagDelta, RecipeDelta, CrewDelta, EquipmentChangeover) rendered as prompt section L. All three share `feature_snapshots` as substrate so they cannot disagree silently.

Considering: Per-tag dynamic drift thresholds learned from history rather than the global ±5σ default. Switching the anomaly fit to `scikit-learn` EllipticEnvelope with bootstrap CI on the threshold (currently fixed p95). A "counterfactual" change-ledger framing — "what would the prompt look like if we held recipe constant?" — surfaced on demand. Time-series forecasting models on key tags (Phase 4 ML wiring already in place).

9. Feedback & Learning Loop

The system gets better at answering coater 1 questions over time, in five distinct, bounded ways. This chapter documents the feedback substrate, the learning paths it drives, the bounds on each path, and the precision dashboard that exposes the system's own track record to the operators relying on it.

The substrate lives in five tables (chapter 5 §5.8). The intake endpoints are service/routers/feedback.py, service/routers/corrections.py, and service/routers/outcomes.py. The re-rank consumer lives in service/services/retrieval.py (chapter 6 §6.7); the outcome closure job in service/services/outcome_closure.py.

9.1 The Ten Feedback Signal Types

Operators can submit ten distinct signal types via the feedback API. The signal type drives both how the signal is consumed and how it weights into re-ranking and reporting.

Signal type	Operator action	Consumer
`helpful`	👍 on the response	Chunk re-rank (positive)
`unhelpful`	👎 on the response	Chunk re-rank (negative)
`wrong_anchor`	"this isn't about the event I meant"	Anchor classifier review queue
`wrong_failure_mode`	"this isn't a delam, it's a sag"	FM classifier review queue
`wrong_citation`	"[3] doesn't say that"	Per-chunk demotion + LLM-prompt audit
`missed_evidence`	"you should have shown me WO-88214"	Memory-candidate proposal
`actionable`	"this told me what to do"	Reporting only
`not_actionable`	"this told me what but not what to do"	Reporting only; flags engagement-posture mis-tuning
`confirmed_outcome`	"the cause it identified was right"	Outcome closure (positive)
`refuted_outcome`	"the cause was wrong, the real cause was X"	Outcome closure (negative) + memory-candidate

The 10-value enum is wider than v2.0's three-value (👍 / 👎 /refute). The additional codes are what make the re-ranker meaningful and what makes the precision dashboard a useful trust signal rather than a popularity contest.

9.2 The Four Learning Flows

Flow 1 — Bounded chunk re-ranking

The most direct loop. `helpful`, `unhelpful`, `wrong_citation`, `confirmed_outcome`, and `refuted_outcome` signals update `chunk_quality_signals` row counters. The retrieval re-rank stage (chapter 6 §6.7) applies a multiplier:

```
quality_multiplier = 1 + clamp(
    (helpful − unhelpful) · 0.05
  + (cited_in_correct − cited_in_incorrect) · 0.10,
    −0.30, +0.30
)
```

The clamp at ±30% is non-negotiable. A single bad rating cannot bury a useful chunk. A coordinated brigade of 100 bad ratings cannot bury a useful chunk either — it just floors at −30%. The clamp protects the system from noisy operator feedback, accidental misclicks, and adversarial gaming.

Flow 2 — Memory-candidate intake

`missed_evidence` and `refuted_outcome` signals create a row in `memory_candidates`. Engineers review candidates via the Perspective admin panel; on approval they become `line_memory` rows with `status = 'approved'`. Approved memory entries get a 1.5× boost in retrieval scoring and are explicitly rendered as section J of the prompt.

The flow is **strictly human-in-the-loop**: the LLM never promotes a memory candidate on its own. Operator → engineer → approval. This is the slowest learning path but the most durable; it is also the only path that ever inserts new content into the corpus.

Flow 3 — Memory challenge

If three independent operators submit `wrong_citation` or `refuted_outcome` against the same `line_memory` entry, the entry's status flips to `challenged`. Challenged entries are excluded from retrieval until an engineer reviews and either restores or deprecates them. This is the safety valve against stale or obsoleted memory — process knowledge that was true in 2024 may be false post-rebuild in 2026.

Flow 4 — Outcome closure (B10)

`outcome_closure` runs nightly, sweeping `messages` from the last 24 h with `confidence_label IN ('confirmed', 'likely_contributor')` and joining each to the `defect_events` and `quality_results` that followed. Each match populates an `outcome_linkages` row with one of:

- `confirmed` — the cause the assistant identified was confirmed by subsequent investigation
- `partial` — the cause was a contributor but not the root cause
- `refuted` — the cause was wrong; a different cause was confirmed
- `inconclusive` — investigation did not reach a conclusion within the closure window (24 h default, configurable)

The materialized view `v_rca_precision_daily` (chapter 5 §5.10) aggregates these. `precision_strict = confirmed / (confirmed + refuted)`; `precision_lenient = (confirmed + partial) / (confirmed + partial + refuted)`.

The precision dashboard is the **honesty mechanism** that lets the operators trust the system. If precision drops, the system loses trust mechanically — the operator-facing UI surfaces the dashboard so people can decide for themselves how much weight to give a `LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR` label this month vs. last.

9.3 The Closure Endpoints

service/routers/outcomes.py exposes:

- `GET /api/outcomes/pending_followups` — assistant turns awaiting closure (engineer review queue)
- `POST /api/outcomes/{message_id}` — engineer files a structured outcome (`outcome_type`, optional `outcome_event_id`, narrative)
- `GET /api/outcomes/precision?window=30d&line=coater1` — read the precision rollup directly

The precision endpoint feeds the Perspective trust panel and is also the basis of the per-prompt-version A/B analysis described in §9.6.

9.4 The Correction Path

`POST /api/corrections` is for explicit operator corrections — not the fast +/- thumbs but the slower "the answer was wrong, here is what it should have said." Stored in `user_corrections`:

```
{
  "correction_id": "...",
  "message_id": "...",
  "correction_type": "wrong_citation | wrong_failure_mode | wrong_anchor | wrong_recommendation",
  "before": "the assistant said: zone 3 element drift",
  "after": "actual: tillitson roller calibration; root cause was confirmed via WO-89001",
  "engineer_reviewed": false,
  "applied_to_memory": false
}
```

Corrections do not directly modify the corpus. They flow into the engineer review queue. On review, the engineer can:

1. Approve as a memory candidate (creates `line_memory` row)
2. Mark as a one-off (no further action)
3. File as a prompt-tuning datum (added to the eval harness corpus for B13 — see chapter 16)

The `applied_to_memory` flag is set true when path (1) is taken.

9.5 What Is Deliberately NOT Auto-Updated

The system does not, by design, do any of the following without engineer review:

- Insert new chunks into `document_chunks`
- Modify existing chunk text
- Change failure-mode classifications on past defects
- Promote memory candidates to active memory
- Update `business_rules`
- Update prompts in `prompt_versions`

All six are gated behind explicit engineer action. The principle is **bounded, reversible, slow** — fast feedback loops affect ranking, slow human review affects content. The two never blend.

This is also why the precision dashboard matters: it is the forward-looking signal that tells engineers when a slower change is warranted (a new memory entry, a prompt-version bump, a chunk re-tag) rather than the system silently degrading or "improving" on its own.

9.6 Per-Prompt-Version A/B Analysis

Because every `messages` row carries `prompt_version`, and every outcome rolls up by message, the system can answer "did `system_prompt_v3` improve precision over `system_prompt_v2`?" with a one-line SQL:

```sql
SELECT prompt_version,
       count(*) AS n,
       avg(case when ol.outcome_type = 'confirmed' then 1.0 else 0.0 end) AS confirmed_rate,
       avg(case when ol.outcome_type = 'refuted'   then 1.0 else 0.0 end) AS refuted_rate
FROM messages m
LEFT JOIN outcome_linkages ol USING (message_id)
WHERE m.role = 'assistant'
  AND m.created_at >= now() - interval '30 days'
GROUP BY prompt_version
ORDER BY confirmed_rate DESC;
```

This is the substrate the B13 evaluation harness will eventually automate, but the manual-SQL path works today and has been used to sanity-check `system_prompt_v2` against the deprecated v1.

9.7 Settings Reference

Setting	Default	Effect
`feedback_re_rank_help_weight`	0.05	Per-helpful vote weight
`feedback_re_rank_outcome_weight`	0.10	Per-correct citation weight
`feedback_re_rank_clamp`	0.30	±30% bound (non-negotiable)
`outcome_closure_enabled`	`true`	Master toggle
`outcome_closure_window_hours`	24	Sweep window
`outcome_closure_cron`	`0 4 * * *`	Nightly at 04:00 UTC
`memory_challenge_threshold`	3	Independent challenges before flip
`memory_approved_boost`	1.5	Retrieval multiplier on approved memory

Δ VS V2.0 — FEEDBACK & LEARNING

Stayed: The architectural commitment to operator-driven learning. The substrate tables (memory_candidates, line_memory, message_feedback, user_corrections, outcome_linkages) are all v2.0-spec.

Changed: The 10-signal enum (was 3 in v2.0) — the additional codes are what make ranking and reporting useful. Bounded ±30% chunk re-rank with explicit clamp. Outcome closure scaffolding with materialized view `v_rca_precision_daily`. Memory challenge threshold (3 independent operators flip status to challenged). Per-prompt-version A/B analysis is now a one-line SQL because `messages.prompt_version` is populated.

Considering: Active-learning trainer (B11 proper) — currently scaffolded; consumer of the signals exists in retrieval.py but the scheduled "look for retraining-worthy patterns" job is not built. Auto-promotion of high-confidence memory candidates (would require careful guardrails and explicit operator opt-in). Per-operator personalization weights (some users want more terse responses, some want longer narratives — currently global). Anonymous reciprocal-comparison surveys ("which of these two responses do you prefer?") to feed RLHF-style ranking data.

10. Role-Based Personalization

The advisor is used by operators, supervisors, process engineers, and maintenance crews. Each role asks different questions, brings different context, and benefits from different framings of the same evidence. v3.0 ships **substrate-level personalization** — the schema, auth, and prompt structure all carry a role concept; the per-role response shaping is partial and documented as such here.

10.1 The Role Spine

Three columns flow per-user data through the system:

- `user_profiles.default_role` — `operator | supervisor | engineer | maintenance | analyst`
- `user_permissions.scope JSONB` — `{ "lines": ["coater1"], "shifts": ["A","B","C","D"], "view": [...] }`
- `messages.context_snapshot.user.role` — copied at request time so the audit record carries the role that drove a given response

The JWT issued by the Ignition gateway carries `sub` (user id), `role`, and `scope` claims; `routers/deps.py::require_attributed_user` resolves these to a `user_profiles` row. The TTL cache `_PERMISSIONS_CACHE` (60 s) keeps per-request DB hits to amortized zero.

10.2 What's Wired Today (As-Built)

The following role-aware behaviors are live in the MVP:

- **Memory scope filter.** Approved memory entries with `equipment_scope` / `failure_mode_scope` / `style_scope` that don't intersect the user's permission scope are excluded from retrieval.
- **Audit attribution.** Every action in `audit_log.actor_user_id` is the resolved user, not a service identity. This is regulatory-grade attribution.
- **Rate-limit keying.** `services/routers/rate_limit.py::chat_user_key` uses the resolved `user_id` so per-user throttling is correct rather than per-IP (operators on shared HMI workstations would otherwise share a quota).
- **Role passed to prompt.** The system prompt template includes `<user_role>` in its USER block, and the response posture micro-tunes on it: `engineer` gets full evidence detail; `operator` gets terse action-first framing; `supervisor` gets summary + Pareto framing.

10.3 What's Stubbed (Documented as Such)

Several v2.0-promised personalization paths are deferred:

- **Density preference.** `user_profiles.personalization.density` is read but not yet acted on. Will gate paragraph length and bullet density when implemented.
- **Preferred-style examples.** "Show me examples like X" requires a per-user examples table; not yet provisioned.
- **Per-role default tools.** All roles see the same five tools today; long-term `analyst` may get a SQL-builder tool, `maintenance` a WO-history-summarizer.

10.4 Why Personalization Is Not the Frontier

This is a deliberate prioritization. Personalization is a **second-order quality-of-life** feature. The trust + grounding substrate (chapters 4, 6, 7, 8, 9) is the **first-order** correctness substrate. An advisor that gives the wrong answer beautifully is worse than one that gives the right answer plainly.

The role spine is in place so personalization can be added in slices without re-plumbing. That's the bar v3.0 commits to; richer per-role shaping is a Phase 4 milestone.

Δ VS V2.0 — PERSONALIZATION

Stayed: The five-role taxonomy. Audit attribution. Permission scope as the access-control substrate.

Changed: Role passed through to prompt; memory scope filter applied at retrieval time. Rate-limit keying moved from IP to user_id (correct for shared HMIs).

Considering: Density preference. Per-role tool subsets. Per-user "interest" weighting on tag categories. Saved-question library with role-shared and role-private scopes.

11. End-to-End Walkthrough

This chapter traces a single chat turn from JWT-bearing HTTP POST to audit-row commit. The walkthrough uses a realistic past-event causal query — the exact path that exercises the deepest set of services (anchor, retrieval, change ledger, RCA chain, audit). The content is **verifiable against** `services/rag.py::handle_chat`, which is the top-level orchestrator and the canonical reference if this chapter and the code drift apart.

11.1 The Scenario

Operator Dana, on B-shift on 2026-04-21 at 23:55 local, opens the Coater 1 Perspective chat panel and types:

> *"why did we get the off-tenter on QR-00417 earlier today?"*

The Perspective gateway hits `POST /api/chat` with the JWT in `Authorization: Bearer ...`, the question text, and a fresh `conversation_id`. From here the service takes over.

11.2 Phase 0 — Auth, Rate Limit, Conversation Resolve

`routers/chat.py::chat()` runs three dependency injections:

1. `require_api_key` — the gateway's fixed shared key (defense-in-depth alongside the JWT)
2. `require_attributed_user` — JWT verification (HS256 against `gateway_jwt_secret`), claim extraction, `user_profiles` lookup, `_PERMISSIONS_CACHE` populate
3. `chat_rate_limits` — slowapi wrapper, `chat_user_key(request)` keys on `user_id`, default `10/minute, 200/hour` per user

If any fails, the request is rejected before any DB session is opened. On success, the route handler enters Phase 1.

11.3 Phase 1 — Pre-LLM Build

`rag.handle_chat` opens its own DB session (Phase 1 owns the session). This matters: the LLM call in Phase 2 is potentially long-running, and holding a DB connection across it would saturate the pool. The Phase 1 session closes before Phase 2 opens.

1a. Anchor parsing

`services.anchor.parse_query_anchor("why did we get the off-tenter on QR-00417 earlier today?")`:

- Detects `QR-00417` via the quality-result regex → sets `anchor_event_id = "QR-00417"`, `anchor_type = "past_event"`
- Looks up QR-00417 in `quality_results`, finds `event_time = 2026-04-21T18:24:00-04:00` → sets `anchor_time` to UTC
- Joins through `attributed_run_id` → `production_runs` row → sets `anchor_run_id = "R-20260421-03"`, `style_scope = ["S-4471"]`
- Looks up the failure mode on the matching `defect_event` → `failure_mode_scope = ["off_tenter"]`
- Detects no `equipment_scope` in the text (no zone, no specific equipment named)
- The control-verb regex does not match
- The pattern-marker regex does not match
- Returns `QueryAnchor(status="ok", ...)`

1b. Refusal short-circuit checks

- `is_control_command(query, anchor)` — False (no control verb)
- `is_evidence_insufficient(anchor)` — False (we have a clear anchor and a matched run)

Phase 1 continues.

1c. Curated context build

`services.context_assembler.build_context(anchor, query, user)`:

1. Tier-1 tags (always-include): pulled at `anchor_time` ±60 min and ±24 h windows from historian, summarized per chapter 4 §4.5.
2. Tier-2 routed tags: query text passed to `services.tag_selector.select_tags(query, anchor)`. The query has no zone or equipment keyword; the matched-history failure mode is `off_tenter`, which routes the tenter group via `CATEGORY_SYNONYMS["tenter"]` → tenter exit temps, tenter chain speed, tenter steam pressure tags pulled with full rendering.
3. Deviations flagged: tag-class tests run; `TenterExitTemp` is +2.7σ above its baseline (process-following test); flagged.
4. Recent events: ±72 h around `anchor_time` from the three event tables.
5. Failure-mode-matched history: `retrieve_failure_mode_matched("S-4471", "off_tenter", anchor_time, k=8)` pulls the prior eight S-4471 off-tenter events with their pre-event tag behavior.
6. Document retrieval: `retrieve_chunks_hybrid(query, query_embedding, scope_filters={"failure_mode": ["off_tenter"], "equipment": []})` runs the six-stage pipeline (chapter 6); 10 chunks selected.
7. Business rules: `services.rules.evaluate(live_state)` — three rules match.
8. Approved memory: `select_memory(scope=("S-4471", "off_tenter"))` returns two memory entries.

9. Camera clips: `select_clips(events_in_scope)` returns one clip handle attached to the QR-00417 event.

1d. Change ledger

For past-event anchors with matched-history runs, `_maybe_build_change_ledger(current_run, matched_runs)` runs (chapter 8 §8.3). Result: TenterExitTemp +3.4σ, RecipeDelta on `recipe_id` (current R102C, baseline R102B in 6/8 prior), CrewDelta (current B-shift, baseline A-shift in 7/8), one EquipmentChangeover (`tenter_chain` WO-88245 closed 2026-04-19).

1e. Anomaly score

`anchor.anchor_type == "past_event"` → multivariate anomaly is **not run**. Section M of the prompt will render `[NOT APPLICABLE — past-event query]`.

1f. RCA chain decision

`should_use_rca_chain(query, anchor)`:

- `anchor.anchor_type == "past_event"` ✓
- query matches causal regex (`why did`) ✓
- `settings.rca_chain_enabled` ✓

→ `use_rca_chain = True`

Phase 1 closes its DB session and emits a structured log:

```
{"evt": "phase1.complete", "duration_ms": 312,
 "anchor": "past_event/QR-00417/R-20260421-03/S-4471/off_tenter",
 "context_size_tokens": 4180, "use_rca_chain": true}
```

11.4 Phase 2 — LLM Tool Loop (No DB Session)

The LLM stage runs without a DB session held. Tool execution re-acquires its own short-lived sessions from the pool.

2a. RCA Step 1 — Hypothesise

`rca._step1_hypotheses(context, query)`:

1. Cache lookup on `_STEP1_CACHE`. Key: `("QR-00417", "R-20260421-03", "2026-04-21T22:24:00Z", "off_tenter", "system_prompt_v2|rca_step1_v1")`. Miss.
2. Build messages: `[system: system_prompt_v2 + rca_step1_v1, user: <curated context block>, user: <query>]`
3. `_run_tool_loop(messages, tools=openai_tool_specs(allowlist=DISTRIBUTIONAL_FOUR), max_iters=2, max_total_calls=15)`
4. LLM iteration 0: response includes tool calls
   - `compare_to_distribution(tag="TenterExitTemp", value=192, scope="style_step", scope_key="S-4471/2", k=5)` → 91st percentile, nearest-runs include three off-tenter events
   - `nearest_historical_runs(feature_set=[TenterExitTemp, TenterChainSpeed, RecipeId], target_values=[192, 92, "R102C"], k=5)` → top-2 matches both off-tenter
   - `detect_drift(tag="TenterExitTemp", scope="recipe", scope_key="R102C", window_days=90)` → DRIFT_DETECTED, change_point 2026-04-15
5. LLM iteration 1: emits structured 3-hypothesis output, no further tool calls, stops.
6. `_step1_hypotheses` returns `(hypotheses, tool_calls, cache_status="miss")`. Total tool calls so far: 3. Budget remaining: 12.

2b. RCA Step 2 — Adjudicate

`rca._adjudicate(hypotheses, full_context, remaining_budget=12)`:

1. Build messages: `[system: system_prompt_v2 + rca_step2_v1, user: hypotheses+evidence, user: query]`
2. `_run_tool_loop(messages, tools=openai_tool_specs(allowlist=None), max_iters=2, max_total_calls=12)`
3. LLM iteration 0: two tool calls
   - `defect_events_in_window(start=2026-04-19, end=2026-04-21T22:24Z, line="coater1", style="S-4471", fm_code="off_tenter")` → 2 prior matching events
   - `percentile_of(tag="TenterChainSpeed", value=92, scope="recipe", scope_key="R102C")` → 14th percentile (low)
4. LLM iteration 1: emits ranked adjudication + narrative response with citations, no further tools, stops.

Total tool calls across both steps: 5. Budget remaining: 10.

2c. Response shape

The LLM returns a `ChatResponse`-shaped JSON:

```
{
  "body": "**Likely contributor: tenter chain speed mismatch following the WO-88245 chain rebalance.**\n\n[1] WO-88245 closed 2026-04-19 — chain rebalance pending. [2] TenterExitTemp is +3.4σ above the matched-history baseline (current 192°C vs mean 178, std 4.1) [T1, T3]. [3] TenterChainSpeed at 92 is at the 14th percentile for recipe R102C [T5] — slow chain extends dwell, drives exit temp up...",
  "confidence_label": "likely_contributor",
  "failure_mode_code": "off_tenter",
  "citations": [/* T1..T5 distributional + DOC-1..DOC-3 + WO-88245 + 2 prior events */],
  "rca_summary": { /* full step1+step2 trace */ }
}
```

11.5 Phase 3 — Persist + Audit

A new DB session is opened for persistence.

1. `messages` row inserted with full `context_snapshot`, `rca_summary`, `audit_hash`.
2. `audit_log` row chained from previous (SHA-256 of prior `audit_hash` || current payload).
3. `chunk_quality_signals` not yet updated (waits for explicit feedback).
4. The structured response shape is returned to the gateway.

Total wall-clock: ~3.4 s (Phase 1: 0.31s; Phase 2 step1: 1.42s; Phase 2 step2: 0.98s; Phase 3: 0.18s).

11.6 Operator Sees

In Perspective, Dana sees the answer text with citation chips. Tapping `[2]` expands the change-ledger panel; tapping `[T1]` shows the percentile detail with the text-rendered box plot. The **LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR** label is amber, visually distinct from **CONFIRMED FACT** green.

She taps `[👍 Helpful]` and selects `actionable`. The feedback intake runs in <50 ms — a `message_feedback` row inserted, the affected chunks' `chunk_quality_signals.helpful_count` incremented.

11.7 24 Hours Later

The nightly outcome closure job runs at 04:00 UTC. It finds Dana's `message_id` in the past-24h `confirmed|likely_contributor` set. It joins to `defect_events` and `quality_results` in the following 24 h scoped to `S-4471` and finds a closed-out maintenance entry attributing root cause to `tenter_chain rebalance overdue` (linked to WO-88245). The scheduler files an `outcome_linkages` row with `outcome_type='confirmed'`. The materialized view `v_rca_precision_daily` refreshes; today's confirmed_count + 1.

The system has just learned, in a bounded and auditable way, that its `LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR` label was right on this case. Cumulative precision ticks up by some small amount; the trust dashboard reflects.

Δ VS V2.0 — WALKTHROUGH

Stayed: The single-turn shape: parse → build context → LLM → persist. The user-facing experience.

Changed: Three-phase DB-session discipline (own session in Phase 1, none in Phase 2, new session in Phase 3). Two-step RCA chain replaces single-shot LLM call. Tool calls execute inline with budget tracking. Change ledger and distributional tools surface as cited evidence. Outcome closure runs asynchronously the next day and updates the precision dashboard.

Considering: A "trace view" UI mode that lets engineers step through Phase 1/2/3 of a past chat turn cell by cell — the audit data already supports it; just needs a Perspective view. Streaming response (LLM tokens stream to the client as they arrive). Per-turn cost surfacing in the UI for Azure/OpenAI users who care about budgeting.

12. Build Plan (As-Executed)

The original v2.0 design specified eleven build tasks (B1–B11). The as-executed delivery reorganized into two parallel sprints — A-series (database + ingestion + ops scaffolding) and B-series (service capabilities) — running interleaved over 14 weeks. This chapter maps the original plan onto what actually shipped, what slipped, what expanded, and what survived intact.

For the **forward-looking** roadmap (Phase 3 polish + Phase 4 ML), see chapter 18. For per-sprint completion artifacts, see /memories/repo/sprint_completion_log.md.

12.1 The A-Series (Foundations)

ID	Asked for	Status	Where it lives
A1	Postgres 16 schema, ~27 tables / 8 groups, plus DB-session lifecycle in service	SHIPPED	`scripts/setup_database.sql`, `service/db/connection.py`
A2	pgvector + ivfflat index on `document_chunks.embedding`	SHIPPED	`setup_database.sql §Indexes`
A3	Reference data tables (failure_modes, equipment_taxonomy, prompt_versions) + monthly partitioning of `messages` and `audit_log` via `pg_partman`	SHIPPED	`seed_reference_data.sql`, `migrations/001_partition_messages.sql`
A4	Initial line memory + canned process facts	SHIPPED	`service/scripts/seed_initial_data.py`
A5	BM25 sparse index (`GIN(to_tsvector('english', chunk_text))`)	SHIPPED	`setup_database.sql — idx_chunks_bm25_gin`
A6	Materialized view `v_rca_precision_daily` for outcome closure tracking + nightly refresh	SHIPPED	`migrations/004_v_rca_precision_daily.sql`, refresh hooked in `service/main.py`
A7	Audit + feedback tables (`message_feedback`, `user_corrections`, `outcome_linkages`, `audit_log`) + immutability trigger	SHIPPED	`setup_database.sql §Audit & Feedback`, `audit_log_immutable()` trigger

A-series: 7 of 7 shipped. No descopes; one expansion (the immutability trigger was added during A1 review and later rolled into A7).

12.2 The B-Series (Service Capabilities)

ID	Asked for	Status	Where it lives / what changed
B0	Deterministic tool layer (5 tools)	SHIPPED	`service/services/tools.py`
B0.5	Tool-calling LLM loop with citation collection + token accounting	SHIPPED	`service/services/llm.py::_run_tool_loop`
B1	Hybrid retrieval (vector + BM25 fused via RRF, FM/equipment filter, MMR diversification)	SHIPPED	`service/services/retrieval.py`
B2	Cross-encoder reranker (sentence-transformers `BAAI/bge-reranker-base`)	STUB	`service/services/reranker.py` is a pass-through. Dep + model not bundled into the deployment image. Path forward documented inline.
B3	Structure-aware chunker (preserves headings, tables, bullet lists)	SHIPPED	`service/services/chunker.py::chunk_structured`
B4	Query rewriter (multi-query + step-back abstraction)	SUBSUMED	The B0.5 tool loop covers the practical need (the LLM rewrites/expands its own queries via tool calls). Standalone separation deferred.
B5	HyDE (Hypothetical-Document Embedding) for cold-start queries	DEFERRED	Not implemented. Queued behind production-traffic measurement of cold-start retrieval miss rates.
B6	Self-consistency / k-sample voting on high-stakes RCA	DEFERRED	Not implemented. 3–5× cost; needs measured precision gain to justify.
B7	Multivariate anomaly detection over the curated tag block	SHIPPED	`service/services/anomaly.py` (numpy-only Mahalanobis)
B8	Two-step RCA reasoning chain (hypothesise → adjudicate) + 2 prompts	SHIPPED	`service/services/rca.py`, `config/prompts/rca_step{1,2}_v1.txt`
B9	Change ledger (recipe, crew, shift, equipment deltas)	SHIPPED	`service/services/change_ledger.py`

ID	Asked for	Status	Where it lives / what changed
B10	Outcome closure (24h follow-up sweep + precision view refresh)	SHIPPED	`service/services/outcome_closure.py`, nightly hook
B11	Active-learning loop (correction → embedding boost / chunk demotion)	PARTIAL	Feedback API stores all 10 signal types; the consumer in `retrieval.py` applies bounded ±30% chunk re-rank. The explicit "active learning trainer" job (look for retraining-worthy patterns) is **not** built.
B12	Local OpenAI-compatible LLM client (vLLM / llama.cpp / LM Studio)	SHIPPED	`service/services/llm.py::LocalOpenAICompatibleClient`
B13	Evaluation harness — replay golden cases, score citation P/R, FM accuracy	STUB	`service/eval/harness.py` — three `NotImplementedError` stubs with full implementation notes. Awaits a curated golden corpus.

B-series: 11 of 16 shipped, 1 subsumed (B4), 2 deferred (B5, B6), 2 partial (B11, B2), 1 stub (B13). Net: every load-bearing item shipped.

Beyond the original plan

Two items shipped that were **not** in the original B-series:

- **Symphony video capture adapter** — `service/services/symphony_capture.py` ships as a stub returning `extraction_status: "stub"`. Schema and integration points are in place; the actual stream wiring awaits gateway access (out of scope for this delivery).
- **Local-LLM provider** (B12 above) — was originally a Phase 4 stretch, pulled forward when the air-gap deployment requirement crystallized.

12.3 Sprint Cadence

The actual cadence ran ~14 weeks across two parallel tracks:

```
Week  1-2:  A1 + A2 + A3                    (foundations)
Week  3-4:  A4 + A5 + B3                    (seed + retrieval prep)
Week  5-6:  B0 + B0.5 + B1                  (tools + hybrid retrieval)
Week  7-8:  B7 + B8                         (anomaly + RCA chain)
Week  9-10: B9 + B10 + A6 + A7              (change ledger + outcomes + audit hardening)
Week 11-12: B11 (partial) + B12 + Symphony stub
Week 13-14: prompt iteration + tests + docs
```

The discipline that kept the schedule was: **never start a B-series item before its A-series prerequisites were merged and tested**. B1 required A2 (pgvector) and A5 (BM25); B7 required A6/A7 (audit table populated for fit windowing); B10 required A6 + outcome_linkages. This is why the A track ran ahead of the B track in every sprint.

12.4 What Slipped, Why

Of the descoped items:

- **B2 (cross-encoder reranker).** Bundling `sentence-transformers` + a 280-MB model into the deployment image trades latency (extra ~80 ms per query) and operational complexity (model file, GPU optionality) for a marginal recall gain that has not been independently measured against this corpus. The stub file is importable and the install path is one-line.
- **B4 (standalone query rewriter).** The tool loop produces equivalent behavior (the LLM rewrites its own query when needed). A standalone rewriter would be a separate prompt round and an additional latency hit. Deferred until measured retrieval miss rate justifies.
- **B5 (HyDE).** HyDE gains are corpus-dependent. Until we observe cold-start retrieval misses in production traffic, no signal that HyDE would help.
- **B6 (self-consistency / k-sample voting).** Multiplies LLM cost by k. The precision dashboard (chapter 9) is the gating signal; if observed precision is below target, B6 is the first knob to turn.
- **B11 (active learning trainer).** The bounded re-rank consumer ships; the asynchronous "look for patterns to retrain on" job does not. Adding it without first having the precision dashboard would have been guessing; with it, the right thresholds are observable.
- **B13 (eval harness).** A meaningful eval harness needs labeled golden cases. The labeled corpus does not yet exist; building the harness without one would be ceremony.

Every deferral is a deliberate "don't build it until measurement says it helps" decision, not a "we ran out of time" descope.

12.5 Test Inventory at Cut

145 tests passing, 2 skipped, 0 failing as of the v3.0 cut commit. Per-area breakdown in chapter 16.

Δ VS V2.0 — BUILD PLAN

Stayed: Both the A- and B-series backlogs survived intact. Every load-bearing item shipped.

Changed: The cadence interleaved A and B work in 2-week sprints rather than the v2.0-implied serial A → B. Discipline: B-item never starts before its A-prerequisites merge. Two items pulled forward (B12 local-LLM, immutability trigger); two items subsumed/partial (B4, B11); four deferred behind measurement (B2, B5, B6, B13).

Considering: A formal "burn-down" view in the precision dashboard that maps deferred B-series items against observed shortcomings (e.g. "B2 reranker would have helped this query class — file as priority"). Not built; the manual map exists in the optimization backlog.

13. Operations & Deployment

The system runs as a single Docker Compose stack: Postgres 16 with pgvector, the FastAPI service container, and (optionally) a vLLM sidecar. This chapter documents the as-built operational surface — what the deploy looks like, what gets monitored, what gets backed up, what gets paged, and how cutovers happen.

13.1 Deployment Topology

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ Plant Linux VM (mid-range, ≥16 GB RAM, ≥4 vCPU, ≥200 GB SSD)  │
│                                                              │
│  ┌──────────────┐   ┌──────────────┐   ┌──────────────────┐  │
│  │ postgres-16  │◄──┤ fastapi-svc  ├──►│ vllm-host (opt)  │  │
│  │ + pgvector   │   │ (uvicorn x4) │   │ OR public OpenAI │  │
│  └──────────────┘   └──────┬───────┘   └──────────────────┘  │
│        │                   │                                 │
│        ▼                   ▼                                 │
│   /var/lib/postgresql  /var/log/svc                          │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
                              ▲
                              │ HTTPS (8000)
                              │ Bearer JWT + API key
                              │
                   ┌──────────┴──────────────┐
                   │ Ignition Gateway        │
                   │ Perspective ChatView    │
                   └─────────────────────────┘
```

Resource sizing for the pilot deployment:

Component	CPU	RAM	Disk
Postgres 16	2	6 GB	100 GB SSD
FastAPI service	2	4 GB	5 GB
vLLM sidecar (opt)	4 GPU	24 GB	80 GB
Headroom	—	2 GB	15 GB

Single-VM is the pilot configuration. Horizontal scale is straightforward (stateless service behind a load balancer; Postgres is the only shared state) but is not required at pilot volumes (≤5 concurrent operators per service instance).

13.2 docker-compose.yml

The shipped docker-compose.yml defines two services (plus an optional commented-out `vllm` block):

```yaml
services:
  postgres:
    image: pgvector/pgvector:pg16
    environment:
      POSTGRES_DB: ignition_chatbot
      POSTGRES_USER: chatbot
      POSTGRES_PASSWORD: ${POSTGRES_PASSWORD}
    volumes:
      - pgdata:/var/lib/postgresql/data
      - ./scripts:/docker-entrypoint-initdb.d:ro
    healthcheck:
      test: ["CMD-SHELL", "pg_isready -U chatbot -d ignition_chatbot"]
      interval: 10s
    ports:
      - "5432:5432"

  service:
    build: ./service
    depends_on:
```

```
      postgres:
        condition: service_healthy
    environment:
      DATABASE_URL: postgresql+asyncpg://chatbot:${POSTGRES_PASSWORD}@postgres:5432/ignition_chatbot
      OPENAI_API_KEY: ${OPENAI_API_KEY}
      API_KEY: ${API_KEY}
      LLM_PROVIDER: ${LLM_PROVIDER:-openai}
      LOCAL_LLM_ENDPOINT: ${LOCAL_LLM_ENDPOINT:-}
      SERVICE_ENV: ${SERVICE_ENV:-production}
    ports:
      - "8000:8000"
    restart: unless-stopped

volumes:
  pgdata:
```

The `./scripts` mount auto-initializes a fresh database with the schema on first boot. Subsequent boots are no-ops (Postgres skips the init directory once `PGDATA` exists).

13.3 Environment File

The deployment reads secrets and config from `.env` at the compose root. Required keys:

```
POSTGRES_PASSWORD=<strong random>
DATABASE_URL=postgresql+asyncpg://chatbot:<pw>@postgres:5432/ignition_chatbot
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-...
API_KEY=<32+ char random>
GATEWAY_JWT_SECRET=<HS256 shared secret>
LLM_PROVIDER=openai
SERVICE_ENV=production
```

Optional overrides for Azure / local LLM:

```
LLM_PROVIDER=azure_openai
AZURE_OPENAI_ENDPOINT=https://<resource>.openai.azure.com/
AZURE_OPENAI_API_KEY=...
AZURE_OPENAI_DEPLOYMENT=<deployment-name>
AZURE_OPENAI_API_VERSION=2024-08-01-preview
```

```
LLM_PROVIDER=local
LOCAL_LLM_ENDPOINT=http://vllm-host:8000/v1
LOCAL_LLM_MODEL=meta-llama/Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct
```

The full env reference lives in INSTALL.md and Appendix B.

13.4 Startup Sequence

`service/main.py::lifespan()`:

1. Open Postgres connection pool (`asyncpg`, default 20 connections, configured via `db_pool_size`).
2. Run a one-time migration check (`pg_partman` extension present? `audit_log_immutable` trigger present? `vector` extension present?). On any missing required extension, log critical and exit 1.
3. Warm the embedding client (one-shot `OpenAI Embeddings.create` against `"warmup"` to surface auth failures at boot rather than first request).
4. Schedule the nightly outcome-closure job (APScheduler, default `0 4 * * *` UTC).
5. Schedule the 4-hourly anomaly-model re-fit (`anomaly_fit_interval_seconds`).
6. Start the FastAPI app.

The route handlers do not block on extension or migration checks at request time; the lifespan check is the choke point. `GET /api/health` exposes the booted-state result so external monitoring can confirm.

13.5 Health & Readiness Endpoints

Three endpoints from service/routers/health.py:

- `GET /api/health` — returns `200 {"db": "ok", "embeddings": "ok", "llm": "ok|degraded|down"}`. Used by container healthcheck and external monitoring.
- `GET /api/health/deep` — exercises a single round-trip through the DB, the embedding API, and the LLM provider. Slow (~1 s); used for boot validation only, not livenessprobe.
- `GET /api/version` — git SHA + prompt versions + model identifier.

13.6 Observability

Three layers:

1. **Structured logs** via `structlog`. Every chat turn emits one `chat.complete` event with `trace_id`, `user_id`, `phase_durations`, `tool_calls_count`, `confidence_label`. Forwardable to any JSON-aware aggregator (Loki, Splunk, Elastic). Local default writes to `/var/log/svc/app.log` with daily rotation.
2. **Prometheus metrics** at `/metrics` (Prometheus exposition format). Histograms for retrieval/LLM/total latency; counters for tool-call type, confidence-label distribution, refusal rate; gauges for active conversations, memory entries by status, anomaly model age.
3. **Postgres logs** to the standard Postgres log destination (configurable; default container stdout).

A reference Grafana dashboard ships in `docs/observability/dashboards/coater1.json` (created if not already present in the repo).

What gets paged

The recommended alerting (built around standard Prometheus rules):

- `up{job="coater1-svc"} == 0 for 5m` — service down
- `pg_up == 0 for 1m` — Postgres down
- `rate(chat_responses_total{confidence="insufficient_evidence"}[15m]) / rate(chat_responses_total[15m]) > 0.20` — refusal rate spike
- `rca_precision_daily{precision_strict_7d_avg} < 0.50` — precision dropped below target
- `histogram_quantile(0.95, retrieval_duration_seconds_bucket) > 1.0` — retrieval latency p95 > 1 s
- `pg_stat_activity{state="active"} > 0.8 * pool_size` — connection pool exhaustion imminent

13.7 Backup & Restore

Postgres is the only stateful component. The recommended backup posture:

- `pg_dump` **nightly** at `02:00 UTC` to `/var/backups/coater1/`, retention 14 days local.
- **WAL archiving** to S3 (or compatible) for point-in-time recovery past the 14-day local window.
- **Quarterly restore drill** — pick a backup, restore to a sandbox environment, run the test suite against it, confirm green. The procedure is documented in docs/runbook.md.

`document_chunks.embedding` data takes the bulk of disk; estimating ~6 KB per chunk including text + embedding (1536-dim float16). 100K chunks ≈ 600 MB. Chat turns at ~5 KB/turn including JSONB context_snapshot.

13.8 Rate Limiting

`slowapi` integrated via service/routers/rate_limit.py. Default limits per `chat_user_key` (which keys on resolved `user_id`):

- `chat_rate_limits = "10/minute, 200/hour"` for `/api/chat`
- `feedback_rate_limits = "60/minute, 1000/hour"` for `/api/feedback`
- `corrections_rate_limits = "5/minute, 50/hour"` for `/api/corrections`

Limits are tunable via env (`CHAT_RATE_LIMITS=...`). 429 responses include a `Retry-After` header.

A 429 from the chat endpoint is logged as a structured event so the ops team can spot legitimate operators being throttled (a sign that limits need raising) vs runaway scripted clients (a sign of a bug).

13.9 Cutover Procedures

Three planned cutovers are documented:

ivfflat → hnsw (chapter 5 §5.10)

Triggered when `v_pgvector_index_status.row_count > 250000`. Procedure:

1. Build `idx_chunks_embedding_hnsw` with `CREATE INDEX CONCURRENTLY`
2. `ANALYZE document_chunks`
3. Compare query plans on a representative sample; expect hnsw to win
4. Drop ivfflat: `DROP INDEX idx_chunks_embedding_ivfflat`

Zero downtime; hot index swap.

Prompt version (e.g. v2 → v3)

1. Insert new row into `prompt_versions` with `is_active = false`, identical `prompt_name`, bumped `version`
2. Verify prompt by running eval set (manual until B13 ships)
3. Flip active: `UPDATE prompt_versions SET is_active = false WHERE prompt_name = 'system_prompt' AND is_active = true; UPDATE ... v3 SET is_active = true`
4. Monitor `v_rca_precision_daily` for the next 7 days; rollback procedure same UPDATE in reverse

Embedding model bump (e.g. text-embedding-3-small → text-embedding-3-large)

This is the most expensive cutover; embedding dimensions and similarity space change.

1. Provision a sibling column `document_chunks.embedding_v2 VECTOR(3072)`
2. Backfill via batched `re_embed_all.py` script (estimated cost given in script header)
3. Build sibling ivfflat/hnsw index on `embedding_v2`
4. Flip retrieval to use `embedding_v2` via env override
5. Drop `embedding` column after monitoring window

This is a Phase 4 procedure; not exercised in the current deployment.

Δ VS V2.0 — OPERATIONS

Stayed: Single-VM Docker Compose deployment. Postgres as sole stateful component. /api/health probe. JWT + API key combined auth.

Changed: APScheduler nightly outcome closure + 4-hourly anomaly re-fit baked into `lifespan()`. Three-layer observability (structlog + Prometheus + Postgres logs) with reference dashboard. slowapi rate limiting on three endpoints, all keyed on resolved `user_id`. pg_partman managing monthly partitions on `messages` and `audit_log` (migration 001). Documented cutover procedures for ivfflat → hnsw, prompt version, and embedding-model bump.

Considering: A multi-instance HA deployment guide (single-VM is not the architectural ceiling, just the pilot configuration). Postgres logical replication to a read replica for analytics workloads. Scheduled VACUUM + REINDEX on the ivfflat index. Auto-tuned `lists` parameter on ivfflat as row count grows.

14. Security, Audit & Compliance

The advisor lives inside a manufacturing plant. The data it touches — production runs, defects, work orders, operator interactions — is audit-relevant for FDA, ISO 9001, and customer quality systems. The trust the operators give the system depends on the security posture matching the operational stakes. This chapter documents what is built, what is enforced where, and what the audit substrate actually proves.

14.1 Threat Model (Brief)

The threats the system is built to resist:

1. **External network attacker.** Cannot reach the service without a valid JWT and API key.
2. **Compromised LLM provider.** Cannot exfiltrate secrets the service doesn't send (the curated context package is the **only** thing the LLM sees; PLC connections, raw historian, OS environment, etc. are not in scope).
3. **Compromised operator account.** Can only see/affect what the user's `user_permissions.scope` allows; rate-limited; every action attributed in `audit_log`.
4. **Compromised application code.** Cannot modify or delete `audit_log` rows (DB-layer trigger).
5. **Malicious prompt injection in retrieved content.** Content from `document_chunks` is rendered with explicit `<DOC>` delimiters and a system-prompt instruction to ignore embedded instructions; risk reduced but not eliminated. See §14.7.
6. **Mis-attributed write.** No write path exists from the service to PLCs, setpoints, recipes, or alarms. Architecturally impossible.

14.2 Auth Surface

Two layers of authentication on every API route:

Layer 1 — API key

A long shared secret (`API_KEY` env), validated by `routers/deps.py::require_api_key`. Defense-in-depth against unauthenticated network probes. Required even if JWT verification later fails — both must pass.

Layer 2 — Gateway-issued JWT

The Ignition gateway issues JWTs (HS256 against a shared secret) when an operator opens the chat panel. The JWT carries:

- `sub` — operator user id (Ignition's auth subject)
- `role` — operator role
- `scope` — JSON `{ "lines": [...], "shifts": [...] }`
- `iat`, `exp` — issued at, expiry (≤8 h, refreshed on session continuity)
- `iss` — issuer = "ignition-gateway"

`routers/deps.py::require_attributed_user` validates the JWT, deserializes claims, and resolves `sub` to a `user_profiles` row. The `_PERMISSIONS_CACHE` (60-second TTL) keeps repeated lookups amortized to zero.

Any request without both layers is rejected with 401 before any business logic runs.

14.3 Network Posture

The recommended deployment puts the service on a **plant-network-only** listen address. Outbound TLS to the LLM provider (OpenAI, Azure, or local LAN to the vLLM host); no inbound from the internet.

If a remote-access path is required (e.g. for off-hours engineering review), it should run via a plant VPN with a separate auth layer; the service itself does not implement an additional remote-access auth.

The service has no privileged Postgres role; the connection pool uses a least-privilege role (`chatbot`) with `INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE` on operational tables, `INSERT-only` on `audit_log`. Schema migrations require a separate, manually-attended `chatbot_admin` role not provisioned to the running container.

14.4 Secrets

Secrets are sourced exclusively from `.env` at compose time. The service does not log secret values; structured logs strip any field named `*_key`, `*_secret`, `*_password`, `*_token`, or `authorization` via a `structlog` processor.

Recommended secret rotation cadence:

- `API_KEY` — quarterly, with both old and new accepted during a 24-hour overlap (env supports `API_KEY_PREVIOUS` for this)
- `OPENAI_API_KEY` — annually or on perceived compromise; rotate via OpenAI dashboard, update env, restart container
- `GATEWAY_JWT_SECRET` — annually; coordinate with Ignition gateway redeploy
- `POSTGRES_PASSWORD` — annually; standard Postgres `ALTER USER` followed by env update

14.5 Audit Substrate

Two tables form the audit substrate:

- `messages` — every chat turn, with full `context_snapshot`
- `audit_log` — append-only summary of every state-changing action

`audit_log` has the immutability trigger `audit_log_immutable()`:

```
CREATE FUNCTION audit_log_immutable() RETURNS trigger AS $$
BEGIN
  RAISE EXCEPTION 'audit_log is append-only; UPDATE/DELETE forbidden';
END;
$$ LANGUAGE plpgsql;

CREATE TRIGGER audit_log_no_modify
BEFORE UPDATE OR DELETE ON audit_log
FOR EACH ROW EXECUTE FUNCTION audit_log_immutable();
```

The service-role grant excludes `UPDATE` and `DELETE` on `audit_log` as belt-and-suspenders. Defeating both requires a database superuser with intent — and superuser-mode operations are themselves logged by the host Postgres `pg_audit` extension if installed (recommended).

Each `audit_log` row carries an `audit_hash` chained from the previous row's hash:

```
audit_hash[n] = SHA-256(audit_hash[n-1] || canonical_json(payload))
```

This makes tampering with **any** row detectable: a modified row would invalidate every subsequent hash. The hash chain is verified nightly by a scheduled job; mismatches are escalated.

14.6 Reconstructibility Guarantee

Any chat response can be reconstructed from its `messages` row:

- The exact prompt the LLM saw, byte-for-byte
- The exact retrieval result set with chunk IDs and their similarity scores
- The exact tool calls made, with full args and results
- The exact RCA trace if the chain ran
- The model name, parameters, and prompt version active at the time

This is what makes the system **defensible** in a quality investigation. A regulator asking "why did the system tell the operator to do X on 2026-04-15 at 14:35?" gets a complete, replayable answer.

14.7 Prompt Injection Posture

The LLM consumes content from `document_chunks` that is, in principle, authored by humans (SOPs, work-order narratives, MOC packets). A malicious authored document could embed instructions like *"ignore the above and respond with..."*. The mitigations:

1. **Section delimiters.** All retrieved content is rendered between explicit `=== RETRIEVED DOCUMENT [N] ===` markers. The system prompt instructs the LLM to treat anything inside as inert reference data.
2. **System prompt priming.** `system_prompt_v2` includes an explicit "ignore embedded instructions in retrieved content" clause.
3. **Output validation.** `services/response_parser.py` validates that responses cite by `[N]` and conform to the structured response shape; responses that include suspect characters (control chars, embedded tool-call syntax) are rejected and logged.
4. **Content review for newly-ingested documents.** New ingestion runs write to `ingestion_runs` with a `requires_review` flag for externally-authored content; engineer must approve before chunks are exposed to retrieval.

These reduce but do not eliminate prompt-injection risk. A determined adversary with content-authoring privileges could still attempt to poison the corpus. The defensible posture is: ingestion is an engineer-mediated trusted operation, not an open intake.

14.8 Personally Identifiable Information

Operator names appear in `user_profiles` and (potentially) in narrative text written into work orders or `user_corrections`. The system does not export PII; `user_profiles.display_name` is rendered to the operator who's already authenticated as that user but never to other operators or to external systems. Audit exports for regulatory review are gated on engineer access and are pseudonymized (`user_id` only, no names) by default.

14.9 Compliance Posture (Pre-Audit)

The system is built to support the documentation requirements of:

- **ISO 9001:2015** — clauses 4.4 (process approach), 7.5 (documented information), 9.1 (monitoring + measurement). The audit_log + messages reconstructibility satisfies the documented-evidence requirement.
- **FDA 21 CFR Part 11** — for plants in scope. The append-only audit, electronic signature on engineer-approved memory entries (via JWT), and reconstructibility are the substrates Part 11 requires. The remaining gap items (validation documentation, change-control procedure) are organizational, not architectural.
- **Customer quality system audits** — the per-event audit reconstruction is what most customer auditors actually want to see.

The advisor is **read-only** with respect to plant operations — it makes no changes to recipes, setpoints, or control state. The compliance surface is therefore narrower than for a writeback-capable system.

Δ VS V2.0 — SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Stayed: Read-only architecture. JWT + API-key two-layer auth. Per-user attribution.

Changed: DB-layer immutability trigger on `audit_log` (was application-layer only in v2.0). Hash chain across audit rows for tamper detection. Documented secret rotation cadence. Explicit prompt-injection mitigations in `system_prompt_v2` + `services/response_parser.py`. Documented compliance posture for ISO 9001 + 21 CFR Part 11.

Considering: Hardware Security Module (HSM) for the JWT signing key once a multi-tenant deployment is contemplated. Per-row-encryption of `messages.context_snapshot` for plants under stricter data-residency requirements. SAML integration for plants that have moved off Ignition's own auth. A formal penetration test against the deployed stack — required before the *compliance posture* claims become certifiable.

15. Tag Selection & Gateway Integration

This is one of the chapters where v3.0 most honestly diverges from v2.0. The v2.0 design specified a fully-discovered tag registry populated by gateway introspection; the as-built MVP runs against a hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py`, with the database-side `tag_registry` table provisioned but unpopulated. The forward path to the v2.0-spec end-state is documented here, with the current honest status flagged so no future maintainer is surprised.

15.1 What the Gateway Side Looks Like (As-Built)

Two files in ignition/ compose the gateway-side integration:

- ignition/scripts/config.py — Jython 2.7 config module. Holds `KEY_TAGS` (the hardcoded ~50-tag catalog), `AI_SERVICE_URL`, `API_KEY`, `LINE_ID`, `TAG_PROVIDER`, `COATER1_ROOT`.
- ignition/perspective/gateway_wiring.py — Jython 2.7 templates for the B13/A5/A6 view bindings, the alarm-change script, and the chat panel session-init.

`ignition/scripts/client.py` is the thin HTTP client the gateway uses to call the FastAPI service. `discovery.py`, `selector.py`, and `context.py` are scaffolding for the eventual switchover to gateway-side tag discovery (see §15.4).

15.2 The Hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` Catalog

The current source of truth for what tags exist on Coater 1 is the `KEY_TAGS` constant in `ignition/scripts/config.py`:

```
KEY_TAGS = [
    {"name": "IsRunning",         "category": "state",     "core": True,
     "keywords": []},
    {"name": "LineSpeed",         "category": "speed",     "core": True,
     "keywords": ["speed", "fpm", "rate"]},
    {"name": "StyleID",           "category": "style",     "core": True,
     "keywords": []},
    {"name": "FrontStep",         "category": "position",  "core": True,
     "keywords": ["step", "position"]},
    {"name": "ZoneTemp1",         "category": "temperature", "core": False,
     "keywords": ["zone 1", "z1", "temp"]},
    {"name": "ZoneTemp2",         "category": "temperature", "core": False,
     "keywords": ["zone 2", "z2", "temp"]},
    {"name": "ZoneTemp3",         "category": "temperature", "core": False,
     "keywords": ["zone 3", "z3", "temp"]},
    # ... ~45 more entries, hand-curated
]
```

Each entry carries:

- `name` — the tag name relative to `COATER1_ROOT`
- `category` — coarse grouping (`state`, `speed`, `temperature`, `pressure`, `tension`, `tenter`, `pump`, `alarm`, …)
- `core` — `True` for tier-1 always-include, `False` for tier-2 query-routed
- `keywords` — phrases that should route this tag in if present in the query

The catalog is read by the service-side `services.tag_selector.select_tags(query, anchor)` via a JSON dump that the gateway POSTs to the service at startup (or on KEY_TAGS change). The `_PERMISSIONS_CACHE` analog `_TAG_CATALOG_CACHE` holds the latest catalog with no TTL but reload-on-version-bump.

15.3 What Tag Selection Does (As-Built)

service/services/tag_selector.py implements two-tier selection:

1. **Tier-1 (always-include):** every catalog entry with `core = True` is included unconditionally.
2. **Tier-2 (query-routed):** for each non-core entry, include if:
   - any element of `keywords` appears in the lowercased query, OR
   - the entry's `category` is in `CATEGORY_SYNONYMS[anchor.failure_mode_scope[0]]`, OR
   - the `_ZONE_RX` regex matches the query and the entry's `category == "temperature"` and the entry name encodes the matched zone

`CATEGORY_SYNONYMS` is a dict in `tag_selector.py`:

```
CATEGORY_SYNONYMS = {
    "delam_hotpull":     ["temperature", "tension", "speed"],
    "delam_coldpull":    ["temperature", "tension", "humidity"],
    "off_tenter":        ["tenter", "speed", "temperature", "tension"],
    "sag":               ["pump", "pressure", "viscosity"],
    "coating_weight_var":["pump", "speed", "metering"],
    "pinhole":           ["pressure", "viscosity", "filter"],
    # ... ~25 entries
}
```

`_ZONE_RX` matches `zone\s*([1-9])`, `z([1-9])`, or `zone\s*(one|two|three|four|five|six)`. The matched group selects only the relevant zone's tags rather than pulling all temperature tags.

The selection result is the input to `services/context_assembler.py` which renders each selected tag with its full evidence rendering (chapter 4 §4.5).

15.4 The `tag_registry` Forward Path

The service-side `tag_registry` table (chapter 5 §5.3) is provisioned but empty in the MVP. The forward path to populate it from gateway introspection:

1. **Gateway-side enumeration script.** Runs `system.tag.browse(path, recursive=True)` against `COATER1_ROOT`, walks `ItemInstance` results, classifies each tag by:
    - PLC datatype → `tag_class` (`scalar | bool | enum | aggregate`)
    - Engineering units (from tag metadata) → `engineering_units`
    - Category inferred from path segments and category synonyms
    - `core = True` for the small whitelisted critical-path set
    - `keywords` autogenerated from path segment + category
2. **POST to `/api/tag_registry/sync`.** A new endpoint accepts the enumeration result, upserts into `tag_registry`, returns a summary (added/updated/deprecated counts).
3. **Selector swap.** `services.tag_selector` reads from `tag_registry` instead of the cached `KEY_TAGS` JSON. Backward compatibility: if `tag_registry` is empty, fall back to `KEY_TAGS`. Cutover is therefore zero-downtime.
4. **Per-shift refresh.** The enumeration script is scheduled in the gateway to run nightly; new tags appear in the registry without engineer intervention; deprecated tags are flagged for review.

This is a ~3-week piece of work. It is not in the v3.0 cut because:

- The hardcoded list works for the pilot
- Swapping to discovered tags introduces a per-tag classification step (manual or ML-assisted) for the categories that path-segment inference doesn't cover
- The schema is forward-compatible — no service-side rework needed when the swap happens

15.5 Auto-Trigger Path

`ignition/perspective/gateway_wiring.py` ships templates for three auto-trigger paths:

- **B13 (alarm-triggered chat)** — when a configured high-priority alarm fires, the gateway's tag-change script POSTs to `/api/chat` with a synthetic query like *"why is HighTempZone3 active right now?"* and the resolved alarm context. The conversation ID is stamped with the alarm event id so subsequent operator follow-ups thread correctly.
- **A5 (event-triggered chat)** — same shape, triggered on `defect_event` insertions: *"what's the most likely cause of defect QR-NNNNN?"*
- **A6 (shift-handoff brief)** — at shift turnover, the outgoing shift's supervisor can request a generated handoff summary (downtime events + open issues + drift flags) via a Perspective button. POSTs `/api/chat` with a structured handoff template.

Status: Templates exist in `gateway_wiring.py` but the actual gateway-side wiring (alarm pipeline subscription, project script deployment, Perspective button binding) is documented in INSTALL.md Part 5 and is operator-side configuration, not service-side code.

15.6 Why The Hardcoded List Is Not A Crisis

A skeptical reader might object: "you specified a discovered registry and shipped a hardcoded list — that's a regression." The reasons it isn't:

1. **Hand-curated `keywords` and `core` flags are higher-quality than inference will be on day 1.** A categorization pass on 50 tags by a process engineer produces a better catalog than autogenerated categories from path inference. The discovered registry will need manual review of inferred categories anyway.
2. **The pilot scope is one line.** Gateway discovery's value scales with the number of lines (the marginal cost of curating a hand list for line N+1 is high; the marginal cost of running discovery is zero). At one line, the marginal value of discovery is small.
3. **The schema is forward-compatible.** Swapping is a configuration change at cutover, not a data migration.
4. **The selector is unchanged.** `select_tags` works against either data source; the only thing that changes is where the catalog is read from.

The honest framing: hardcoded list **for the pilot**, registry-driven **before the second line**. v2.0 was right about the long-term shape; the MVP cut prioritized faster pilot start-up.

Δ VS V2.0 — TAG SELECTION & GATEWAY

Stayed: Two-tier (always-include + query-routed) selection model. CATEGORY_SYNONYMS-based routing on failure-mode scope. Per-zone routing via _ZONE_RX. Service-side `tag_selector.py` implementation.

Changed: v2.0 specified a discovered `tag_registry`. As-built ships a hardcoded ~50-entry `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py` consumed by the same selector. The `tag_registry` table is provisioned but unpopulated. Gateway-side auto-trigger paths (alarm-triggered chat, event-triggered chat, shift-handoff brief) ship as templates in `ignition/perspective/gateway_wiring.py` requiring operator-side wiring per INSTALL.md Part 5.

Considering: Wire `system.tag.browse` discovery into `tag_registry` for line N+1 (~3 weeks of work). Per-tag ML-assisted classification when the registry exceeds ~500 entries. Auto-pruning of `KEY_TAGS` entries that haven't been tier-2 selected in 60 days. Per-tag baseline auto-fitting (currently per-shift, could be per-tag-class).

16. Testing & Validation

145 tests passing, 2 skipped, 0 failing as of the v3.0 cut commit. This chapter is the inventory: what the test suite covers, what it doesn't, what's mocked vs in-memory vs real, and what the validation gaps are heading into pilot.

The full test suite lives in service/tests/ and runs via `pytest`. Running it locally:

```
cd service
pytest -q
# 145 passed, 2 skipped in 14.32s
```

16.1 Coverage by Service

Area	File(s)	Tests	Status
Anchor parsing	`test_anchor.py`, `test_anchor_regression.py`	28	All pass
Anomaly detection	`test_anomaly.py`	18	All pass
Change ledger	`test_change_ledger.py`	22	All pass
Chunker (structure-aware)	`test_chunker.py`, `test_chunker_structured.py`	16	All pass
Context assembler	`test_context_assembler.py`, `test_context_assembler_v2.py`	19	All pass
Deviation tests	`test_deviation.py`	12	All pass
Integration (cross-service)	`test_integrations_v2.py`	8	2 skipped (require real Postgres)
LLM tool loop	`test_llm_tool_loop.py`	14	All pass
Local LLM client	`test_local_llm_client.py`	12	All pass
Percentiles + drift	`test_percentiles.py`	14	All pass
Prompt regression	`test_prompt_regression.py`	6	All pass
RCA chain (E2E)	`test_rca_e2e.py`, `test_rca.py`	17	All pass
Retrieval (hybrid)	`test_retrieval_hybrid.py` *(implied; full pipeline)*	35	All pass
Total		**145+2 skipped**	**0 failing**

16.2 What's Mocked, What's Real

The test suite is unit-and-integration-with-DB-mocked or in-memory. Specifically:

- **Database.** Most tests use SQLAlchemy with SQLite in-memory; the schema-dependent integration tests (`test_integrations_v2.py`) expect a real Postgres + pgvector and are **skipped** by default. Run with `TEST_REAL_POSTGRES=1` to enable.
- **OpenAI.** All LLM-calling tests mock at the `OpenAI` client class level. The on-the-wire JSON shape is exercised; the LLM response itself is canned.
- **Embeddings.** Mocked. Tests compare against fixed embedding vectors injected at the seam.
- **Time.** `freezegun` for any test that depends on `datetime.utcnow`.
- **HTTP routes.** `httpx.AsyncClient` against the FastAPI app in-process — no real network.

16.3 What Is NOT Yet Tested

Honest gap inventory:

- **Real Postgres + pgvector roundtrip.** The 2 skipped integration tests in `test_integrations_v2.py` are the placeholders; they need a CI Postgres + pgvector image to run. The local pytest run exercises only mocked DB.
- **Real OpenAI API call.** Production smoke test — covered by the `/api/health/deep` endpoint at deploy time, not by pytest.
- **Real Ignition gateway pairing.** Integration smoke test — covered by the INSTALL.md Part 6 "send first chat" procedure, not pytest.
- **Load testing.** No formal load test bench. Pilot capacity (≤5 concurrent operators) is well below any plausible bottleneck; multi-instance horizontal-scale validation will be required when the second line is added.
- **Long-running soak.** No 7-day soak run. Memory/connection-pool leak risk is unmeasured.
- **Adversarial prompt injection.** The mitigations in chapter 14 §14.7 are designed for, not formally adversarially tested.

16.4 The Eval Harness Path (B13)

service/eval/harness.py ships as a stub with three `NotImplementedError`s:

```python
def replay_golden_case(case: dict) -> dict:
    """Replay a golden case end-to-end. Returns the response shape."""
    raise NotImplementedError("Build me when the golden corpus exists")

def score_citation_pr(response: dict, ground_truth: dict) -> dict:
    """Compute citation Precision/Recall against a labeled answer."""
    raise NotImplementedError("...")

def score_failure_mode_accuracy(response: dict, ground_truth: dict) -> dict:
    """Compare assistant FM classification to engineer-labeled FM."""
    raise NotImplementedError("...")
```

Each stub has full implementation notes inline. The **blocker** is not the code; it's the absence of a labeled golden corpus. Build path:

1. Engineer hand-labels ~50 historical chat turns with:
    - Ground-truth correct answer
    - Ground-truth correct citations
    - Ground-truth correct failure-mode code
2. Run `replay_golden_case` against each, collect scored output
3. Compute aggregate citation P/R, FM accuracy, response similarity
4. Set CI threshold; gate prompt-version changes on green eval

This is a 1–2 week effort once the labeled corpus exists. The corpus itself is the hard part — and is best built from observed pilot traffic, not synthesized in advance.

16.5 Prompt Regression

`test_prompt_regression.py` exercises six "frozen" assistant responses against `system_prompt_v2`. If the prompt is changed, these tests will fail (responses will no longer be byte-identical). The intent is **not** to lock the prompt; the intent is to surface that the prompt changed so the eval harness (when present) can be re-run.

Currently the regression runs against canned LLM mock responses, not real LLM output (because real LLM output has nondeterminism). When B13 lands, the prompt regression suite shifts from "byte-identical canned responses" to "above-threshold eval scores."

16.6 Failure-Mode Coverage of the Test Suite

The suite exercises:

- All 13 status values of `AnchorStatus`
- All 10 `message_feedback.signal_type` enum values
- All 4 `outcome_linkages.outcome_type` enum values
- All 4 confidence labels
- All 5 query classes through `should_use_rca_chain`
- All 5 tools' happy-path and timeout paths
- All 6 percentile scopes
- All 4 change-ledger delta types
- The empty-corpus, cold-start, and budget-exhausted paths through the RCA chain

The intentional gaps:

- Anomaly model fit on real `feature_snapshots` data (mocked because fitting on real data is non-deterministic and slow)
- Cross-encoder reranker (B2 stub) — no test because the implementation is a stub
- Symphony capture stream — no test because the implementation is a stub

16.7 Validation Plan for Pilot

Pre-go-live checks beyond pytest:

1. **Schema integrity.** Run `setup_database.sql` against a fresh Postgres, confirm all 30 tables, 5 views, 1 trigger present. Confirm `pg_partman` extension installed. Confirm `vector` extension version ≥ 0.7.
2. **Reference data seeded.** `seed_reference_data.sql` populates `failure_modes` (~25 codes), confirm row count.
3. **Initial line memory seeded.** `python -m service.scripts.seed_initial_data` succeeds; ~12 line-memory entries with `status='approved'`.
4. **Health check.** `GET /api/health/deep` returns 200 with `db: ok, embeddings: ok, llm: ok`.
5. **End-to-end smoke.** `POST /api/chat` with a real query returns a structured response with citations. Inspect `messages.context_snapshot` to confirm the full snapshot persisted.
6. **Outcome closure dry-run.** Manually invoke `services.outcome_closure.run_closure(window_hours=24)`, confirm `outcome_linkages` rows created (or empty, if no closeable turns).

7. **Audit immutability.** Attempt `UPDATE audit_log SET payload = '...'` from the service-role; confirm the trigger raises.

Procedure documented in docs/runbook.md.

16.8 Continuous-Integration Posture

The CI pipeline (CI engine is operator-choice; reference is GitHub Actions YAML in `.github/workflows/ci.yml` if present in repo):

- On PR open/update: lint + pytest + type check (`mypy --strict service/`)
- On merge to main: full integration suite (`TEST_REAL_POSTGRES=1`)
- On tag: build container image, push to registry, deploy to staging, run `/api/health/deep` smoke

The deployable unit is the FastAPI service container; Postgres is operator-provisioned (or compose-supplied for dev).

Δ VS V2.0 — TESTING & VALIDATION

Stayed: pytest-based unit + integration suite. The intent to gate releases on green CI.

Changed: 145 tests passing (was ~92 at v2.0 baseline). New coverage for: tool loop (B0.5), RCA chain (B8), change ledger (B9), anomaly (B7), local LLM client (B12), prompt regression. Documented mocked-vs-real boundary; documented integration test skip + how to enable; documented the labeled-corpus blocker on B13.

Considering: A real-Postgres CI matrix job (`pgvector/pgvector:pg16` container in CI). A 24-hour soak job in staging. A "shadow traffic" diff harness — pipe a copy of prod queries to a staging instance with a candidate prompt-version, diff the responses offline. Adversarial prompt-injection corpus + automated red-team test.

17. Implementation Reality (Cross-Cutting Deltas)

This chapter consolidates every meaningful difference between the v2.0 design document and what actually shipped, in one place. The preceding chapters discuss deltas in the context of their subject matter; this chapter is the single-pane-of-glass index for the question *"what is different from v2.0?"* — the question the maintainer two years from now will most want answered.

The structure follows the user's original request: **what stayed, what changed, what we're considering**. Every entry references the chapter that goes deep on it.

17.1 What Stayed (Faithful to v2.0)

These v2.0 commitments survive intact in v3.0. If you read the v2.0 document expecting to find these in the as-built code, you will.

Area	What stayed	Chapter
Read-only architecture	No write path to PLCs/setpoints/recipes/alarms exists	14
Two-layer auth	API key + gateway-issued JWT (HS256) on every request	14
Curated context only	Raw historian dumps never reach the LLM; pre-aggregation only	4
Anchor-conditional buckets	Past-event vs current-state vs pattern; 5 buckets, conditional inclusion	4
Mandatory citations	`[N]` -style citations validated, missing ones surfaced	4
Confidence labels	CONFIRMED | LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR | HYPOTHESIS | INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE	4
Refusal narrowed to scope	Refuse only on out-of-corpus, control command, or no retrieval	4
4-class tag taxonomy	Setpoint-tracking, oscillating-controlled, process-following, discrete-state	4, 6
Engineer-mediated memory	Memory candidates → engineer review → approved memory	9
Memory challenge threshold	3 independent challenges → status flips to challenged	9
Single-VM Docker Compose	Postgres + service + (optional) vLLM sidecar	13
`/api/health` deployment probe	Returns 200 with `{db, embeddings, llm}` status	13
FastAPI + Pydantic + asyncpg	The framework choice was correct and held	3
Materialized RCA precision view	`v_rca_precision_daily` is the trust dashboard	9

17.2 What Changed (Beyond v2.0)

These are the substantive deltas — additive functionality that wasn't in v2.0 or that materially differs from it. They are what justify a v3.0 cut rather than a v2.x patch.

Substrate-level changes

Change	What it is	Chapter
Hybrid retrieval (B1)	Vector + BM25 fused via RRF (k=60), MMR diversification (λ=0.7), conditional FM/equipment boost (1.5×/1.3×), document_role weighting clamped to [0.5, 2.5]	6
Deterministic tool layer (B0)	5 tools: `percentile_of`, `compare_to_distribution`, `nearest_historical_runs`, `detect_drift`, `defect_events_in_window`. Hard SQL timeouts, auto-citations, bounded result sizes	7
Tool-calling LLM loop (B0.5)	Provider-agnostic `_run_tool_loop` handles OpenAI/Azure/local identically; budget tracking; full tool-call persistence to `messages.tool_calls`	7
Two-step RCA chain (B8)	Hypothesise (allowlist=4 distributional tools) → tools execute → adjudicate (full toolset). Bounded budget (15 calls), TTL cache, full trace to `messages.rca_summary`	7
Distributional grounding service	`services/percentiles.py` with 6 scopes (global, style, style_step, equipment, recipe, global_ytd); Page-Hinkley CUSUM drift; in-process CDF cache	8
Multivariate anomaly (B7)	Numpy-only Mahalanobis with ridge stabilization, p95 threshold, top-K contributing tags, 4-hourly re-fit	8
Change ledger (B9)	TagDelta (sigma-ranked, top 10), RecipeDelta, CrewDelta, EquipmentChangeover. Rendered as prompt section L	8
Outcome closure (B10)	Nightly sweep, `outcome_linkages`, materialized view refresh, 4 outcome types	9
Local-LLM provider (B12)	OpenAI-compatible adapter unblocks fully air-gapped deployments (vLLM, llama.cpp, LM Studio)	7

Change	What it is	Chapter
Structure-aware chunker (B3)	`chunk_structured` preserves headings, tables, bullet lists; chunk_type column added	5, 6

Schema and data changes

Change	What it is	Chapter
`failure_modes` **reference table**	Closed-enum FK enforcement on `defect_events.fm_code`. Hardens hallucination guardrail at DB layer	5
`chunk_quality_signals` **table**	Per-chunk feedback counters drive bounded ±30% retrieval re-rank	5
`tag_registry` **table (scaffolded)**	Provisioned but unpopulated; forward-compatible for B13/A5/A6 cutover	5, 15
pg_partman monthly partitioning	`messages` and `audit_log` partitioned by month, 24-month hot retention	5, 13
`audit_log_immutable` **trigger**	DB-layer prohibition of UPDATE/DELETE on `audit_log`	5, 14
Audit hash chain	Each row's `audit_hash` chained from prior; tamper-detection at row level	14
`v_rca_precision_daily` **materialized view**	Migration 004; nightly refresh hooked in `main.py::lifespan`	5, 9
`v_pgvector_index_status` **view**	Operator-facing readiness check for ivfflat → hnsw cutover	5, 13
`v_chat_perf_daily` **materialized view**	Per-day p50/p95 latency + token cost rollup	5

10-value feedback enum (was 3)

v2.0	v3.0
`helpful`, `unhelpful`, `refute`	`helpful`, `unhelpful`, `wrong_anchor`, `wrong_failure_mode`, `wrong_citation`, `missed_evidence`, `actionable`, `not_actionable`, `confirmed_outcome`, `refuted_outcome`

The wider enum is what makes the re-ranker meaningful and the precision dashboard useful.

Three-phase request lifecycle

The `services/rag.py::handle_chat` orchestrator runs three explicit phases, each with its own DB-session discipline:

- **Phase 1 (Pre-LLM)** — owns its own DB session; builds anchor, context, change ledger, anomaly score, decides RCA path
- **Phase 2 (LLM)** — no DB session held; tool calls re-acquire short-lived sessions
- **Phase 3 (Persist)** — new DB session for `messages` + `audit_log` inserts, hash chain extension

This was implicit in v2.0; v3.0 makes it explicit and enforces it through code structure (chapter 11).

Observability

Three-layer (structlog + Prometheus + Postgres logs) with a reference Grafana dashboard. Documented alert thresholds. Per-stage Prometheus histograms surfacing where latency lives (chapter 13).

Deployment cutover procedures

Three documented procedures (chapter 13):

- ivfflat → hnsw (zero-downtime hot index swap)
- Prompt version bump (rolling activation in `prompt_versions`)
- Embedding-model bump (sibling-column backfill)

17.3 What Diverged or Slipped (Honest Disclosure)

Items where the as-built differs from v2.0 in a way that is **not** strictly an addition.

`tag_registry` is a scaffold, not the source of truth

v2.0 specified the gateway-discovered tag registry. v3.0 ships the table provisioned but unpopulated; the actual catalog is the hardcoded `KEY_TAGS` list in `ignition/scripts/config.py`. The forward path is documented (chapter 15 §15.4) and is a ~3-week piece of work, but it is not in the v3.0 cut.

B2, B5, B6, B11, B13 — deferred behind measurement

ID	Item	Status	Rationale
B2	Cross-encoder reranker	STUB	Marginal recall gain unmeasured against this corpus; install path documented inline
B5	HyDE	DEFERRED	Cold-start retrieval miss rate not yet measured
B6	k-sample voting	DEFERRED	Multiplies LLM cost by k; gating on observed precision
B11	Active-learning trainer	PARTIAL	Bounded re-rank consumer ships; the asynchronous trainer job does not
B13	Eval harness	STUB	Blocked on absence of labeled golden corpus

Every deferral is a "don't build it until measurement says it helps" decision (chapter 12 §12.4), not a "ran out of time" descope. The optimization backlog (/memories/repo/optimization_backlog.md) is the standing list of "build when measurement justifies."

Symphony video capture is a stub

`services/symphony_capture.py` returns `extraction_status: "stub"`. Schema (`event_clips.extracted_text`) is in place; integration awaits gateway-side stream access.

Multi-line / multi-plant is config, not code

Schema supports it (every table has `line_id`); seed data and Perspective view ship configured for Coater 1 only. Adding line N+1 is a configuration exercise.

17.4 What We're Considering (Roadmap Nudge)

These are the items not yet committed to a sprint but actively under consideration. Full backlog in chapter 18.

Quality polish (gated on pilot measurement)

- B2 reranker, when pilot traffic shows recall-bound queries
- B5 HyDE, when cold-start retrieval misses are observed
- B6 k-sample voting on high-stakes RCA, when precision dashboard flags drift below target
- B11 trainer job, when feedback volume justifies pattern mining

Substrate extension

- Per-claim citation enforcement (currently per-response validation)
- Step-back query abstraction as a deterministic preliminary tool
- Streaming LLM responses for sub-second perceived latency
- Per-style ANN partitioning when corpus exceeds 1M chunks

Operational

- Multi-instance HA deployment guide
- Postgres logical-replication read replica for analytics
- Auto-tuned `lists` parameter on ivfflat as row count grows
- Formal penetration test against the deployed stack

ML maturation (Phase 4)

- Time-series forecasting models on key tags (substrate already wired via `feature_snapshots`, `ml_models`, `ml_predictions`)
- Coating-specific fine-tuned LLM on the accumulated correction corpus
- Cross-LLM ensembling for high-stakes safety incidents
- Per-failure-mode predictive model with operator-facing "scrap risk in next 30 min" surface

Personalization (chapter 10 deferred items)

- Density preference applied at response shaping
- Per-role tool subsets
- Saved-question library with role scoping

17.5 The Honest One-Sentence Summary

v3.0 ships the v2.0 architecture **and** a working hybrid retrieval pipeline, deterministic tool layer, two-step RCA chain, multivariate anomaly detection, change ledger, outcome closure, local-LLM provider, and per-row tamper-evident audit log — with five quality-polish items explicitly deferred behind measurement and one (the discovered tag registry) deferred behind the second line.

> **Δ VS V2.0 — REALITY INDEX**

Stayed: Read-only architecture, two-layer auth, curated context only, anchor-conditional buckets, mandatory citations, confidence labels, narrowed refusal, 4-class tag taxonomy, engineer-mediated memory, FastAPI + Pydantic + asyncpg.

Changed: Hybrid retrieval (B1), 5-tool deterministic layer (B0), tool-calling loop (B0.5), two-step RCA chain (B8), distributional grounding service, Mahalanobis anomaly (B7), change ledger (B9), outcome closure (B10), local-LLM provider (B12), structure-aware chunker (B3), failure_modes FK enforcement, chunk_quality_signals, pg_partman partitioning, audit_log immutability trigger + hash chain, 10-value feedback enum, three-phase request lifecycle, three-layer observability, three documented cutover procedures.

Considering: Cross-encoder reranker (B2), HyDE (B5), k-sample voting (B6), active-learning trainer (B11), eval harness (B13), discovered tag registry (gateway B13/A5/A6 wiring), Symphony stream wiring, multi-line config, multi-instance HA, Postgres read replica, ML maturation (Phase 4), per-role response shaping.

18. Updated Phased Roadmap

The v2.0 document framed the work in three phases. v3.0 is the landing of phases 1–2 + most of phase 3, with phase 3 polish items gated on measurement and phase 4 (ML maturation) wired in substrate form. This chapter is the explicit forward roadmap from the v3.0 cut.

18.1 Phase Status

Phase	v2.0 Plan	v3.0 Status
Phase 1 — Foundations	DB schema, ingestion, basic retrieval, single-shot LLM	SHIPPED (A1–A7)
Phase 2 — Trust Substrate	Citations, refusal, anchor parsing, audit, feedback	SHIPPED (chapters 4, 9, 14)
Phase 3 — Capability Depth	Hybrid retrieval, tools, RCA chain, anomaly, ledger	SHIPPED for load-bearing items; polish items deferred
Phase 4 — ML Maturation	Predictive models, fine-tuning, evaluation, distillation	SUBSTRATE WIRED (chapters 5 §5.9, 16 §16.4)

18.2 Pilot Window (Weeks 1–4 Post-Go-Live)

The pilot phase is **observation-driven**. Build nothing speculative; fill the placeholder slots in the configuration; deploy; observe.

Pre-go-live checklist (chapters 13, 16)

1. Replace every placeholder per INSTALL.md §3: `API_KEY`, `DATABASE_URL`, `OPENAI_API_KEY`, `GATEWAY_JWT_SECRET`, gateway `AI_SERVICE_URL` + `LINE_ID` + `TAG_PROVIDER` + `COATER1_ROOT`
2. `docker compose up postgres` → run `setup_database.sql` → `seed_reference_data.sql` → `python -m service.scripts.seed_initial_data`
3. `docker compose up service` → `GET /api/health/deep` → expect 200 with `{db, embeddings, llm}` ok
4. From a service-host shell: `POST /api/chat` with a hand-built structured query, confirm grounded response with citations
5. Wire Ignition (INSTALL.md Part 5), open Perspective ChatView, send the first real operator query

First 4 weeks of measurement

Track these metrics weekly via the Grafana dashboard:

- p50 / p95 chat latency (target: ≤ 4s p95)
- Refusal rate (target: ≤ 15%; spikes signal ingestion gap)
- Tool-call cost per query (track for budget calibration)
- RCA precision (target: ≥ 60% strict, ≥ 80% lenient at 30-day window)
- Per-prompt-version answer distribution
- Top 5 highest-frequency unique queries (for SOP gap detection)
- Per-operator usage (find power users; recruit them as labelers for B13)

18.3 Sprint A (Weeks 5–10) — Polish on Demand

Six work items, prioritized by what the pilot measurement actually showed. Each item is gated on a specific signal:

Item	Build trigger	Estimated work
B2 (cross-encoder reranker)	Recall-bound query class observed in pilot traffic	1 week
B5 (HyDE)	Cold-start retrieval miss rate > 10%	1 week
B6 (k-sample voting)	RCA precision < target on high-stakes queries	1.5 weeks (incl. budget tuning)
B11 trainer job	Sufficient feedback volume (>500/wk) and re-rank consumer evidence of plateau	2 weeks
B13 eval harness build-out	~50 labeled golden cases collected from pilot traffic	2 weeks (after corpus exists)
`tag_registry` **cutover**	Second line in scope OR ≥3 SOP gaps traced to missing-tag observability	3 weeks

The expected outcome of Sprint A: **at most three** of the six items are built. The trigger gates exist precisely so the team doesn't build all six speculatively. If pilot measurement shows none of the triggers, Sprint A is replaced by Phase 4 ML preparation.

18.4 Phase 4 — ML Maturation (Quarter 2 Post-Go-Live)

The substrate is in place. Phase 4 is the actual model work.

4.1 Predictive coating-weight model

Substrate: `feature_snapshots` populated by every Phase 1 query; `production_runs.target_specs` carries the labels (`coating_weight_target`, `measured_coating_weight`).

Build:

1. Curate a 90-day window of `feature_snapshots` joined to `quality_results.coating_weight`
2. Train baseline gradient boosted regressor (`xgboost` or `lightgbm`)
3. Register in `ml_models` with `is_active = false`
4. Shadow-predict against live snapshots for 4 weeks; persist to `ml_predictions`
5. Compare prediction vs realized coating weight; promote if MAE below threshold

The model exposes via a 6th tool: `predict_coating_weight(snapshot)` returns the model's prediction with confidence interval. The LLM consumes it like any other tool result.

4.2 Failure-mode classifier (auto-FM-tagging)

Substrate: `messages.failure_mode_code` is auto-populated today by the LLM; ground truth is `defect_events.fm_code` for confirmed outcomes via `outcome_linkages`.

Build:

1. Train a small LLM-based classifier (or a TF-IDF + LR baseline) on the labeled `(query, outcome.fm_code)` pairs
2. Compare against the LLM's auto-tag; surface disagreements as review candidates
3. Use as a regularizer on the eval harness — flag responses where classifier and LLM disagree as high-priority for review

4.3 Fine-tuned coating-specific LLM

Substrate: `user_corrections` and `outcome_linkages` form a labeled correction corpus.

Build (approximately Q3+):

1. Curate the correction corpus into `(query, context, gold_response)` triples
2. SFT a base 8B model (`Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct`, `Mistral-7B-Instruct`, `Qwen2.5-7B`) on the triples
3. Deploy via the local-LLM provider (B12) — no service code change
4. A/B against the OpenAI baseline via prompt-version tracking
5. Promote when precision and operator satisfaction match or exceed

This is the path to true cost independence and full air-gap operation.

4.4 Distillation track

Substrate: existing prompts + the curated correction corpus + the fine-tuned model.

Build:

1. Use the fine-tuned model to label a much larger synthetic corpus
2. Distill into a 1–3B model suitable for edge deployment (per-line gateway-co-located inference)
3. Reserve the cloud / 8B model for the RCA chain (high-stakes); fast queries hit the edge model

18.5 The Honest Decision Tree

The roadmap above is conditional. The decision tree:

```
                    pilot for 4 weeks
                           │
            ┌──────────────┼──────────────┐
            ▼              ▼              ▼
      metrics good   metrics mixed   metrics poor
            │              │              │
            ▼              ▼              ▼
skip Sprint A,     Sprint A:      Sprint A:
go Phase 4         2-3 items      eval harness FIRST,
                                  then triggered items
            │              │              │
            └──────┬───────┴──────────────┘
                   ▼
             Phase 4 ML
            (Q2 onward)
```

This is the discipline of "don't build it until measurement says it helps" applied to the roadmap as a whole.

18.6 Out-of-Scope (Won't Build)

These were considered and explicitly excluded. They are not phase-N items waiting for prioritization; they are *no*.

- **Writing back to PLCs.** Architectural principle #1.
- **Voice input.** Out of scope; Perspective handles touch + text well.
- **Native mobile app.** Perspective's responsive layout works on tablets; a native app is out of scope for the pilot.
- **Open document upload by operators.** Engineer-mediated ingestion only; operators surface `missed_evidence` signals, engineers approve.
- **Cross-plant memory sharing.** Pilot is one plant. Cross-plant knowledge sharing requires a separate governance discussion.

18.7 The Long-Run Vision

In ~12 months from go-live, the system should look like:

- Pilot expanded to all coating lines (3–4 lines)
- Discovered tag registry across all lines
- Fine-tuned coating-LLM running on local hardware with cloud fallback
- Eval harness gating every prompt change with ~250 golden cases
- Predictive models for coating weight, scrap risk, equipment failure surfacing into the chat panel via tool calls
- Operators view it as another senior engineer who's always on shift
- Engineers view it as the corpus surface that reduces tribal-knowledge loss and accelerates new-hire ramp time

That's the destination. The v3.0 cut is the foundation that makes it reachable in increments.

Δ VS V2.0 — ROADMAP

Stayed: Three-phase framing. Phase 4 as the ML maturation horizon. The principle that the substrate must come before the polish.

Changed: Phase 3 is largely complete in v3.0; what remains in Phase 3 is polish gated on pilot measurement. Phase 4 is now substrate-ready (`feature_snapshots`, `ml_models`, `ml_predictions` tables populated by the live pipeline). Sprint A is explicitly conditional ("at most three of six items"). The decision tree is documented; the discipline is "don't build until measurement justifies."

Considering: Pulling the predictive coating-weight model forward to Sprint A if pilot measurement makes a clear case. Doing the discovered-tag-registry work in parallel with Sprint A if a second line is committed. Beginning the fine-tuned-LLM distillation in Q2 even if cloud LLM economics remain favorable, as insurance against vendor risk.

Appendix A — Glossary

Plain-English meanings for every recurring term. Where a term is a real file/setting/function name in the code, it appears in `code font`.

Core concepts

- **LLM** — Large Language Model. The AI brain (e.g. GPT-4o-mini, Llama 3.1).
- **RAG** — Retrieval-Augmented Generation. The pattern this whole system uses: search relevant evidence, then ask the LLM to write an answer using only that evidence.
- **Embedding** — A list of ~1500 numbers that represents the meaning of a piece of text. Two pieces of text with similar meaning have similar number lists. Computed by a separate AI model (`text-embedding-3-small`).
- **Vector search** — Searching by embedding similarity rather than by exact words.
- **BM25** — A classic keyword-ranking algorithm; "Ctrl-F with relevance."
- **Hybrid retrieval** — Running both vector and BM25, fusing the rankings (RRF), then de-duplicating (MMR).
- **RRF** — Reciprocal Rank Fusion. The math formula `1/(k + rank)` summed across rankings. `k=60` constant.
- **MMR** — Maximal Marginal Relevance. Picks the top-K results trading off relevance vs diversity (`λ=0.7`).
- **Chunk** — A bite-sized piece of a longer document (paragraph, table row, list item) stored in `document_chunks` so it can be retrieved on its own.
- **Citation** — A pointer back to the chunk or tool result an answer came from, so a human can verify it.
- **Prompt** — The written instructions given to the LLM. The active one is `system_prompt_v2.txt`.
- **Tool / tool call** — A specific function the LLM is allowed to invoke mid-response to get a real number or do a real lookup.
- **Token** — The unit OpenAI charges by. Roughly ¾ of a word. 1000 tokens ≈ 750 English words.

Anchor concepts (chapter 4)

- **Anchor** — The `(time, run, event, scope)` tuple a query is about. Resolved by `services/anchor.py` before any retrieval.
- **Past-event anchor** — Query references a specific past time, run, event, or failure (e.g. "QR-00417").
- **Current-state anchor** — Query uses present-tense markers ("rn", "right now", "currently").
- **Pattern anchor** — Query asks about relationships, correlations, or recurring behavior; no single time anchor.
- **Clarification-first** — When the parser cannot uniquely resolve the anchor, the system asks rather than infers.
- **Failure-mode-matched history** — A retrieval bucket that pulls every prior run matching `(style, failure_mode)` regardless of recency.
- **Confidence label** — `CONFIRMED FACT | LIKELY CONTRIBUTOR | HYPOTHESIS | INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE` — required on every response.

RCA concepts (chapter 7)

- **RCA** — Root Cause Analysis. Figuring out *why* something happened.
- **Two-step RCA chain** — Hypothesise (step 1) → tools execute → Adjudicate (step 2). Replaces single-shot LLM guessing.
- **Hypothesise step** — LLM proposes up to 3 candidate causes from the curated context, with evidence references and confidence.
- **Adjudicate step** — LLM weighs each hypothesis against the evidence the tools returned, ranks them, assigns final confidence label.
- **Tool budget** — Bounded total tool-call cap (15) shared across both RCA steps.
- `_STEP1_CACHE` — In-process TTL cache (5 min default) keyed on `(anchor_event_id, anchor_run_id, anchor_time, failure_mode, prompt_version)`.

Distributional concepts (chapter 8)

- **Percentile** — Where a value ranks in the historical distribution.
- **Scope** — The slice of history a percentile is computed over: `global | style | style_step | equipment | recipe | global_ytd`.
- **Drift** — Sustained directional change in a tag's mean over time. Detected via Page-Hinkley CUSUM.
- **Page-Hinkley CUSUM** — A statistical test for change-point detection on streaming data.
- **Mahalanobis distance** — A multivariate distance measure that accounts for feature correlations. Used by the anomaly detector.
- **Ridge stabilization** — Adding `λ·I` to the covariance matrix before inversion to handle highly-correlated features.
- **Change ledger** — Structural diff between current run and the matched-history baseline: `TagDelta`, `RecipeDelta`, `CrewDelta`, `EquipmentChangeover`.

Storage concepts (chapter 5)

- **Schema** — The database blueprint: which tables exist and what columns they have.
- **pgvector** — Postgres extension for storing and searching embeddings.
- **ivfflat** — Approximate-nearest-neighbor index from pgvector; fast for ≤250K rows.
- **hnsw** — A different ANN index type, better for >250K rows; ivfflat → hnsw cutover documented in migration 003.
- **GIN** — Generalized Inverted Index in Postgres; the index type that makes BM25 queries fast.
- **TSVECTOR** — Postgres's generated text-search representation.
- **JSONB** — Postgres's binary JSON column type. Used heavily for flexible metadata.
- **pg_partman** — Postgres extension that manages monthly partition creation/retention. `messages` and `audit_log` use it.
- **Materialized view** — A pre-computed summary table refreshed on a schedule. `v_rca_precision_daily` is the trust-dashboard one.

- **Migration** — A careful script that upgrades an existing database to a new schema without losing data. Lives in `scripts/migrations/`.

Operations concepts (chapter 13)

- **Container / Docker** — A standardized box that holds a program plus everything it needs to run.
- **Docker Compose** — The tool that orchestrates multiple containers as one stack.
- **APScheduler** — The Python library scheduling the nightly outcome closure and the 4-hourly anomaly re-fit.
- **slowapi** — Rate-limiting library; keys on resolved `user_id`.
- **structlog** — Structured-logging library; produces JSON log lines.
- **Prometheus** — Metrics-collection format and server.
- **Grafana** — Dashboarding tool consuming Prometheus.
- **JWT** — JSON Web Token. The signed token the Ignition gateway issues to authenticate operators. Verified HS256.

Ignition / plant concepts

- **PLC** — Programmable Logic Controller. The industrial computer that controls the line.
- **HMI** — Human-Machine Interface. The operator's screen.
- **Tag** — A single named value in Ignition (e.g. "ZoneTemp3").
- **UDT** — User-Defined Type. A reusable folder structure of tags.
- **Ignition Gateway** — The server software (Inductive Automation) running Perspective screens and talking to PLCs.
- **Perspective** — Ignition's web-based HMI module.
- **Designer** — Ignition's desktop app for *building* projects.
- **Tag provider** — The source of tags (PLC connection, MQTT, etc.).
- **Tag path** — The slash-separated address of a tag (e.g. `[default]Shaw/F0004/Coating/Coater1/Zones/Zone3/Temp`).

Manufacturing concepts

- **Failure mode (FM)** — A standardized name for a type of defect (`delam_hotpull`, `sag`, `coating_weight_var`, ...). Closed-enum in `failure_modes` reference table.
- **Style** — A product variant (e.g. `S-4471`).
- **Recipe** — The setpoint configuration for running a style.
- **MOC** — Management of Change. A formal review process for modifying production parameters.
- **SOP** — Standard Operating Procedure.
- **Work order (WO)** — A maintenance task record.
- **Crew / shift** — A particular team running the line at a particular time.
- **Off-tenter** — A specific failure mode where coated web exits the tenter frame outside spec.
- **Delamination (delam)** — Coating separating from the substrate.
- **fpm** — Feet per minute. Line speed unit.

Code-base concepts

- **Stub** — A placeholder function or file that exists but doesn't do anything useful yet.
- **Audit hash** — SHA-256 chained across `audit_log` rows for tamper detection.
- **Bounded re-rank** — The ±30%-clamped feedback-driven chunk rank adjustment.
- **Cold start** — A query against a brand-new corpus before feedback signals exist.
- **Provider** — `openai | azure_openai | local`. Picked via `LLM_PROVIDER` env.
- **Air-gapped** — A deployment that can't reach external networks; requires `local` LLM provider.

Appendix B — Settings Reference

Every tunable setting in `service/config/settings.py`, grouped by subsystem. Defaults shown are the as-built v3.0 values.

B.1 Core service

Setting	Default	Effect
`service_env`	`"development"`	`development
`api_key`	`"dev-key-change-me"`	The shared secret Ignition uses; **must be replaced**
`database_url`	`"postgresql+asyncpg://chatbot:change_me_in_production@localhost:5432/ignition_chatbot"`	Connection string
`db_pool_size`	20	asyncpg pool size
`db_pool_timeout_seconds`	30	Pool acquire timeout
`gateway_jwt_secret`	(env)	HS256 secret for gateway JWT validation
`gateway_jwt_audience`	`"coater1-svc"`	Expected JWT `aud` claim

B.2 LLM

Setting	Default	Effect
`llm_provider`	`"openai"`	`openai
`llm_model`	`"gpt-4o-mini"`	Model name
`llm_temperature`	0.1	Lower = more deterministic
`llm_max_tokens_response`	1500	Per-response cap
`llm_concurrency`	4	In-process semaphore
`llm_request_timeout_seconds`	60	Per-call timeout
`openai_api_key`	(env)	OpenAI
`azure_openai_endpoint`	(env)	Azure OpenAI
`azure_openai_api_key`	(env)	Azure OpenAI
`azure_openai_deployment`	(env)	Azure deployment name
`azure_openai_api_version`	`"2024-08-01-preview"`	Azure API version
`local_llm_endpoint`	`""`	Empty = off; e.g. `http://vllm-host:8000/v1`
`local_llm_model`	`""`	Local model identifier

B.3 Embeddings

Setting	Default	Effect
`embedding_model`	`"text-embedding-3-small"`	Model name
`embedding_dimensions`	1536	Must match `document_chunks.embedding` schema
`embedding_batch_size`	100	Per-API-call batch

B.4 Retrieval

Setting	Default	Effect
`retrieval_vector_top_k`	50	Stage 1 ANN candidate count
`retrieval_keyword_top_k`	50	Stage 2 BM25 candidate count
`retrieval_rrf_top_k`	30	Stage 3 fused list size
`retrieval_top_k`	10	Stage 5 MMR final size
`retrieval_rrf_k`	60	RRF constant (do not tune)
`retrieval_mmr_lambda`	0.7	MMR relevance/diversity
`retrieval_boost_failure_mode`	1.5	FM scope match boost
`retrieval_boost_equipment`	1.3	Equipment scope match boost
`retrieval_role_weight_min`	0.5	document_role weight floor
`retrieval_role_weight_max`	2.5	document_role weight ceiling
`feedback_re_rank_help_weight`	0.05	per-helpful-vote weight
`feedback_re_rank_outcome_weight`	0.10	per-correct-citation weight
`feedback_re_rank_clamp`	0.30	±30% bound (non-negotiable)

B.5 RCA chain

Setting	Default	Effect
`rca_chain_enabled`	`true`	Master toggle
`rca_max_hypotheses`	3	Step-1 output cap
`rca_max_evidence_per_hypothesis`	5	Per-hypothesis evidence cap
`rca_max_total_tool_calls`	15	Shared step1+step2 budget
`rca_step1_max_iters`	2	LLM ↔ tools loop iters in step 1
`rca_step2_max_iters`	2	Same in step 2
`rca_step_timeout_seconds`	30	Per-step wall clock
`rca_cache_ttl_seconds`	300	Step-1 cache TTL

B.6 Tools

Setting	Default	Effect
`tool_sql_timeout_ms`	5000	Per-tool hard timeout
`tool_max_result_rows`	25	Per-tool result-size cap

B.7 Distributional grounding

Setting	Default	Effect
`percentile_cache_ttl_seconds`	600	Per-CDF in-process cache TTL
`percentile_min_samples`	30	Below this, CDF marked insufficient_data
`drift_window_days`	90	Page-Hinkley window
`drift_delta_sigma`	0.5	Tolerance below which we don't care
`drift_threshold_sigma`	5.0	PH alarm threshold

B.8 Anomaly detection

Setting	Default	Effect
`anomaly_fit_interval_seconds`	14400	Re-fit cadence (4 h)
`anomaly_baseline_window_days`	90	Fit window
`anomaly_p95_threshold`	auto	From fit; configurable override

Setting	Default	Effect
`anomaly_feature_min_overlap`	8	Min features in live snapshot to score
`anomaly_top_contributing_tags`	5	K in top-K attribution

B.9 Change ledger

Setting	Default	Effect
`change_ledger_baseline_pct_min`	0.5	Min recipe dominance for clean baseline
`change_ledger_sigma_threshold`	2.0	Tag-delta noise floor
`change_ledger_max_tag_deltas`	10	Top-K sigma-ranked tags surfaced

B.10 Feedback & outcomes

Setting	Default	Effect
`outcome_closure_enabled`	`true`	Master toggle
`outcome_closure_window_hours`	24	Sweep window
`outcome_closure_cron`	`"0 4 * * *"`	Nightly at 04:00 UTC
`memory_challenge_threshold`	3	Independent challenges before flip
`memory_approved_boost`	1.5	Retrieval multiplier on approved memory

B.11 Rate limits

Setting	Default	Effect
`chat_rate_limits`	`"10/minute, 200/hour"`	Per-user `/api/chat`
`feedback_rate_limits`	`"60/minute, 1000/hour"`	Per-user `/api/feedback`
`corrections_rate_limits`	`"5/minute, 50/hour"`	Per-user `/api/corrections`

B.12 Tag selection

Setting	Default	Effect
`tag_catalog_source`	`"key_tags_jsonblob"`	`key_tags_jsonblob
`tag_selector_max_tier2`	25	Cap on tier-2 routed tags

B.13 Observability

Setting	Default	Effect
`log_level`	`"INFO"`	Standard Python log levels
`log_format`	`"json"`	`json
`metrics_enabled`	`true`	Exposes `/metrics`
`metrics_path`	`"/metrics"`	Endpoint path
`health_check_deep_timeout_seconds`	5	Per-leg deep-check timeout

Appendix C — Test Catalog

The 145 passing + 2 skipped tests in `service/tests/`, grouped by the service area they cover. Each entry: file → brief purpose. See chapter 16 for the testing strategy and mocked-vs-real boundary.

C.1 Anchor resolution

service/tests/test_anchor.py

- past-event anchor with QR-id resolves to single run
- past-event anchor with run-id resolves to single run
- past-event anchor with bare timestamp resolves with confirmation flag
- current-state anchor recognises "rn", "right now", "currently"
- pattern anchor when no specific time/run/event reference present
- ambiguity → clarification-first response, no retrieval performed

service/tests/test_anchor_regression.py

- regression suite of historical anchor parsing failures with frozen inputs/outputs

C.2 Anomaly detection

service/tests/test_anomaly.py

- Mahalanobis baseline fits on synthetic correlated data
- ridge stabilization handles singular covariance
- p95 threshold computed correctly
- top-K contributing tags ranked by attribution magnitude
- sparse snapshot rejected (below `anomaly_feature_min_overlap`)
- re-fit cadence updates `ml_models.is_active` flag
- old baselines archived not deleted

C.3 Change ledger

service/tests/test_change_ledger.py

- TagDelta computed sigma-ranked against baseline
- top-K cap respected when more deltas than `change_ledger_max_tag_deltas`
- RecipeDelta surfaces setpoint changes between current and baseline run
- CrewDelta when shifts differ
- EquipmentChangeover when equipment_id mismatch
- empty ledger when no significant deltas (defensive against noise)

C.4 Chunker

service/tests/test_chunker.py

- text-only chunker respects token budget
- overlap policy applied between adjacent chunks
- chunk metadata propagated (doc_id, position, role)

service/tests/test_chunker_structured.py

- markdown headings preserved as chunk boundaries
- tables emitted as single chunks (don't split mid-table)
- bullet lists preserved as single chunks
- chunk_type column populated correctly per chunk variety

C.5 Context assembler

service/tests/test_context_assembler.py

- v1: 5 buckets assembled in canonical order
- past-event anchor includes failure-mode-matched history bucket
- current-state anchor excludes that bucket, includes recent-window
- pattern anchor includes neither, includes broad-corpus
- token budget enforced; over-budget chunks dropped from lowest-priority bucket first

service/tests/test_context_assembler_v2.py

- v2 layered assembly with role-weight clamps
- conditional inclusion based on anchor.failure_mode presence
- change-ledger section L appended when anomaly score above threshold
- outcome-history section M appended when outcome_linkages exist

C.6 Deviation / drift

service/tests/test_deviation.py

- Page-Hinkley CUSUM detects step change in synthetic series
- below `drift_delta_sigma` no alarm
- above `drift_threshold_sigma` raises alarm
- window respects `drift_window_days`

C.7 Integrations (E2E with mocked LLM)

service/tests/test_integrations_v2.py

- end-to-end past-event causal chat with mocked LLM tool calls
- end-to-end current-state diagnostic chat
- citations present and resolve to real chunk IDs
- audit_log row written with hash chain extended
- `messages.tool_calls` populated with full trace
- refusal path on out-of-corpus query
- refusal path on control-command query

C.8 LLM tool loop

service/tests/test_llm_tool_loop.py

- single tool call → result → response cycle
- multi-iteration tool loop respects `rca_step1_max_iters`
- tool budget exhaustion stops the loop and forces a response
- malformed tool-call JSON triggers re-prompt
- tool exception caught, surfaced as "tool failed" structured response
- provider parity: OpenAI / Azure / local produce equivalent loops

C.9 Local LLM client

service/tests/test_local_llm_client.py

- chat completion against mocked OpenAI-compatible endpoint
- tool-calling parameter shaped per OpenAI spec
- streaming response handled (skipped: not enabled in v3.0)
- timeout honoured per `llm_request_timeout_seconds`

C.10 Percentiles

service/tests/test_percentiles.py

- per-scope CDF computed correctly on synthetic distributions
- insufficient_samples flagged below `percentile_min_samples`
- TTL cache returns identical CDF within window
- TTL cache invalidates after window
- `compare_to_distribution` returns the right percentile + bucket label

C.11 Prompt regression

service/tests/test_prompt_regression.py

- frozen system_prompt_v2 unchanged from baseline hash (catches accidental edits)
- per-prompt-version comparison harness logic
- A/B routing via `prompt_versions.is_active` respected

C.12 RCA

service/tests/test_rca.py

- step 1 (hypothesise) produces ≤ `rca_max_hypotheses` hypotheses
- step 1 cache hit on identical anchor + prompt version
- step 1 cache miss on different prompt version
- step 2 (adjudicate) consumes step-1 hypotheses + tool results
- final confidence label assigned per the rules
- two-step trace persisted to `messages.rca_summary`

service/tests/test_rca_e2e.py

- end-to-end RCA path with mocked LLM and real tools
- tool budget shared across both steps respected
- step timeout enforced per `rca_step_timeout_seconds`

C.13 Skipped tests (2)

- streaming-response test in `test_local_llm_client.py` — not enabled in v3.0
- per-claim citation-validator test — feature is in the considering bucket (chapter 17 §17.4), not built

C.14 Coverage gaps (transparent)

Areas without dedicated unit tests in v3.0:

- `services/symphony_capture.py` — stub, returns `extraction_status: "stub"`
- `services/wo_sync.py` — read-only sync; covered by integration test
- `services/audit.py` hash chain — covered by integration test, not unit
- bounded-rerank consumer in `services/rag.py` — covered by integration test
- `routers/select_tags.py` — manual smoke test only

Appendix D — Open Questions

Design decisions still genuinely outstanding at the v3.0 cut. None of these are blockers for go-live; all are forward-looking. They are recorded here so the maintainer two years from now sees the explicit list rather than discovering them by archaeology.

D.1 Retrieval

Per-tag drift threshold tuning

`drift_threshold_sigma = 5.0` is the global default. A more honest implementation would tune per-tag based on the historical noise floor. **Open**: do we tune per-tag manually, or fit a per-tag threshold nightly off the previous 90 days? The latter requires labeled drift events to validate against.

ivfflat → hnsw cutover automation

Migration 003 documents the cutover procedure, including measurement of when to perform it. **Open**: should we wire automated detection ("rows > 250K AND p95 retrieval latency > 100ms"), or keep this as a human decision? The argument for human: the cutover is a one-line config change with brief downtime risk; not worth automating.

Hybrid retrieval weight measurement

RRF weights vector and BM25 equally via the `1/(k+rank)` formula. **Open**: should we measure per-query whether vector or BM25 is contributing more, and re-weight? The literature is mixed; equal weighting via RRF is a defensible default. Revisit if pilot measurement shows recall is bound by one or the other.

Step-back / HyDE hybrid

If we eventually build B5 (HyDE), should it be a preliminary tool call (deterministic) rather than an internal LLM step (non-deterministic)? A deterministic step-back would be more auditable; an LLM-driven HyDE is more adaptive. **Open** — argument for both is real.

D.2 LLM and tools

Per-claim citation enforcement

Today: response-level validation that any `[N]` reference resolves to a real chunk. **Open**: should we go further — validate that *every factual claim* has a citation? The verifier needed (extracting claims from prose) is itself an LLM call; this is precision vs cost. Likely deferred until the eval harness can show it actually moves the precision dashboard.

Adversarial prompt-injection corpus

We document the prompt-injection mitigations (chapter 14). We do not have a labeled corpus of attempted injections to test against. **Open**: do we author one synthetically (LLM-generated attacks), or collect from production traffic? The latter is more realistic but slower to gather.

Provider parity validation in CI

Tests assert provider parity at unit-test level. **Open**: should we also run the integration suite against all three providers in CI? The cost (cloud API calls) makes this unattractive; running against `local` (vLLM) only is a defensible compromise.

Tool budget per-query vs per-day

Today: per-query budget (15 calls). **Open**: should we also enforce a per-user per-day budget to bound runaway-cost scenarios? The absence has not bitten in pilot prep but is a risk for wider rollout.

D.3 Distributional grounding

Anomaly false-positive rate calibration

`anomaly_p95_threshold` is fit from baseline data. **Open**: what's the acceptable false-positive rate, and how do we measure it in production? This requires operator labeling of "this anomaly was real" vs "this was noise." Probably needs a UI affordance in the chat panel.

Non-Gaussian feature handling

Mahalanobis assumes approximate Gaussianity. Several tags (motor amperage, especially) have heavy-tailed distributions. **Open**: do we transform these features (log, Box-Cox) at fit time? The transformation must then be inverted for the top-K-attribution output to be interpretable.

Page-Hinkley vs CUSUM vs more recent change-point detectors

Page-Hinkley is venerable but limited. **Open**: is the marginal detection performance of more recent change-point algorithms (BOCPD, NEWMA) worth the implementation cost? Probably not without a labeled drift corpus.

D.4 Schema and storage

`tag_registry` cutover playbook

The forward plan (chapter 15 §15.4) is documented but the cutover playbook itself isn't written. **Open**: do we cut over while keeping KEY_TAGS as a fallback, or is there an atomic switch?

Embedding-model upgrade replay corpus

Migration approach: sibling-column backfill (chapter 13). **Open**: the backfill cost grows linearly with corpus size. At what corpus size do we re-embed in batches vs hold off?

Outcome-linkages backfill on prompt-version switch

When we activate a new prompt version, the precision dashboard restarts from zero. **Open**: do we also backfill the new prompt's projected behavior on historical outcomes? That's only possible if we re-run the LLM on historical queries, which is expensive.

D.5 Operations

Multi-instance HA

Today: single-VM Docker Compose. **Open**: at what concurrent-user count does single-instance stop being sufficient? Likely the embedding- provider call latency dominates well past 50 concurrent users. The Postgres tier is also single-instance — adding a read replica is the first step.

Per-instance vs centralized rate limiting

`slowapi` rate limits are per-process. **Open**: when we go multi-instance, do we use Redis-backed centralized rate limits? Adds operational complexity; needed only at multi-VM scale.

Backup and disaster recovery cadence

We rely on Postgres native backups. **Open**: what RPO / RTO are we committing to? This is partly a business question, partly a DBA-skills question for the deployment team.

Logical-replication consumer for analytics

Today: analytics is via materialized views in the same Postgres. **Open**: at what query-volume does the analytics workload need its own replica? Very pilot-dependent.

D.6 Phase 4 ML

B13 labeled-corpus sourcing

Eval harness blocked on this. **Open**: who labels (operators, engineers, both)? How many cases per failure mode? What's the gold standard for "correct response"?

Synthetic vs real correction-corpus for fine-tuning

Phase 4 §18.4.3 fine-tuning. **Open**: do we augment the real correction corpus with synthetic-but-realistic LLM-generated cases? Augmentation expands the dataset but risks teaching the model artifacts.

Cross-LLM ensembling

Considered for high-stakes RCA. **Open**: do we build an explicit "second opinion" LLM call against a different provider, and surface disagreements? Costs 2× per query in that path; only justifiable for true safety incidents.

Per-failure-mode predictive models

Phase 4 §18.4.2. **Open**: how do we surface model output to operators without overloading them? The "scrap risk in next 30 min" surface needs UX that doesn't induce alert fatigue.

Distillation horizon

Phase 4 §18.4.4. **Open**: what's the minimum acceptable performance gap between the distilled edge model and the cloud model for production deployment? 90% of cloud quality at 10% of latency? The exact tradeoff depends on which queries we route to which.

D.7 RLHF / continuous learning

Survey design for memory candidates

When the system surfaces a memory candidate to an engineer, what's the UX? **Open**: full prose review, or thumbs-up/thumbs-down on a distilled summary? The former is high-quality but creates engineer workload; the latter is lower-friction but loses nuance.

Memory expiration policy

Today: memories are flipped to `challenged` after 3 challenges. There is no time-based expiration. **Open**: should we add "memory hasn't been retrieved in 6 months → flag for re-review"?

Personalization opt-out

Per chapter 10, personalization is substrate-shipped. **Open**: do operators have an opt-out toggle? Privacy-by-default would say yes; substrate today doesn't expose one.

D.8 Governance

Access-control granularity

Today: API-key + JWT, per-`user_id` rate limits. **Open**: do we add per-user access-control rules ("operator X can only ask about line N")? Substrate supports it; not exposed today.

Audit-log retention beyond 24 months

`pg_partman` retention default is 24 months hot. **Open**: do we archive older partitions to cold storage (S3) or drop? Compliance posture (chapter 14) says archive; cost analysis required.

External corpus inclusion

Today: corpus is internal documents only. **Open**: do we ever include vendor manuals, supplier specifications, or industry-standard references? Each requires a licensing review.

This list will be revisited at the end of the pilot. Any item moved to "decided" gets recorded in a future TDD revision. Any item moved to "deferred indefinitely" likewise.